

CHESS99 BOOK 5 | ELO 1100-1400 | SILVER

Calculation I - Candidate Moves

A repeatable process for choosing moves instead of guessing.

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Candidate Moves

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Candidate Moves converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

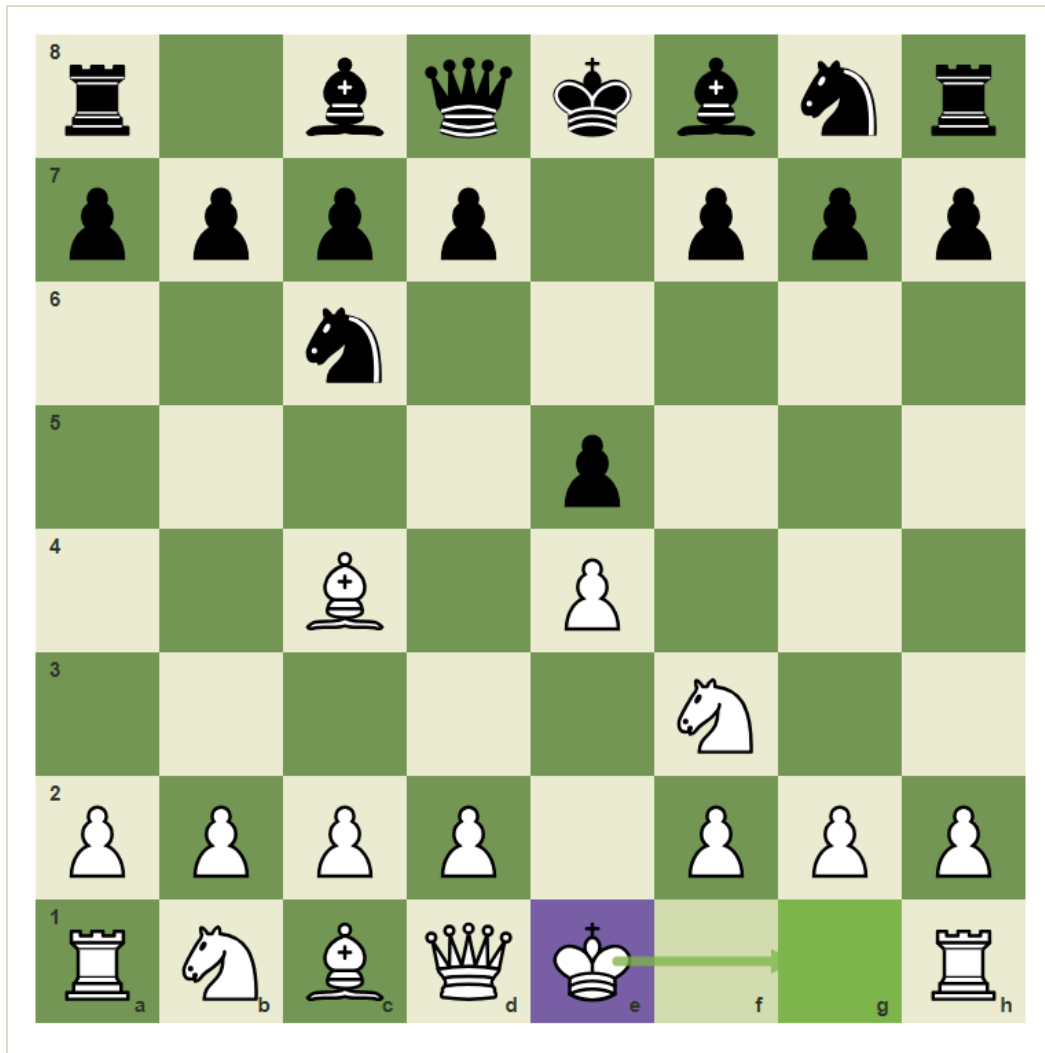
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for candidate moves.
- Choose a move or plan that fits candidate moves.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with candidate moves.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

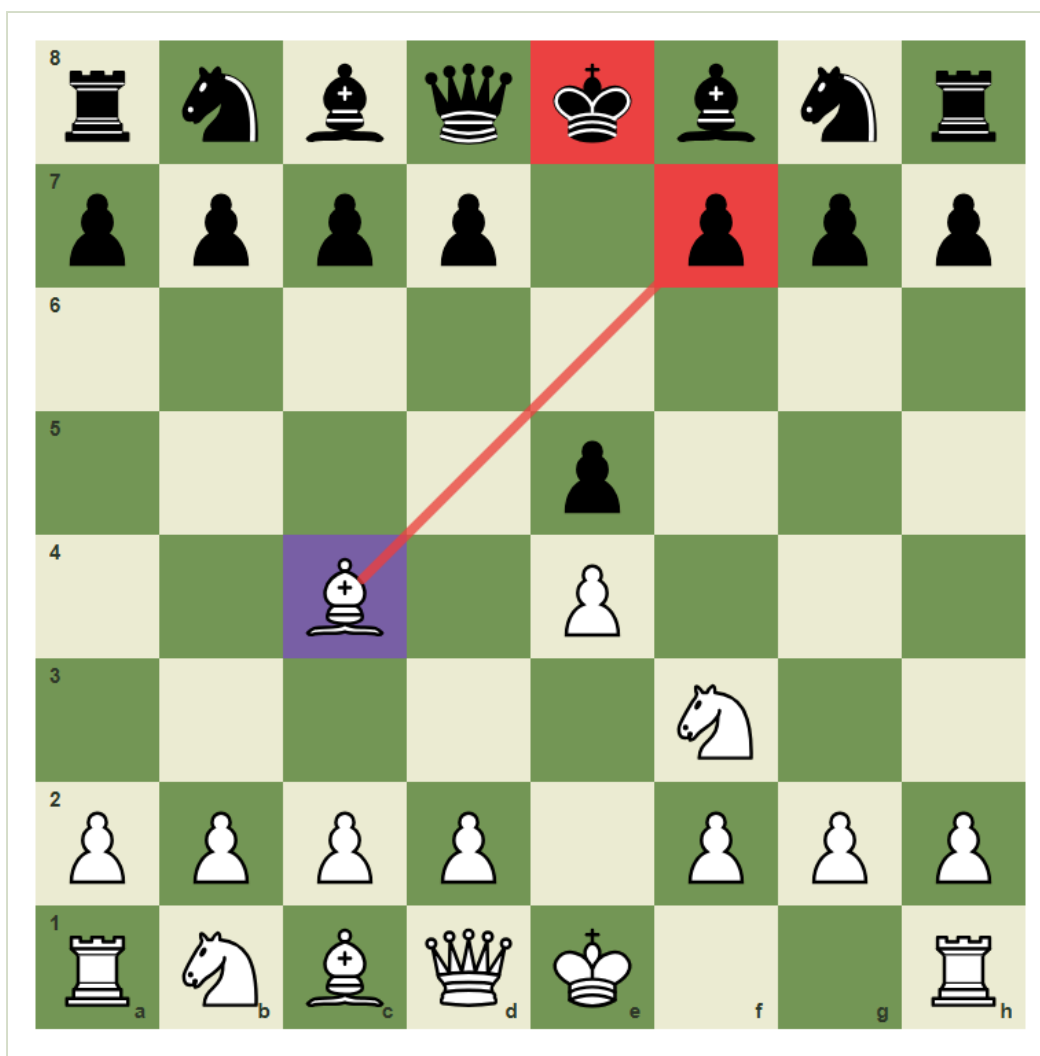
Candidate Moves is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

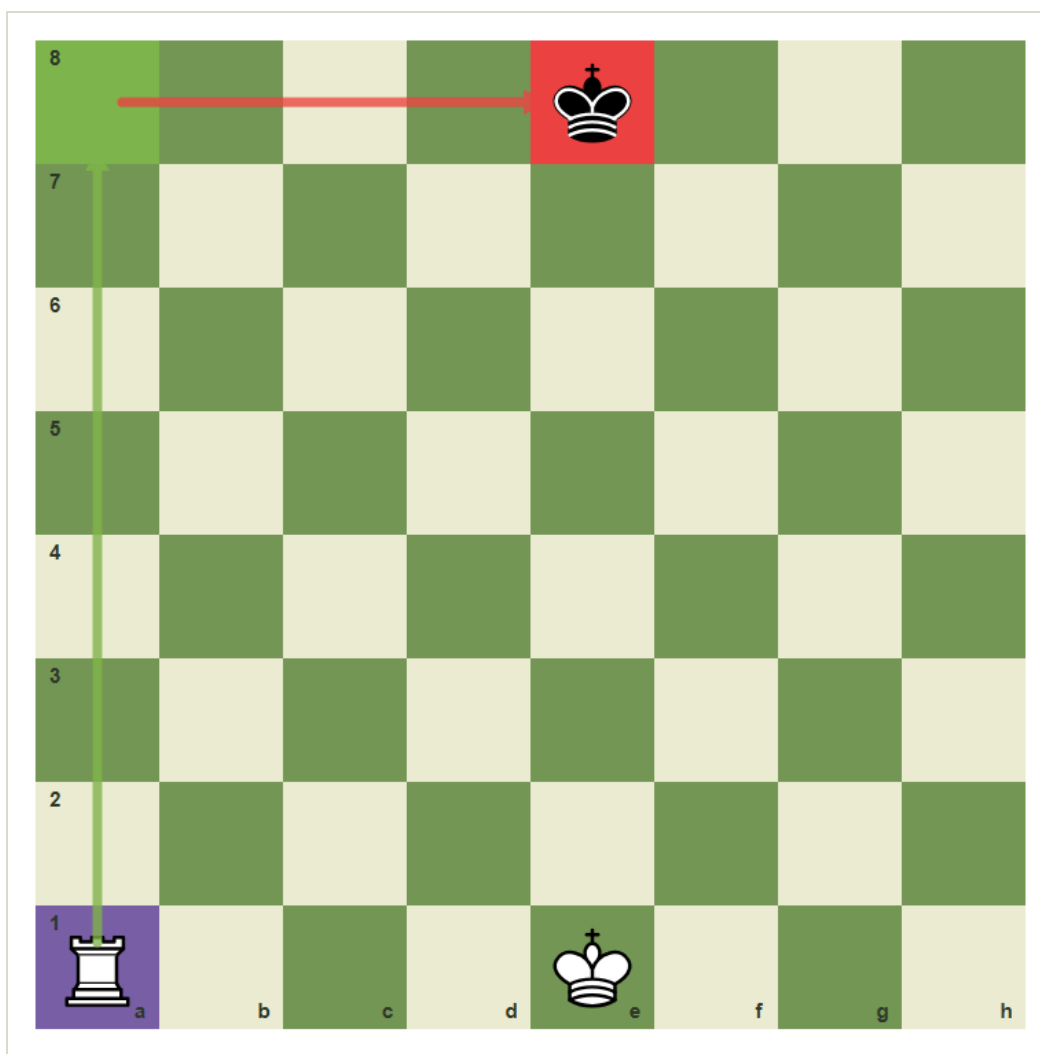


Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

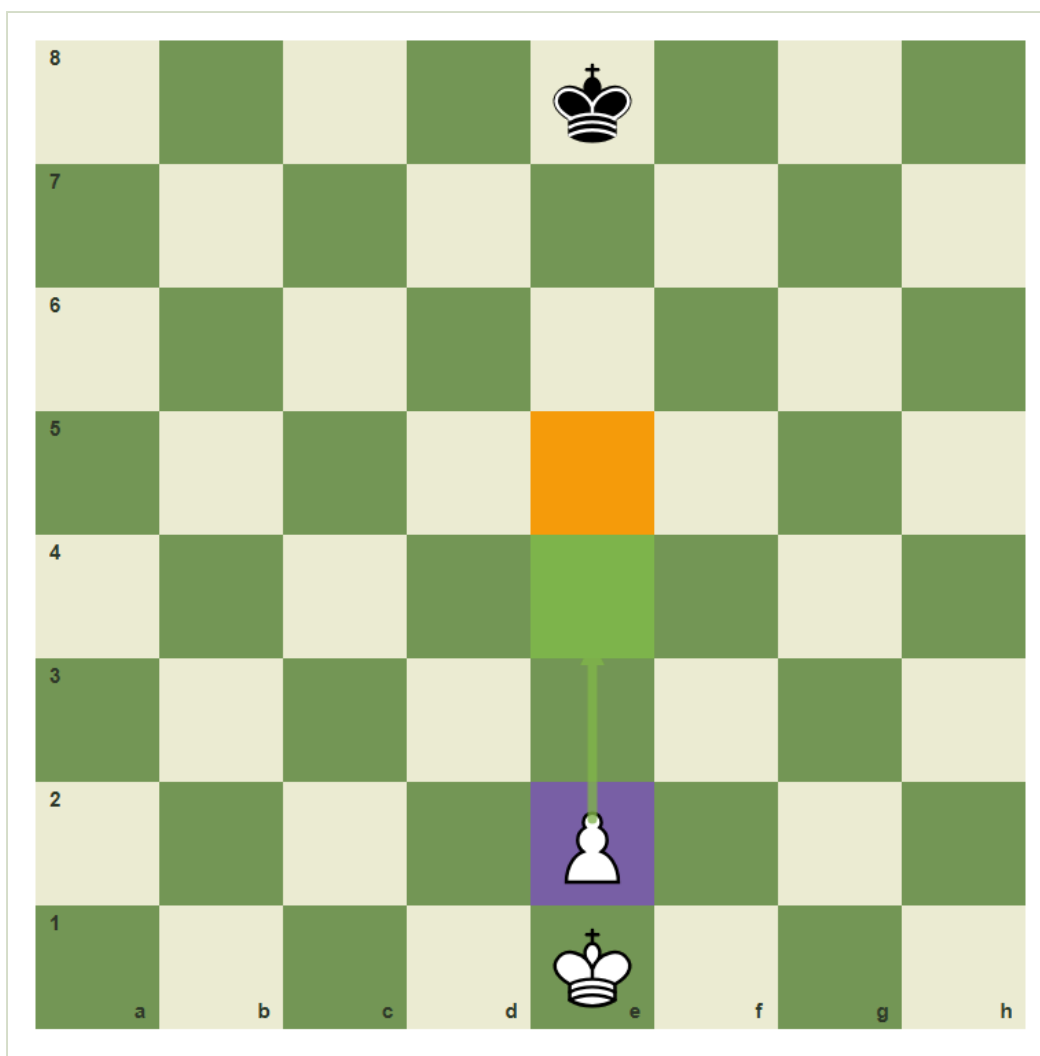
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



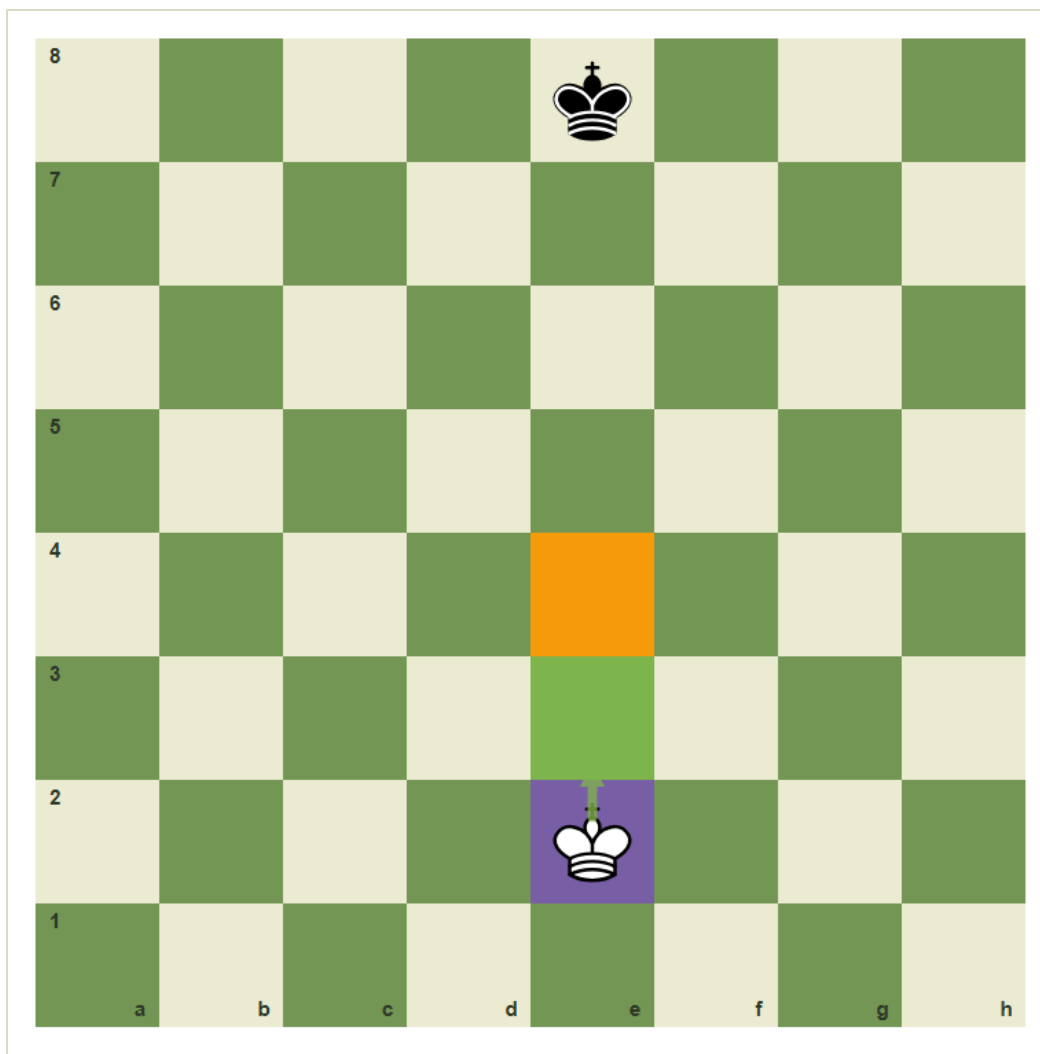
Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

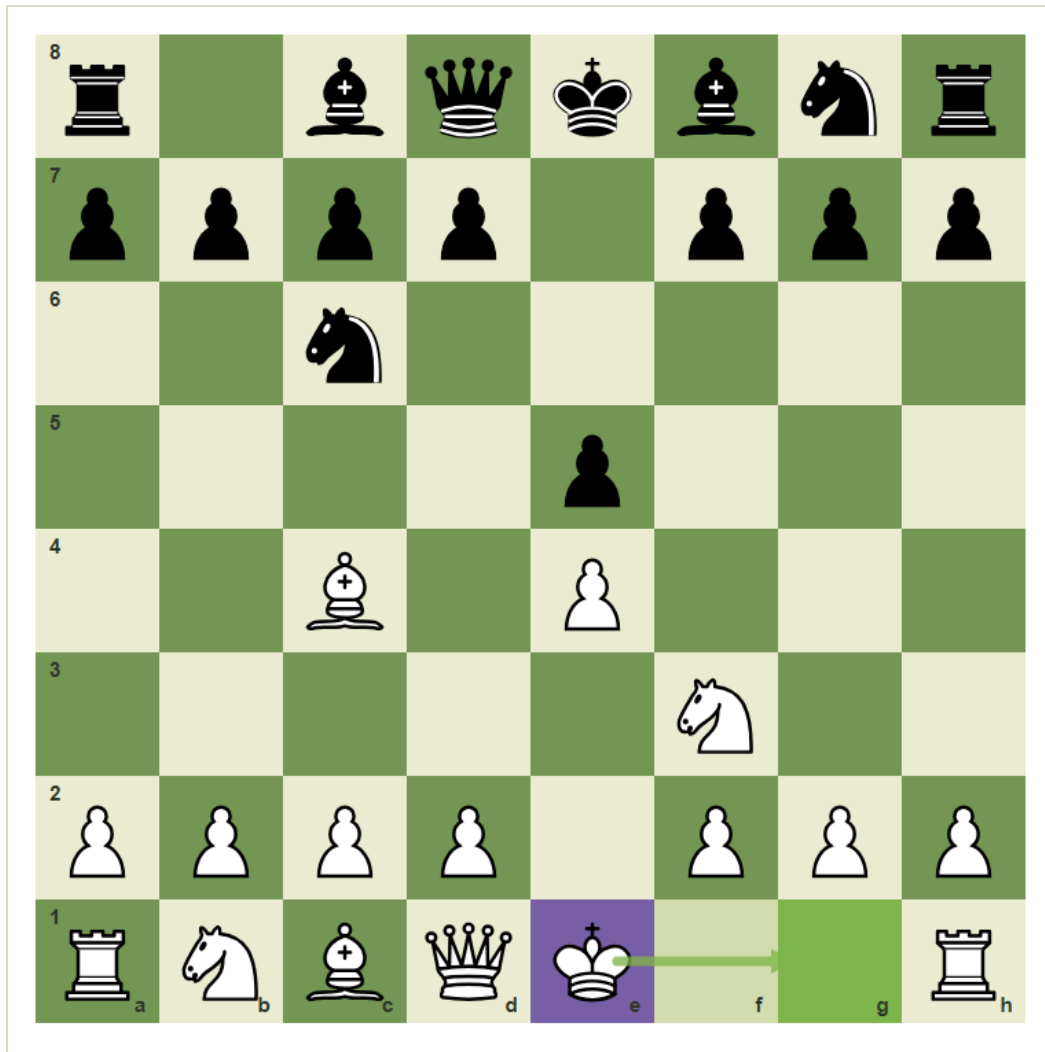
Training Diagram: review position



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

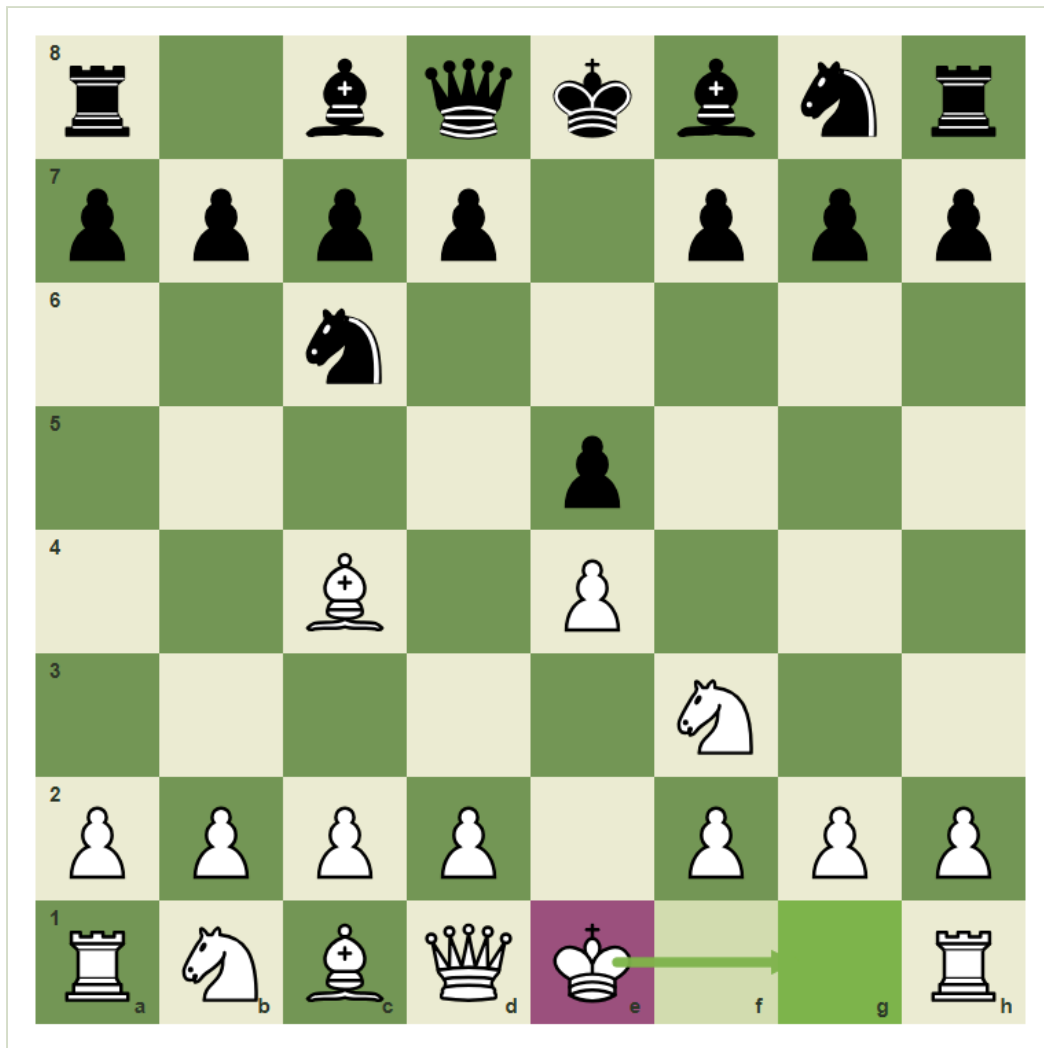
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **g1**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Candidate Moves Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **candidate moves**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Candidate Moves Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **candidate moves**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Candidate Moves Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **candidate moves**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Forcing Moves First

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Forcing Moves First converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

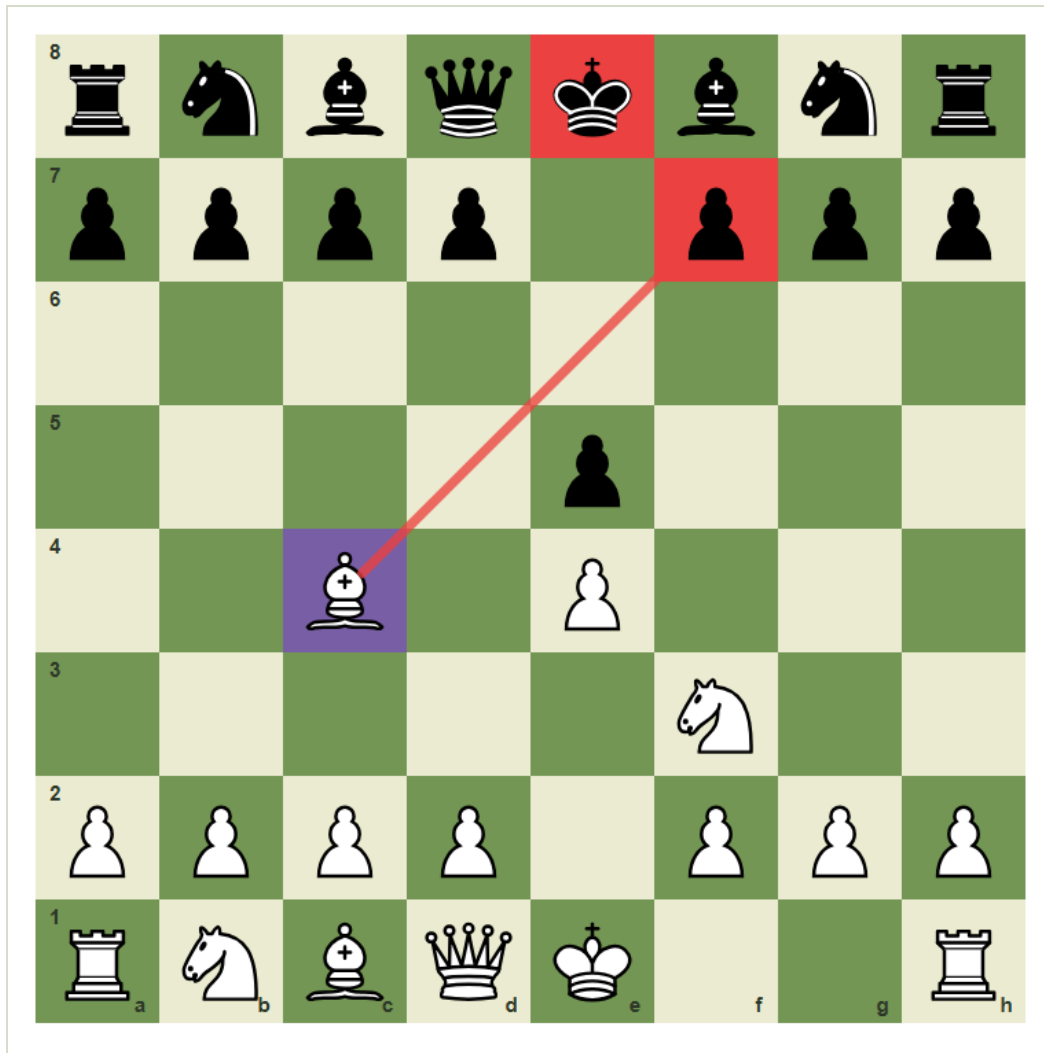
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for forcing moves first.
- Choose a move or plan that fits forcing moves first.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with forcing moves first.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

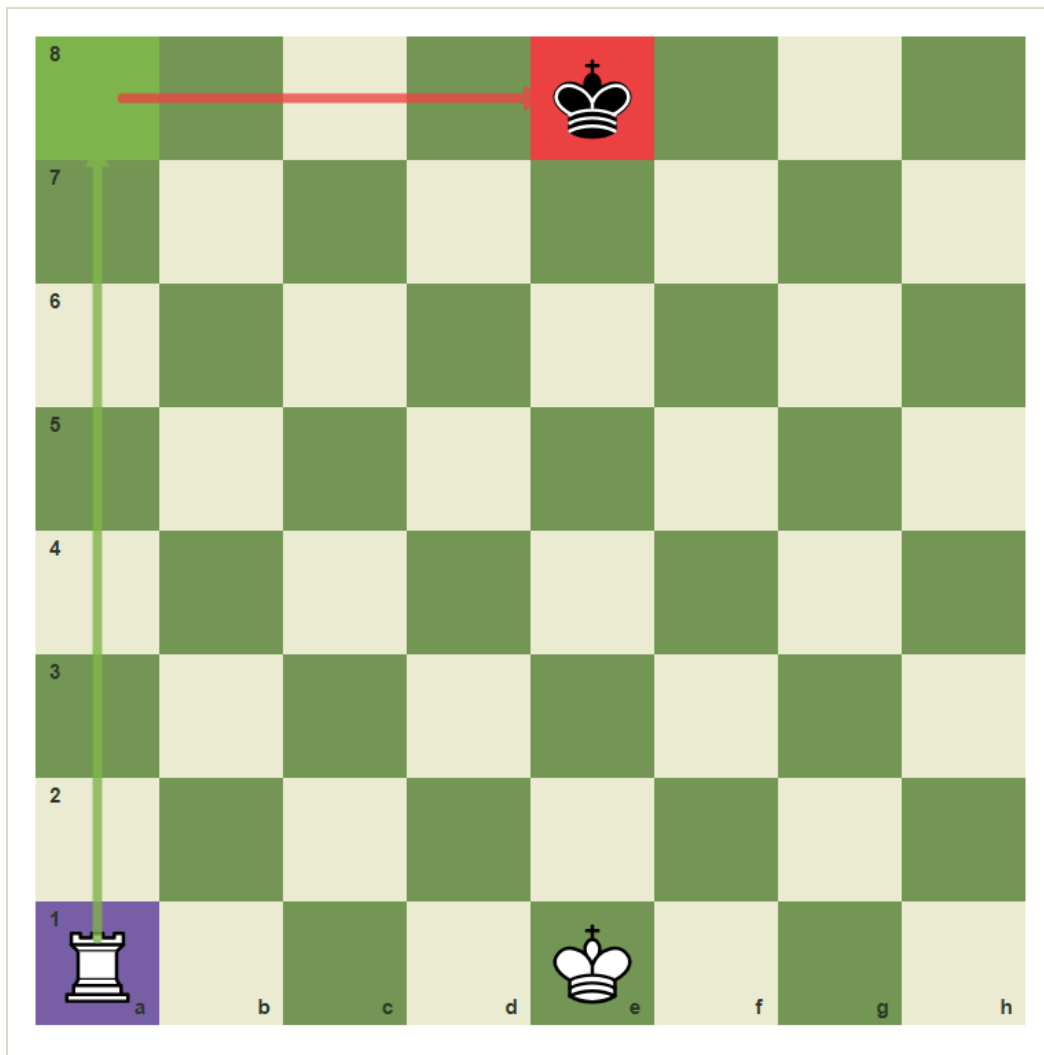
Forcing Moves First is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

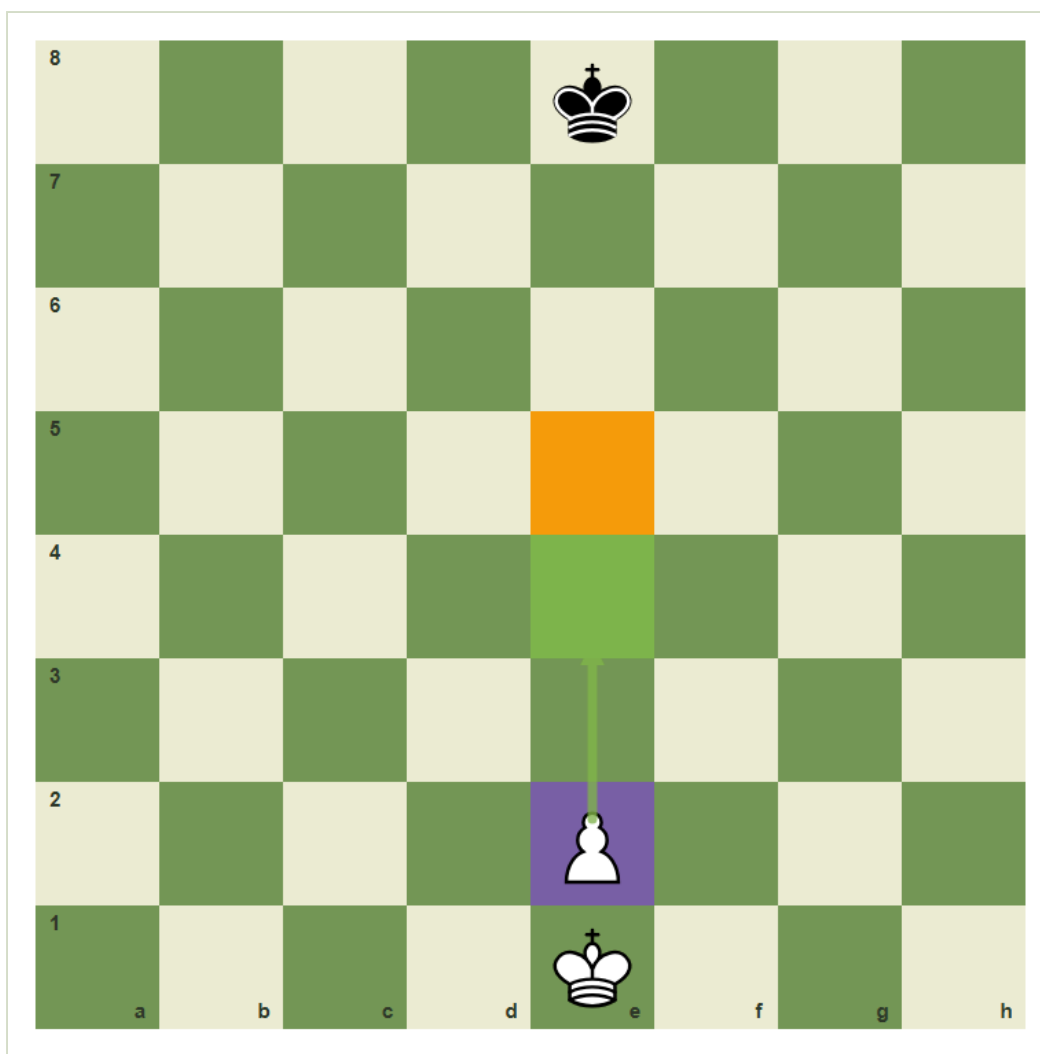


Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

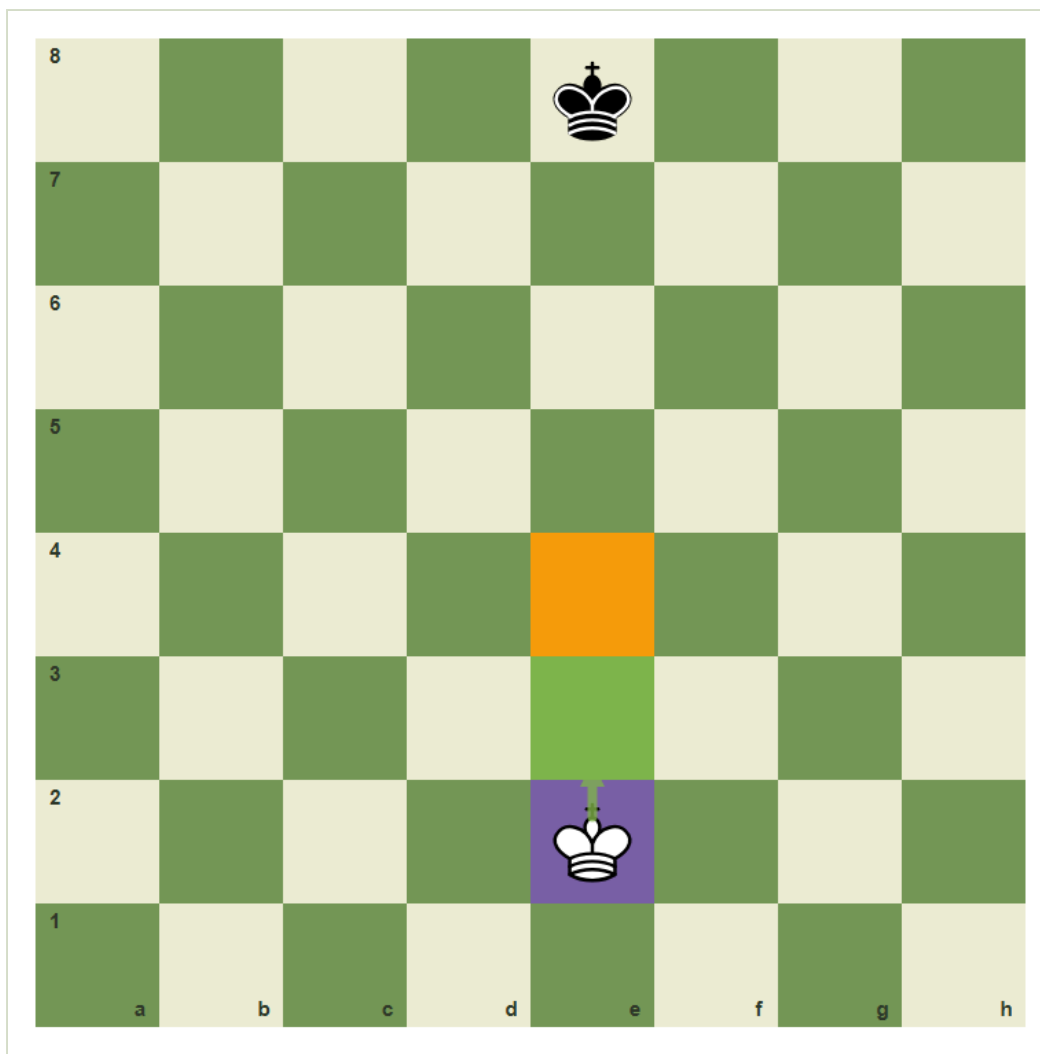
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



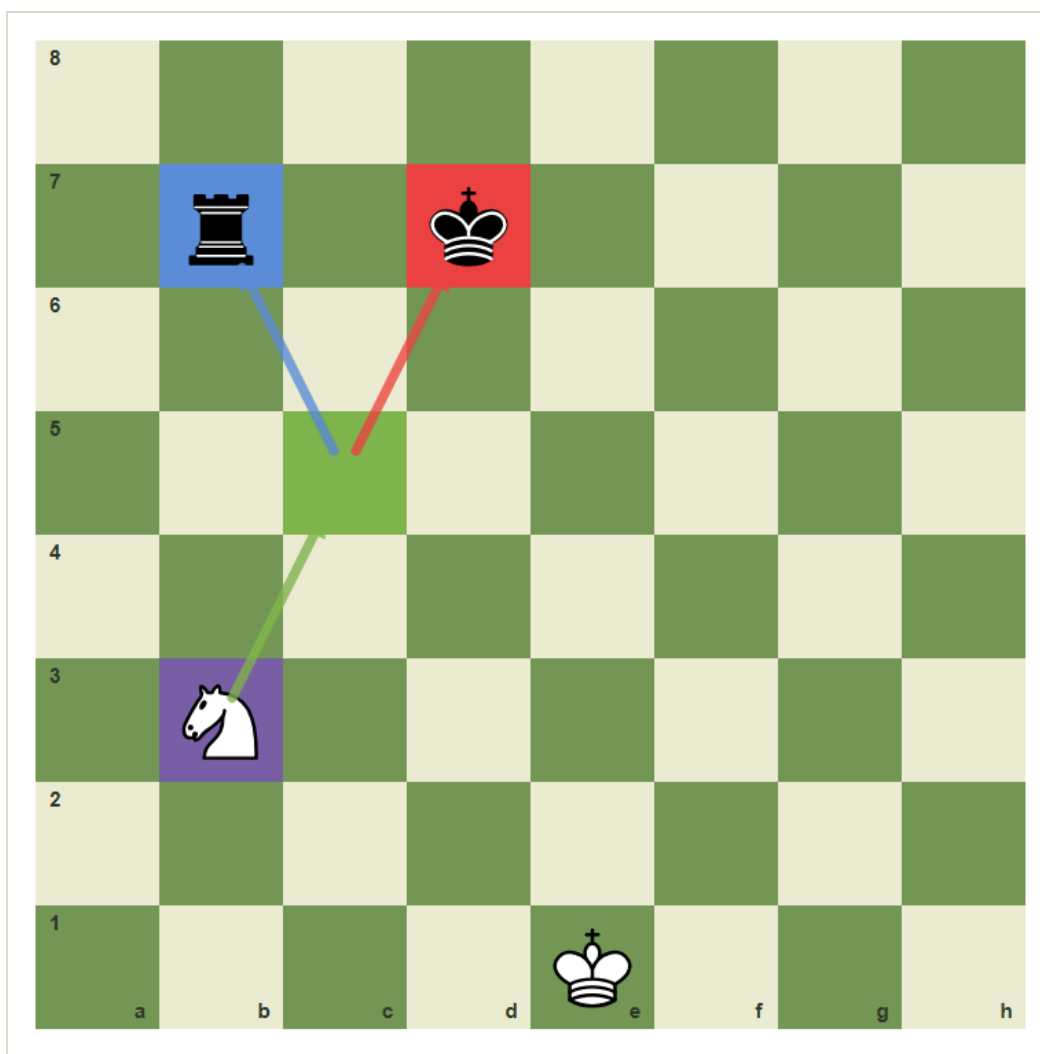
In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

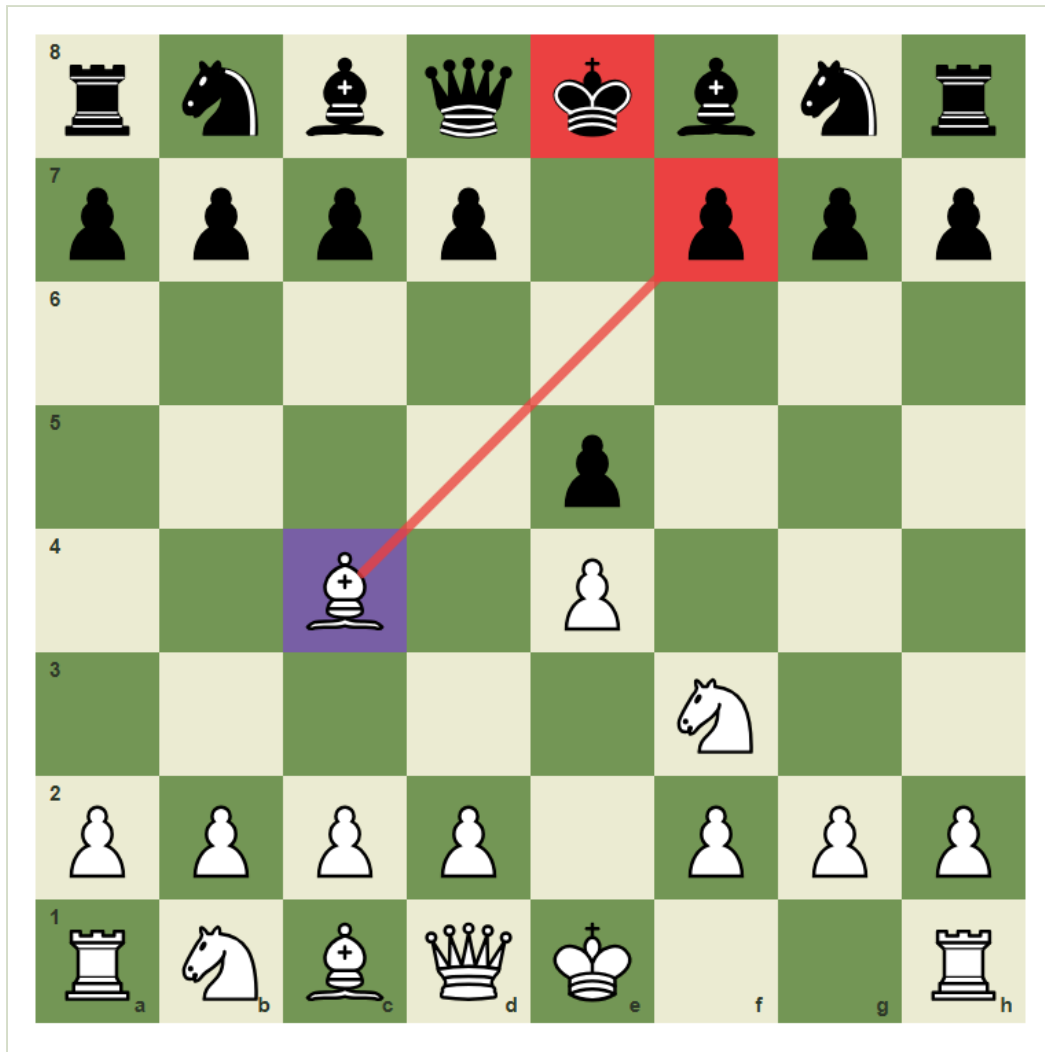
Training Diagram: review position



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

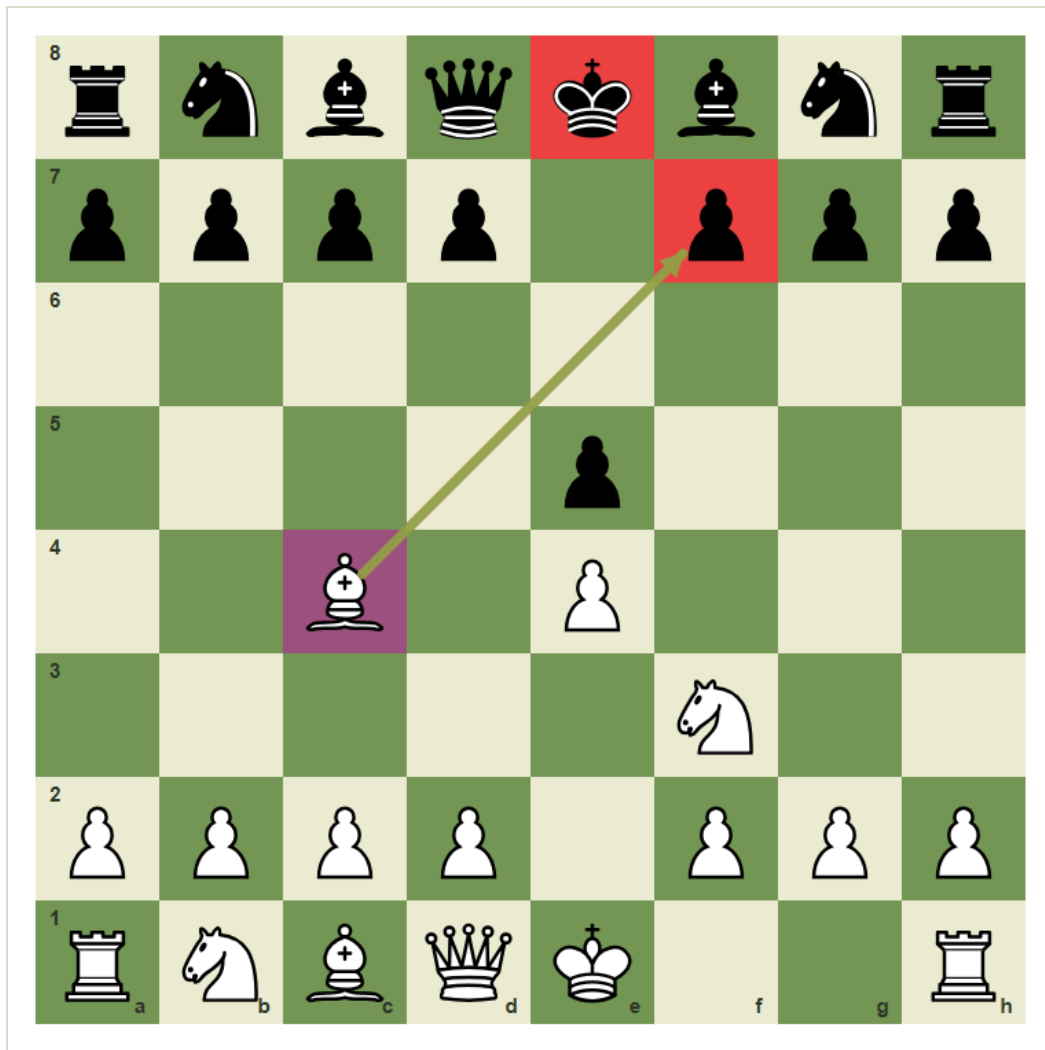
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Forcing Moves First Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **forcing moves first**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Forcing Moves First Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **forcing moves first**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Forcing Moves First Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **forcing moves first**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Checks

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Checks converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

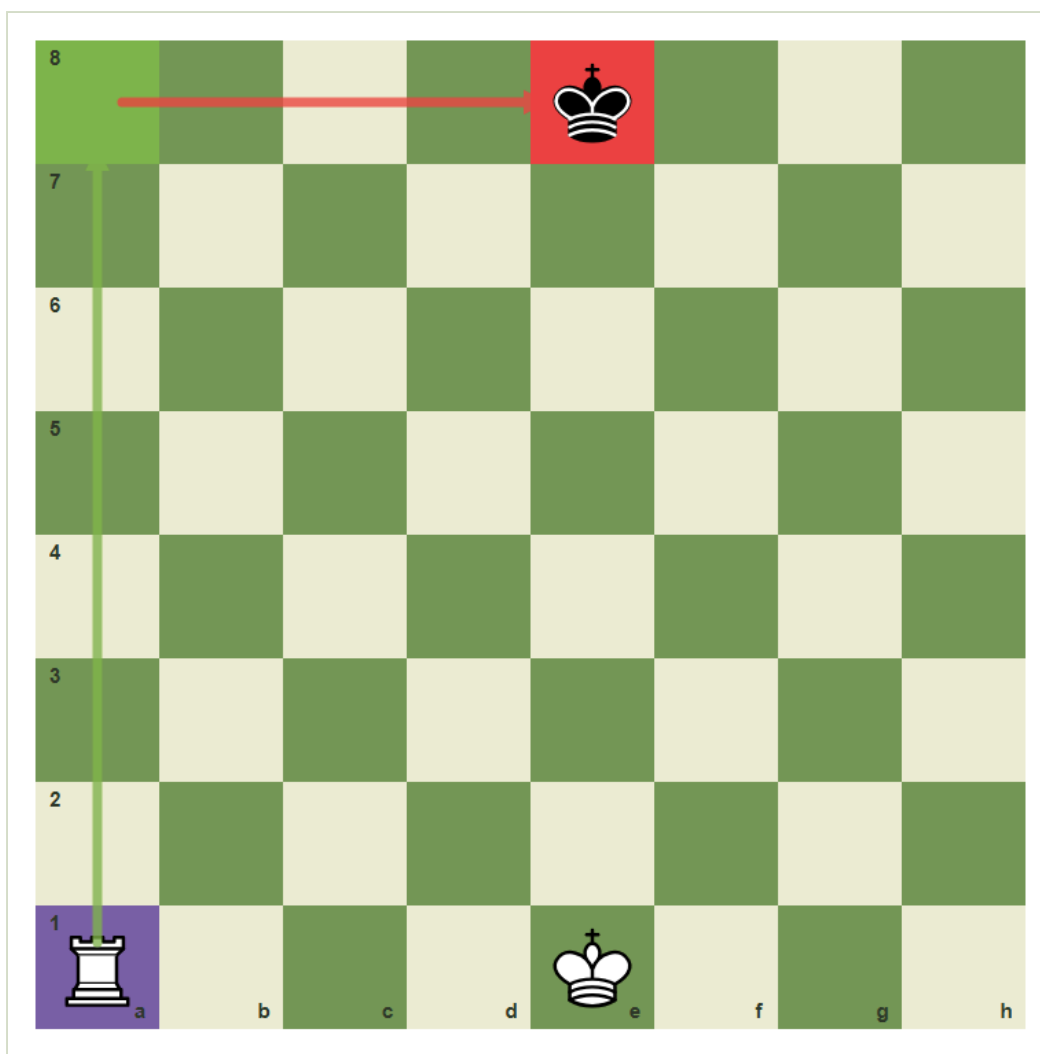
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for checks.
- Choose a move or plan that fits checks.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with checks.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

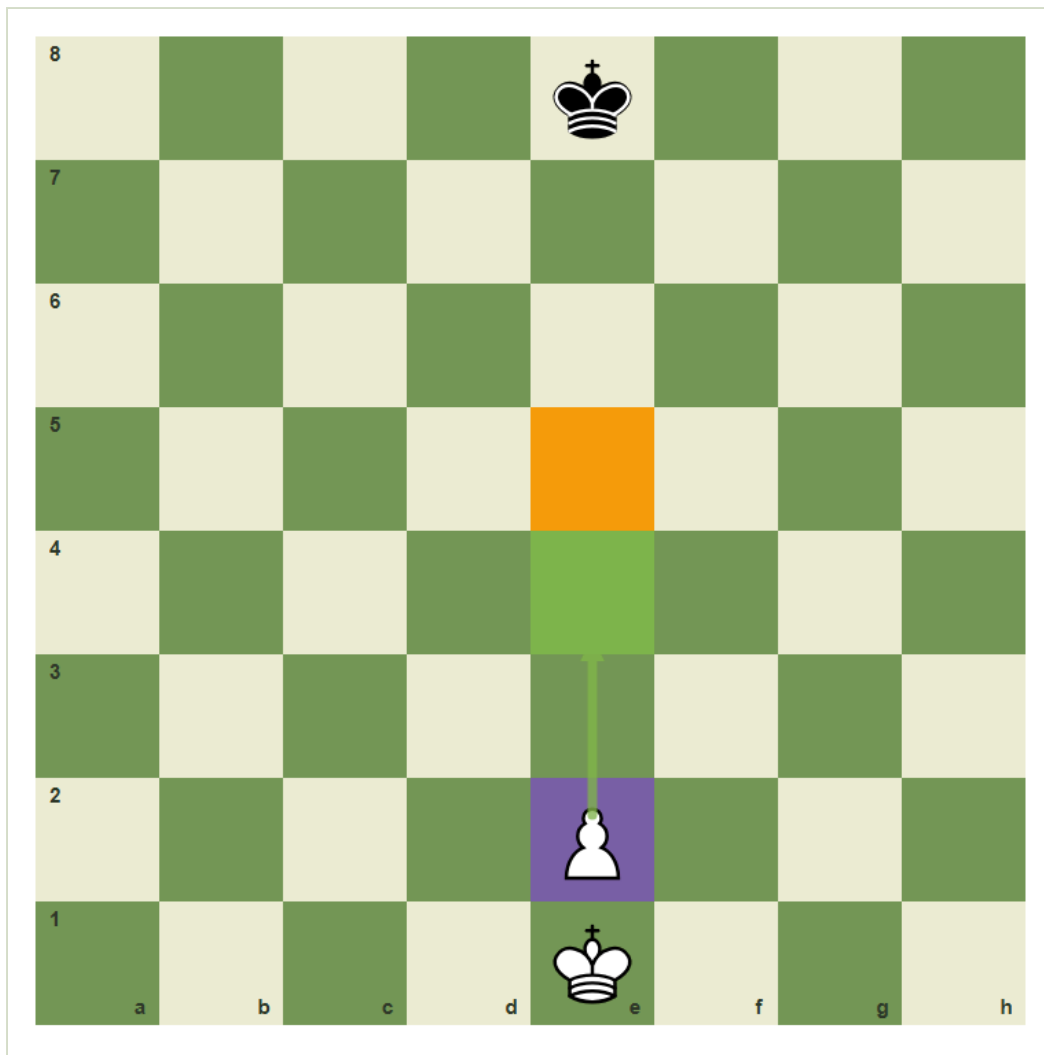
Checks is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

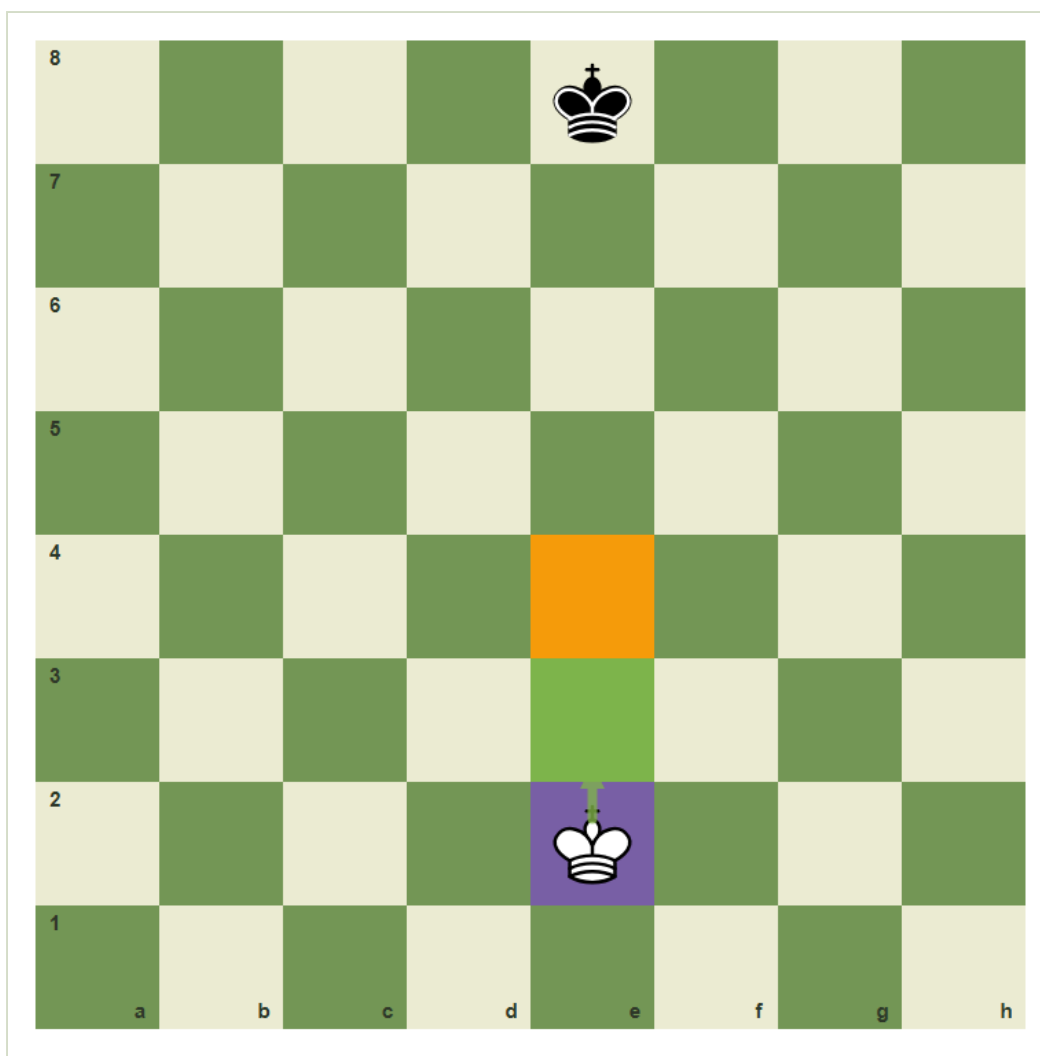


In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

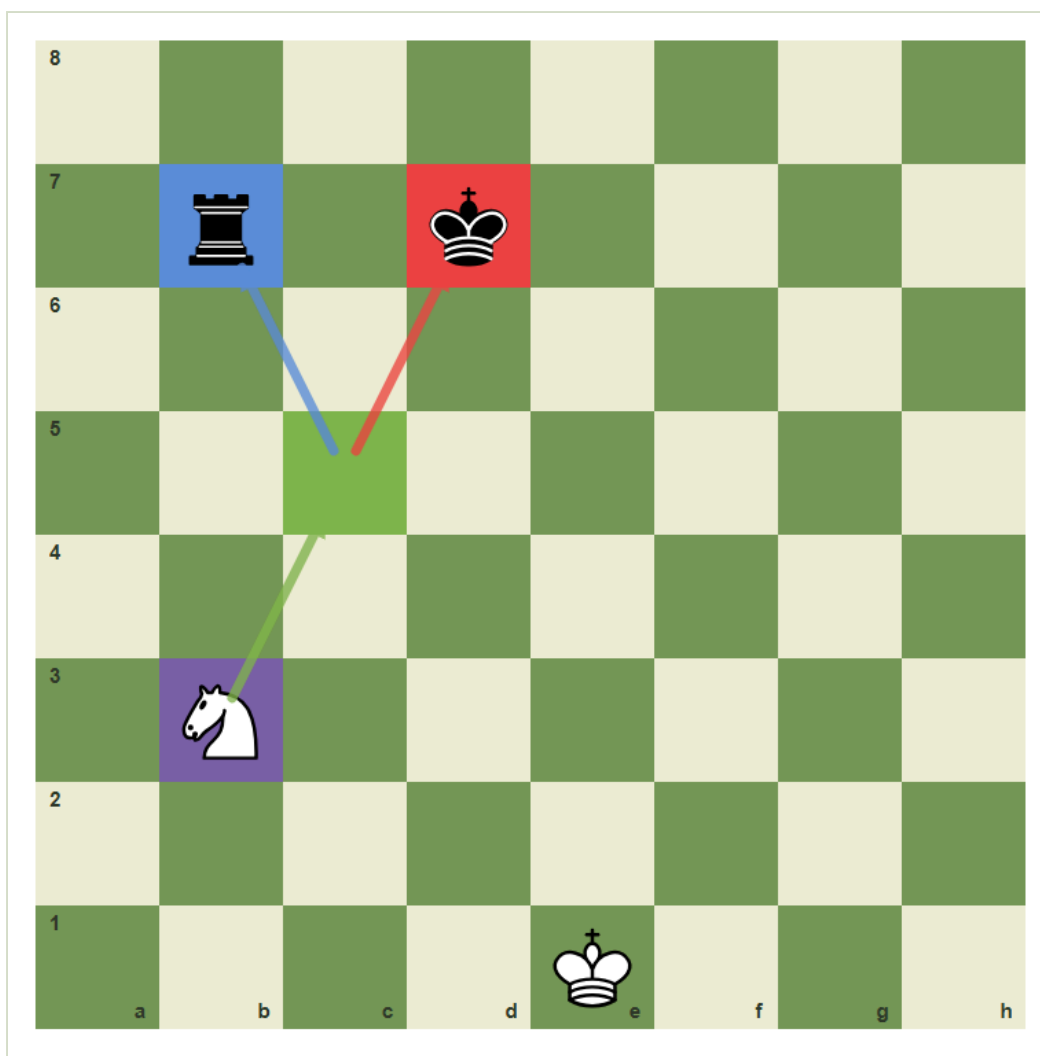
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



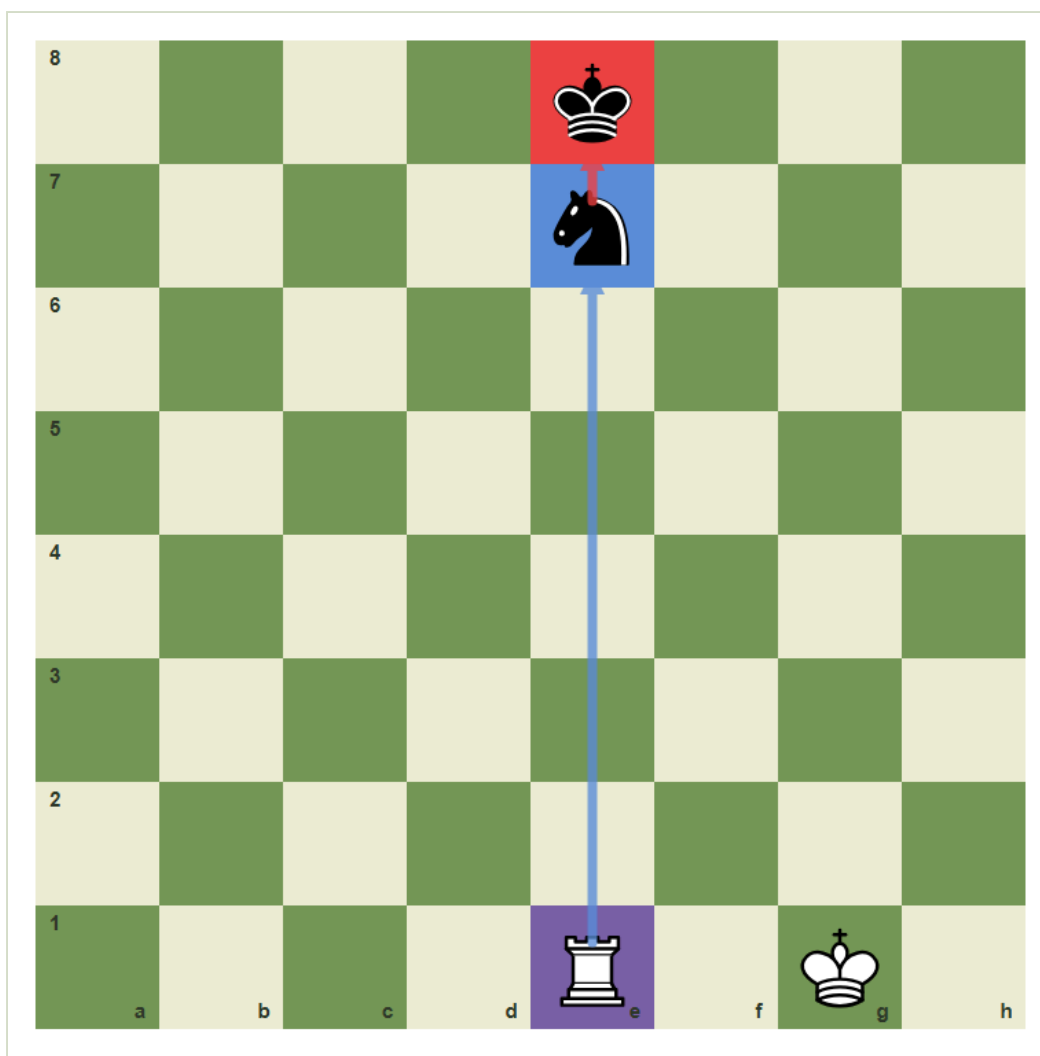
Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

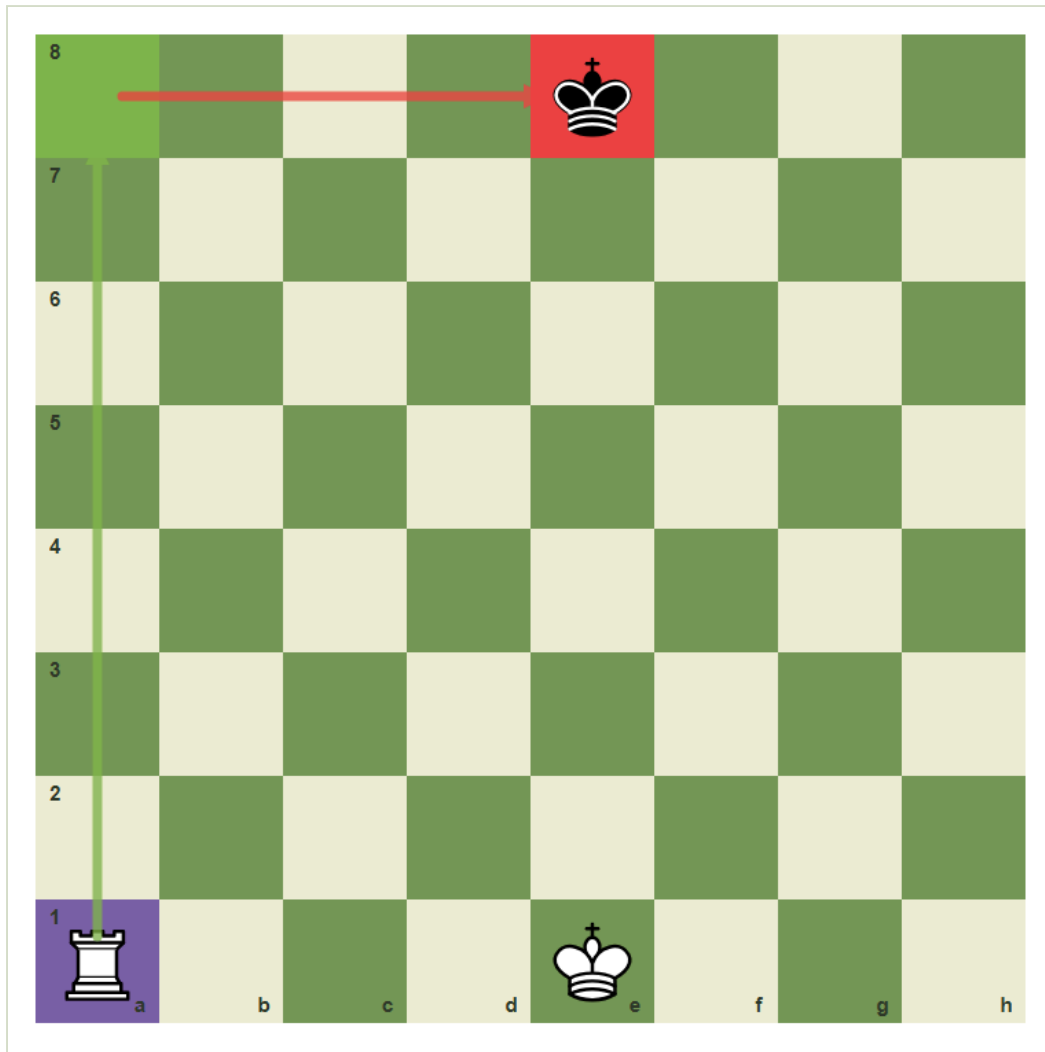
Training Diagram: review position



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

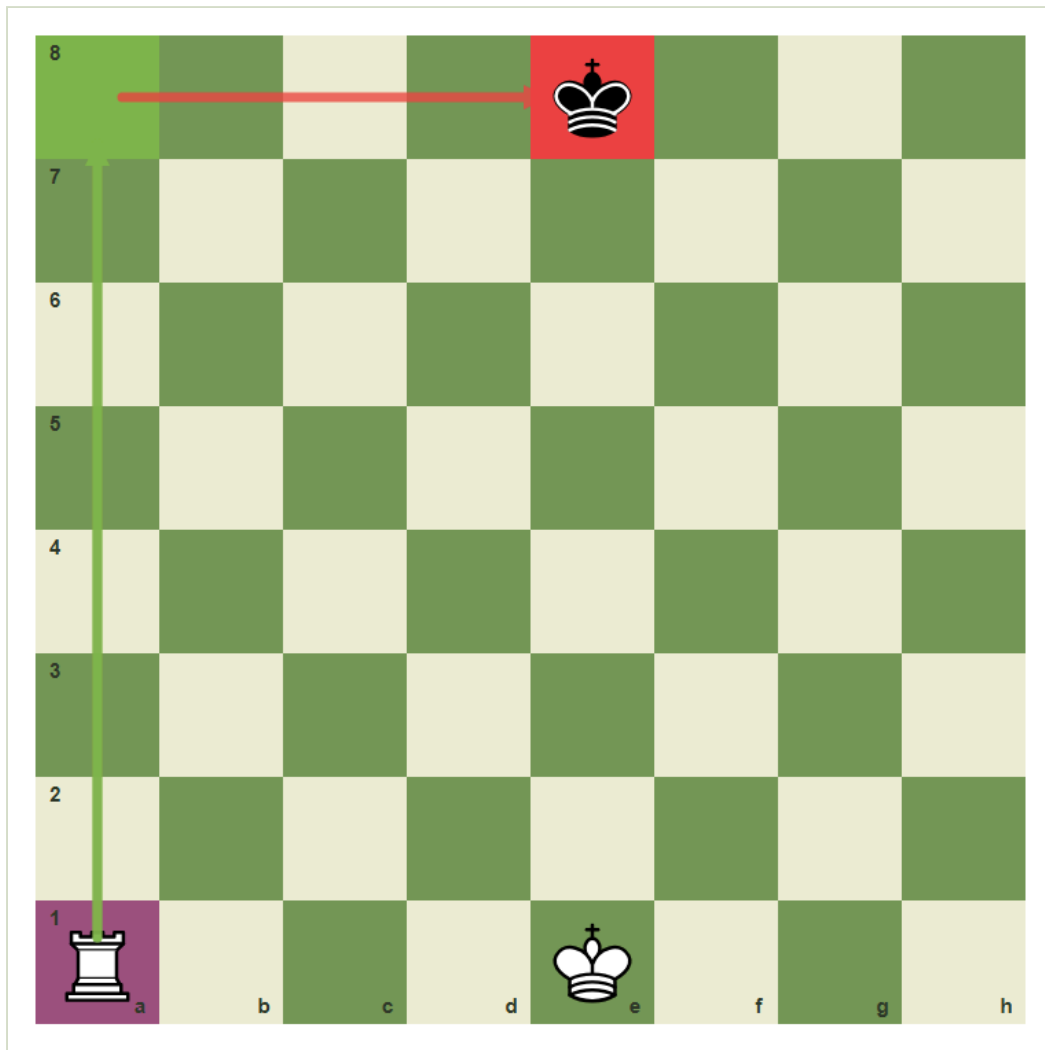
Play the highlighted move from **a1** to **a8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Checks Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **checks**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Checks Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **checks**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Checks Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **checks**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Captures

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Captures converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

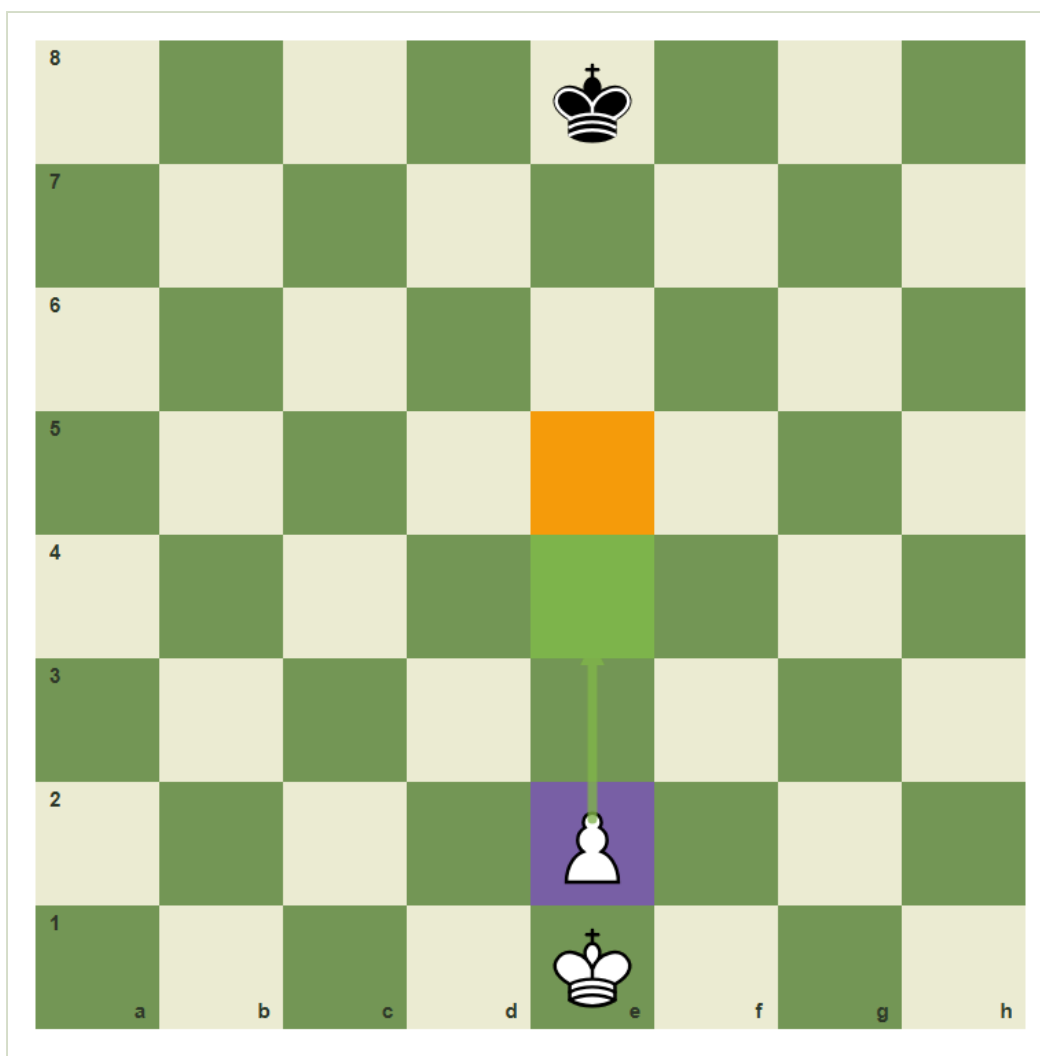
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for captures.
- Choose a move or plan that fits captures.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with captures.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

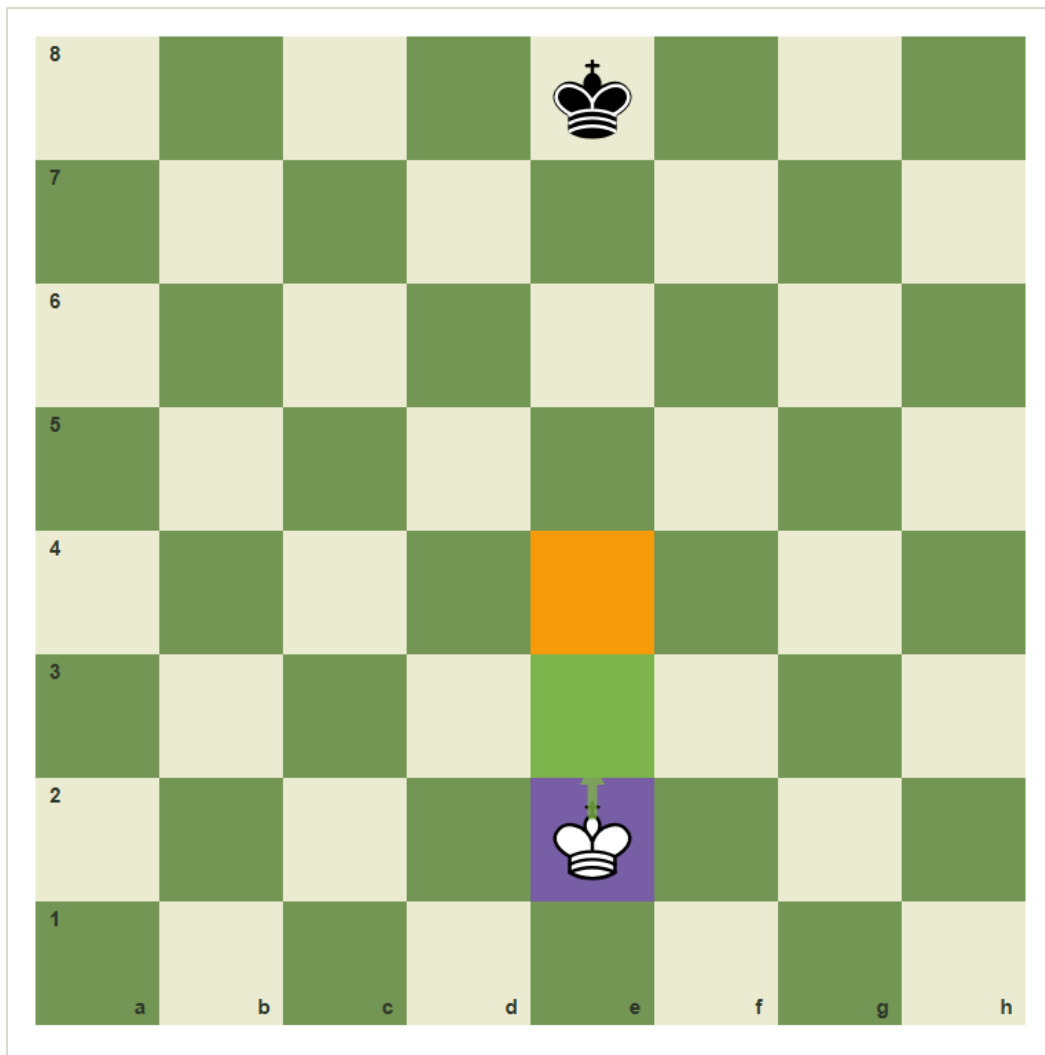
Captures is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

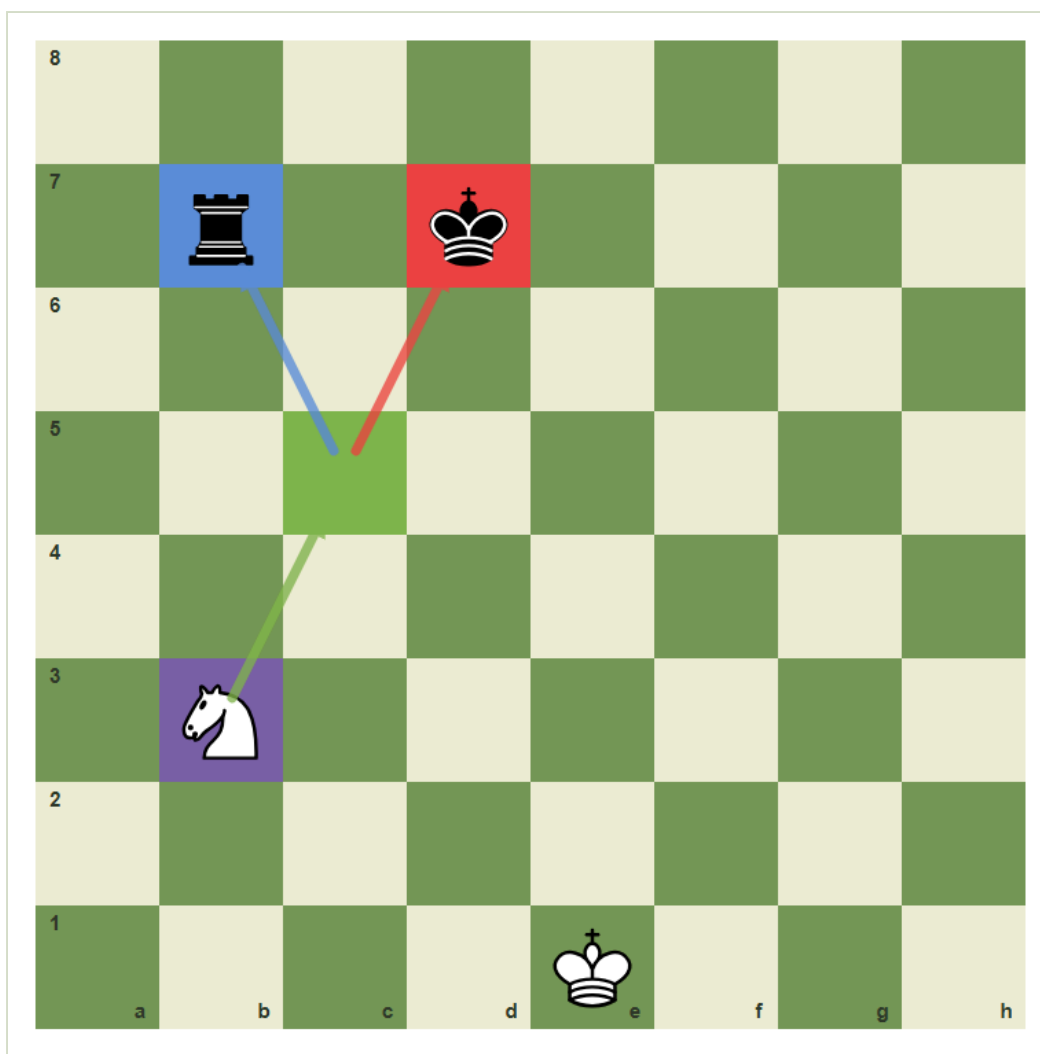


Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

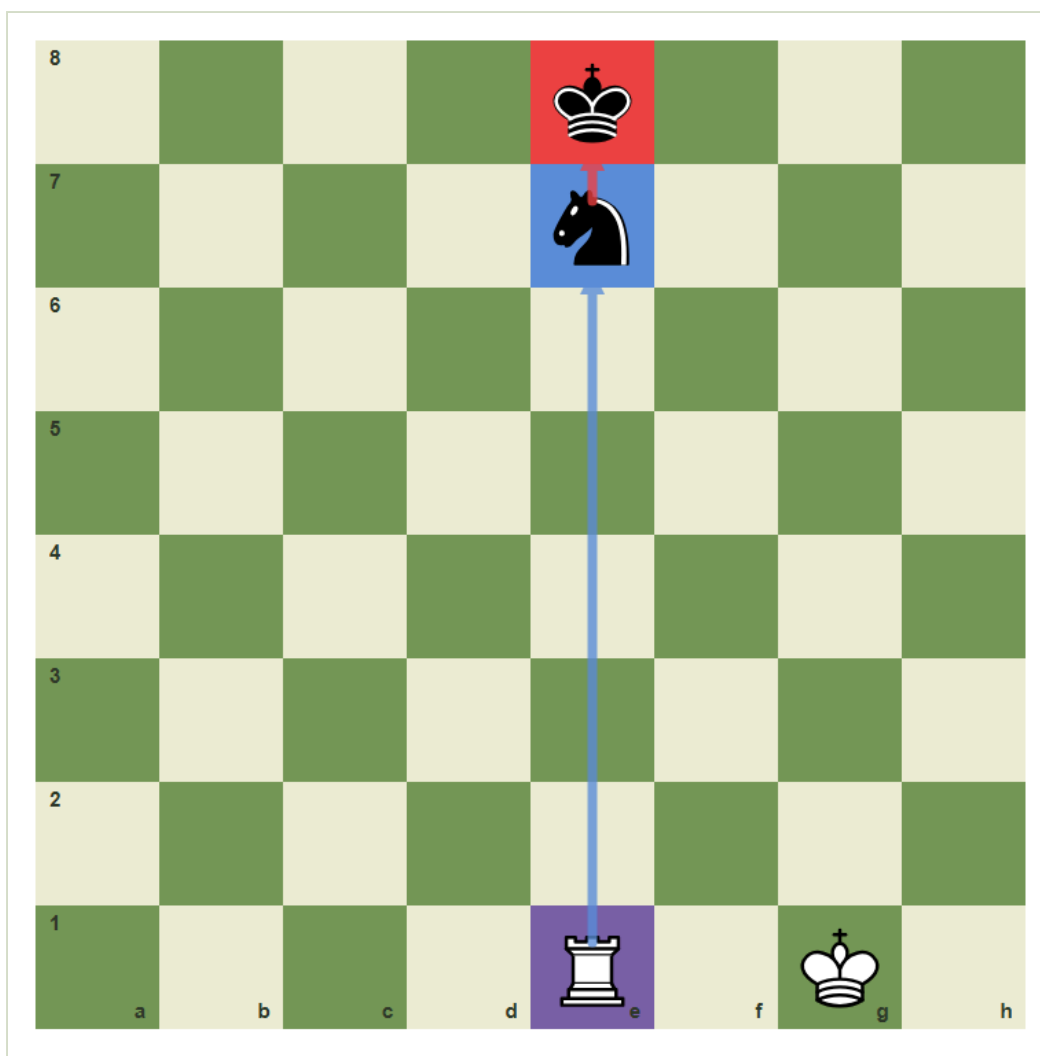
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



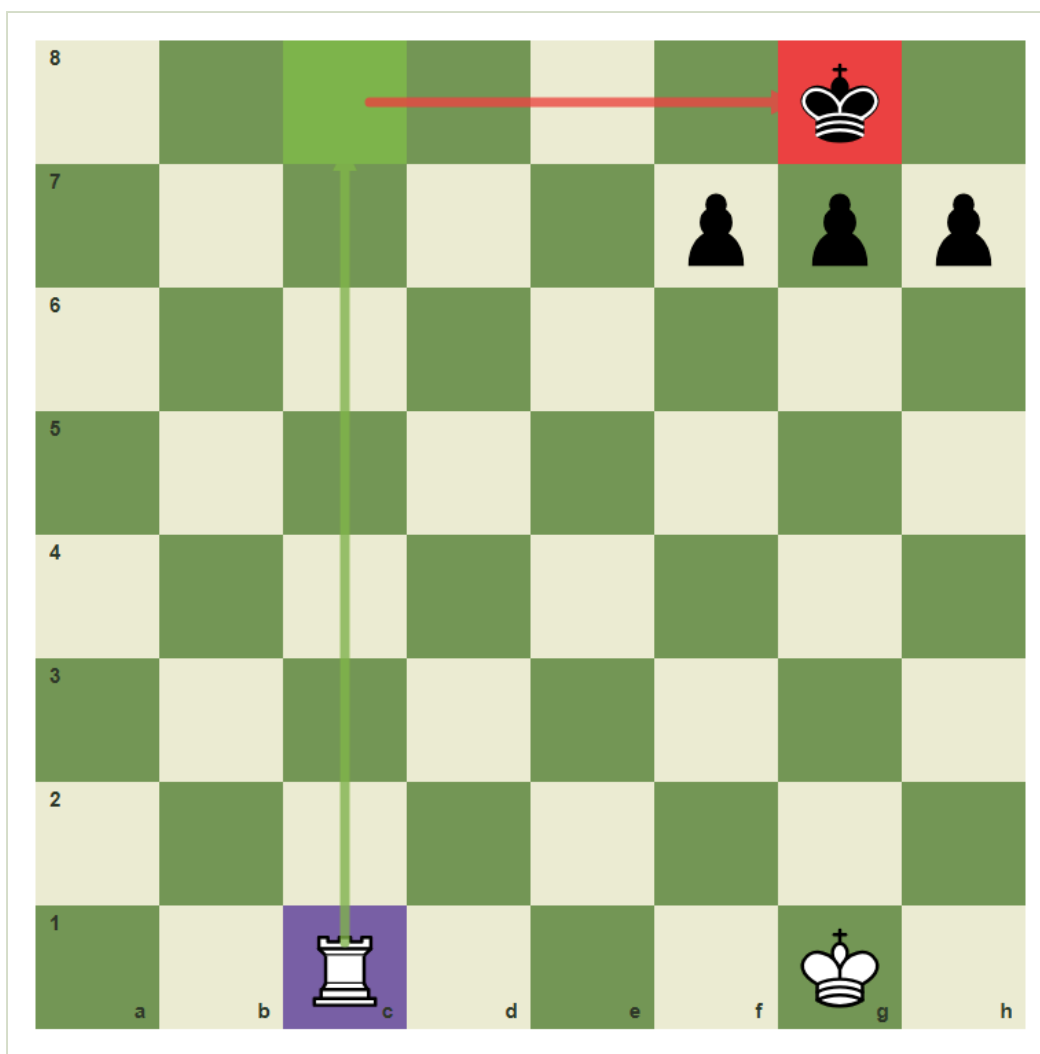
The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

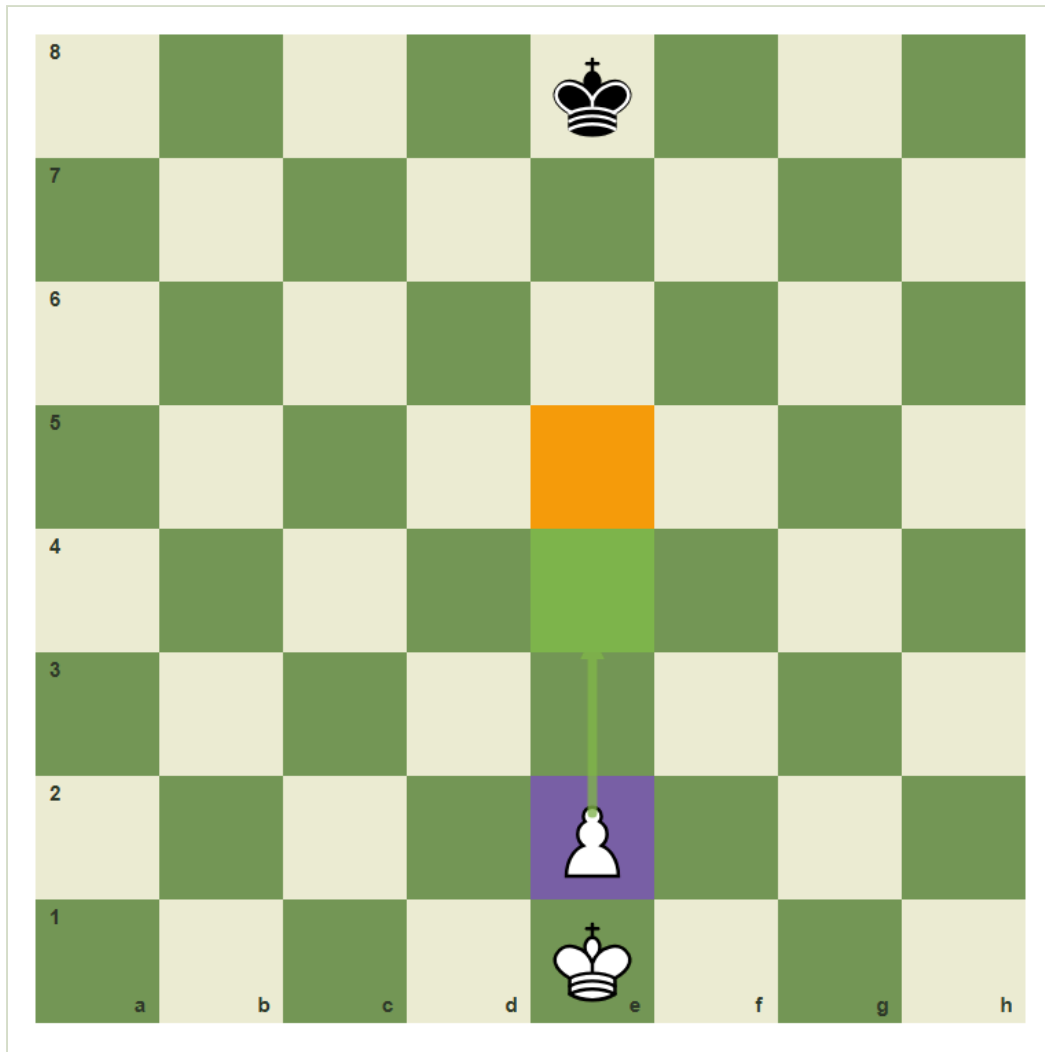
Training Diagram: review position



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

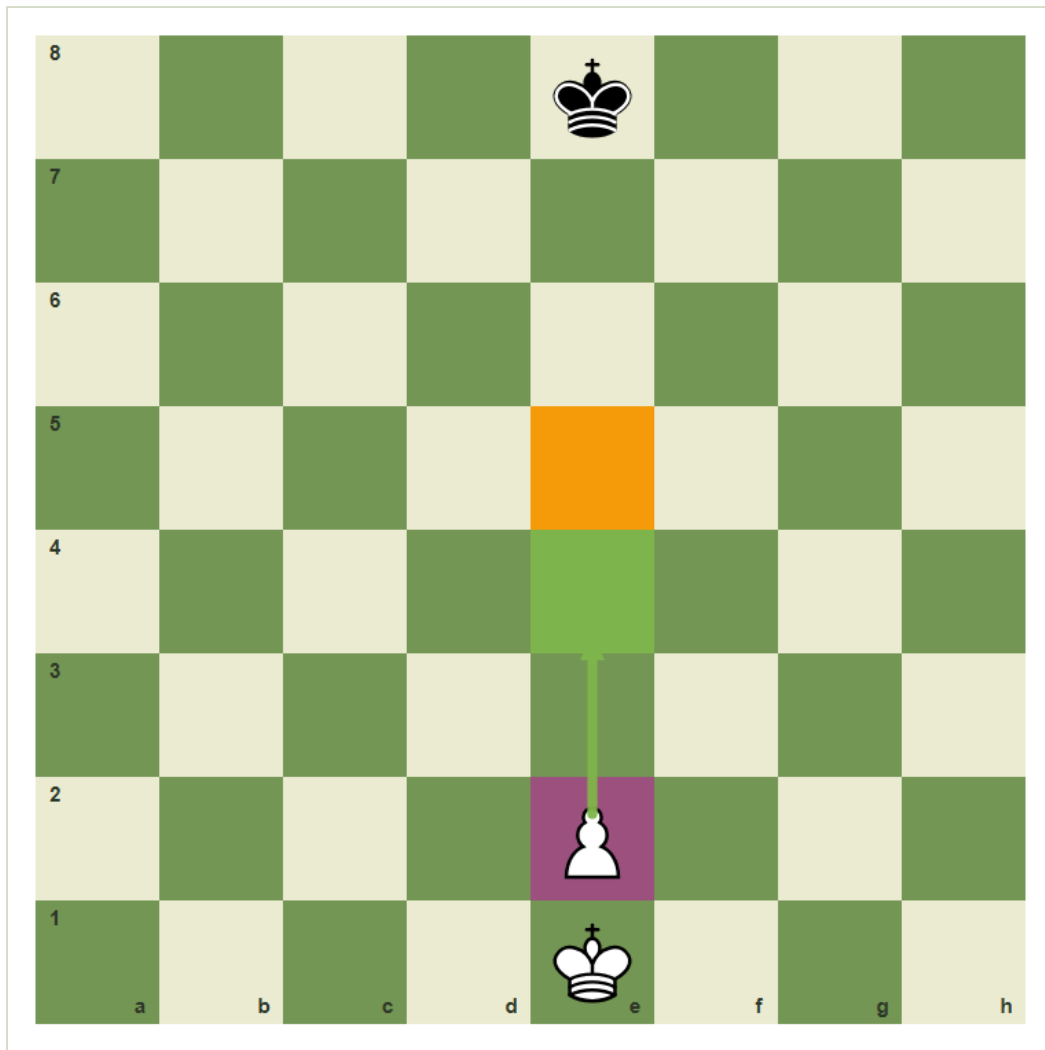
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Captures Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **captures**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Captures Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **captures**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Captures Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **captures**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Threats

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Threats converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

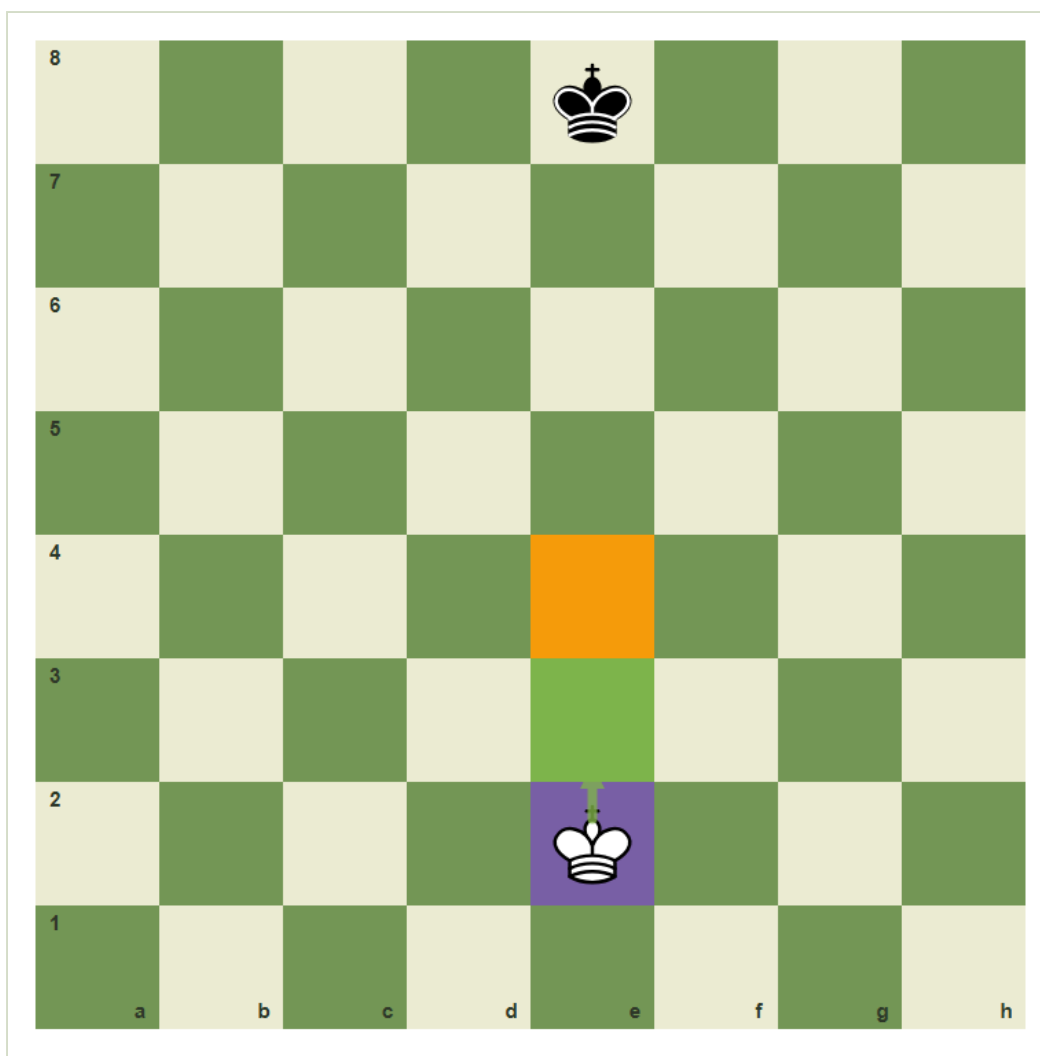
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for threats.
- Choose a move or plan that fits threats.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with threats.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

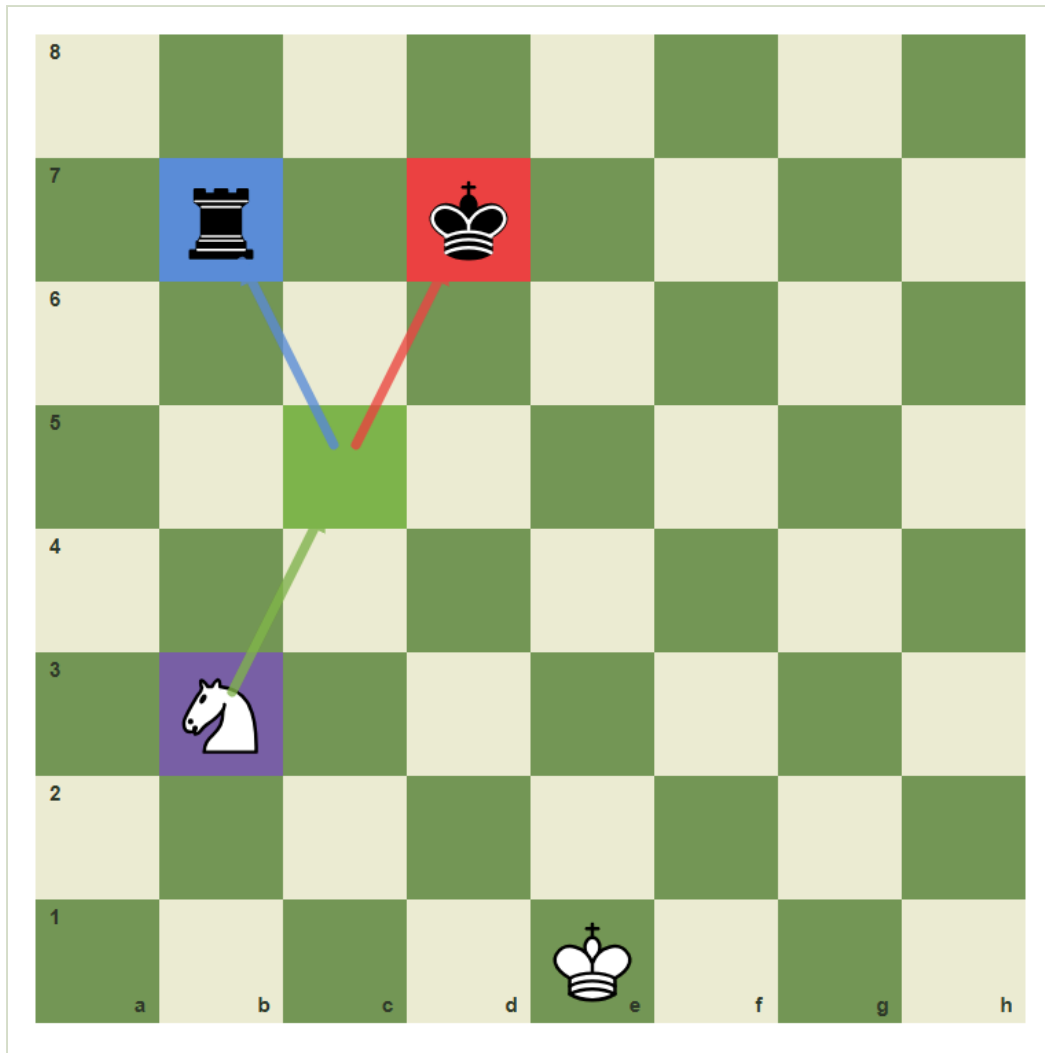
Threats is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

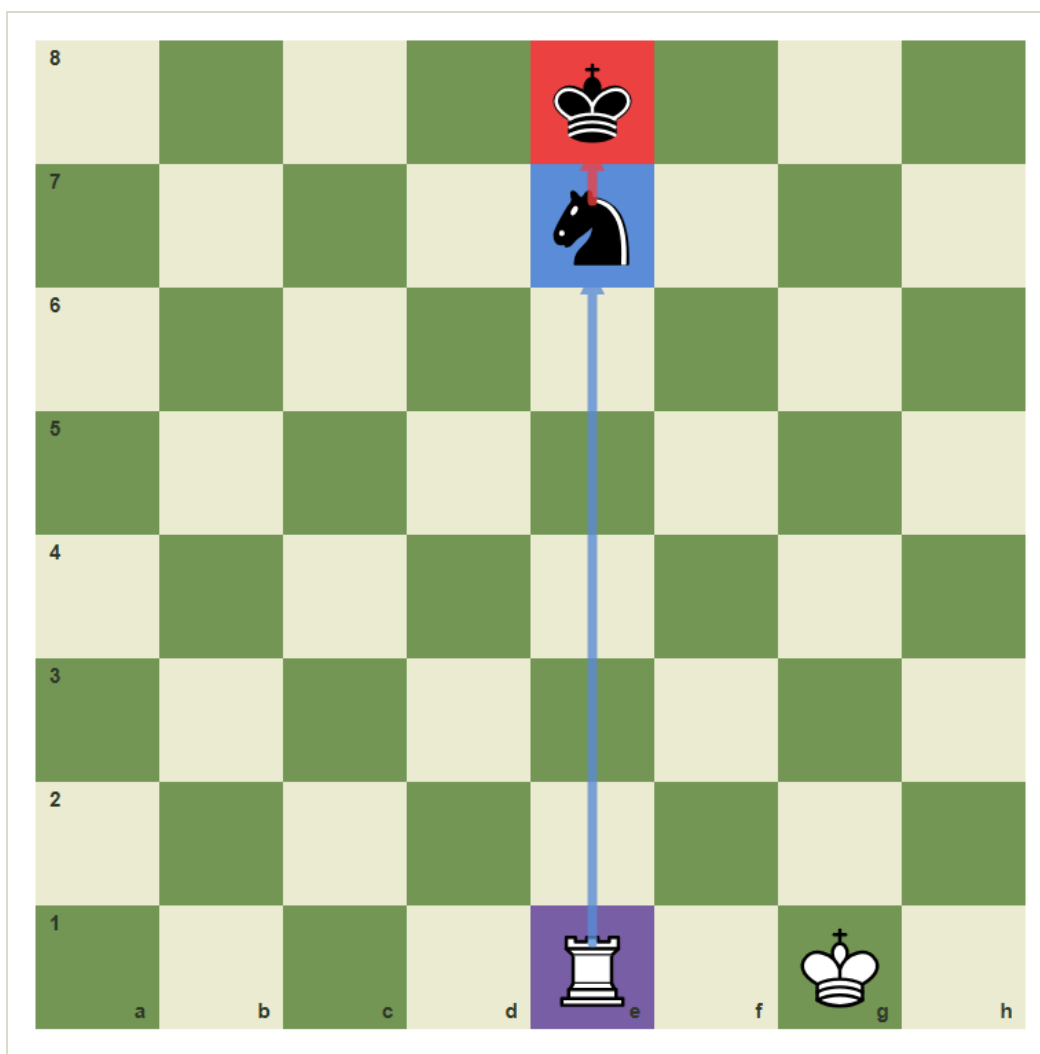


The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

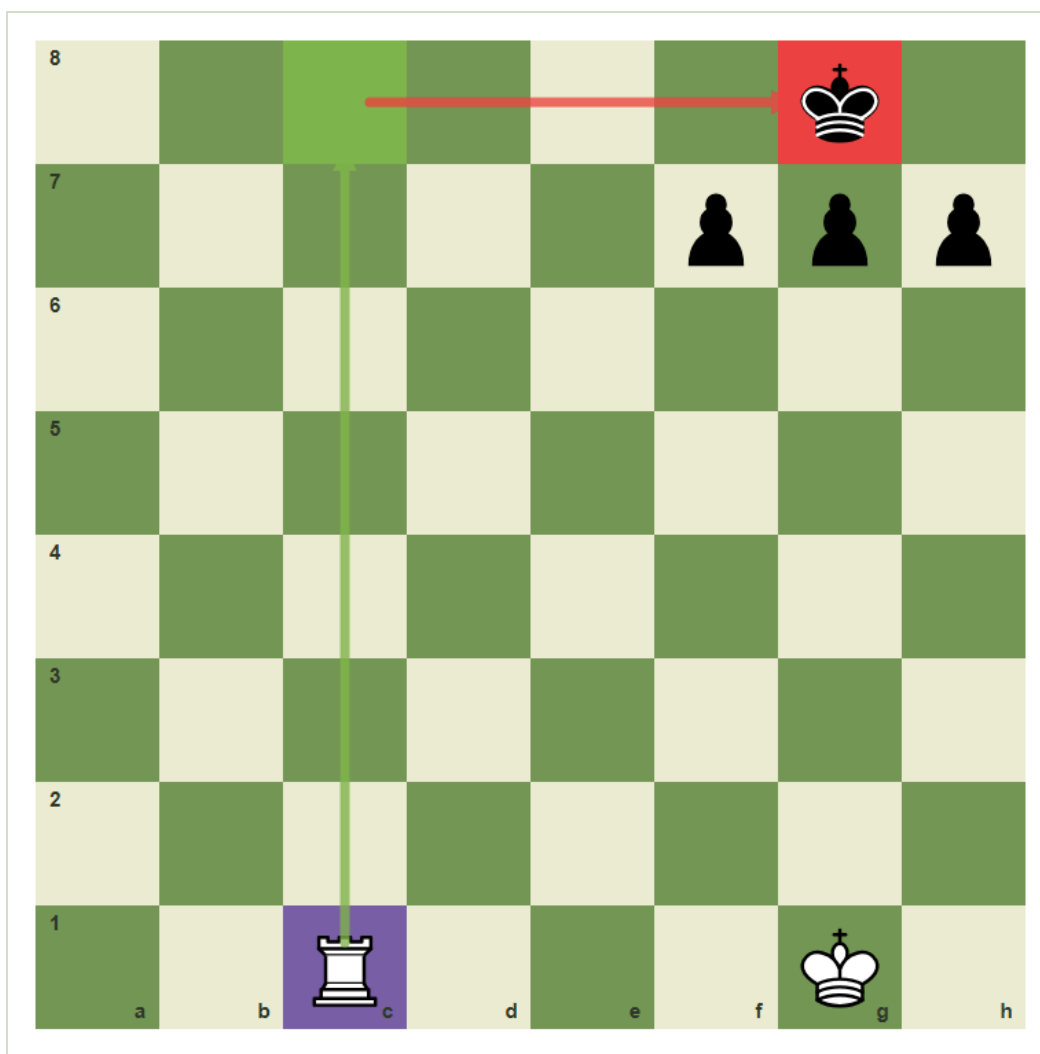
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



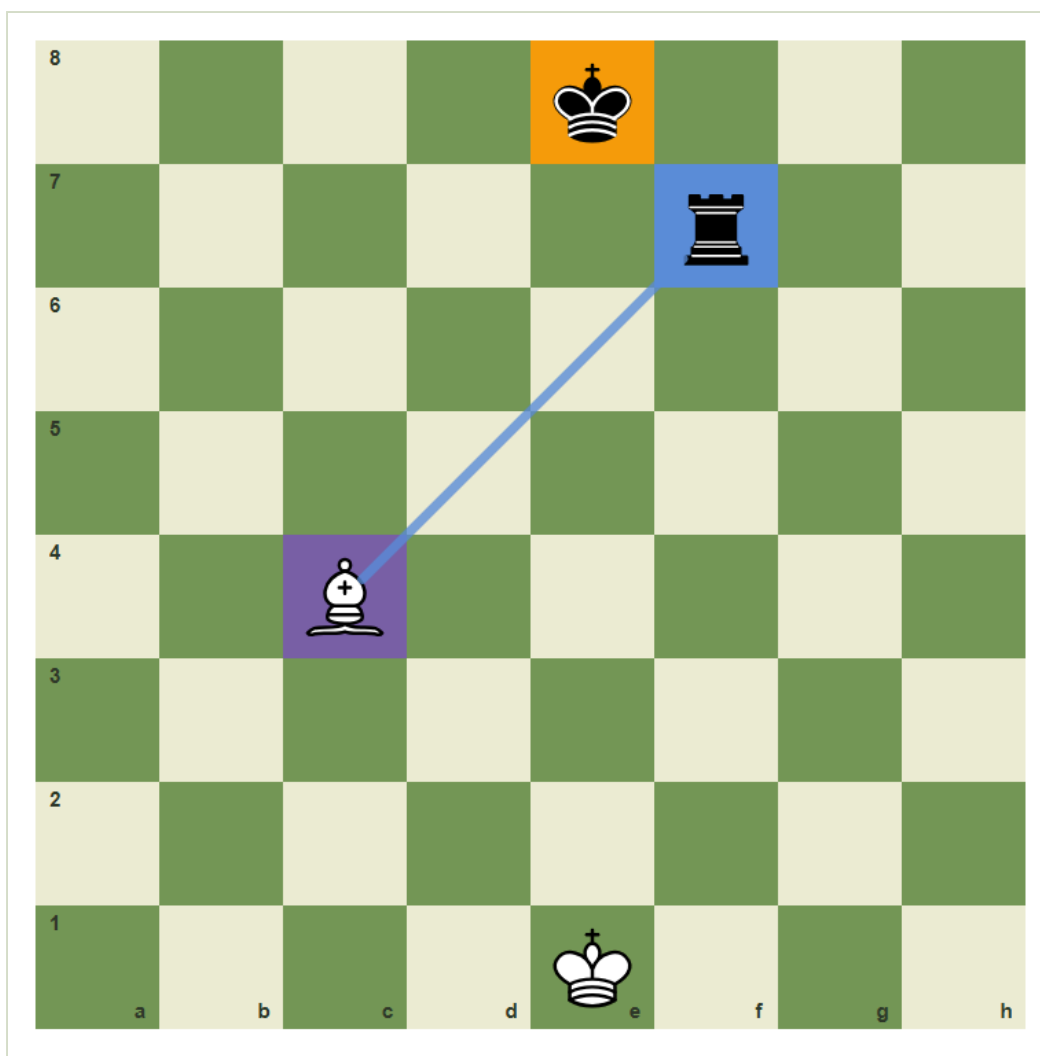
The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

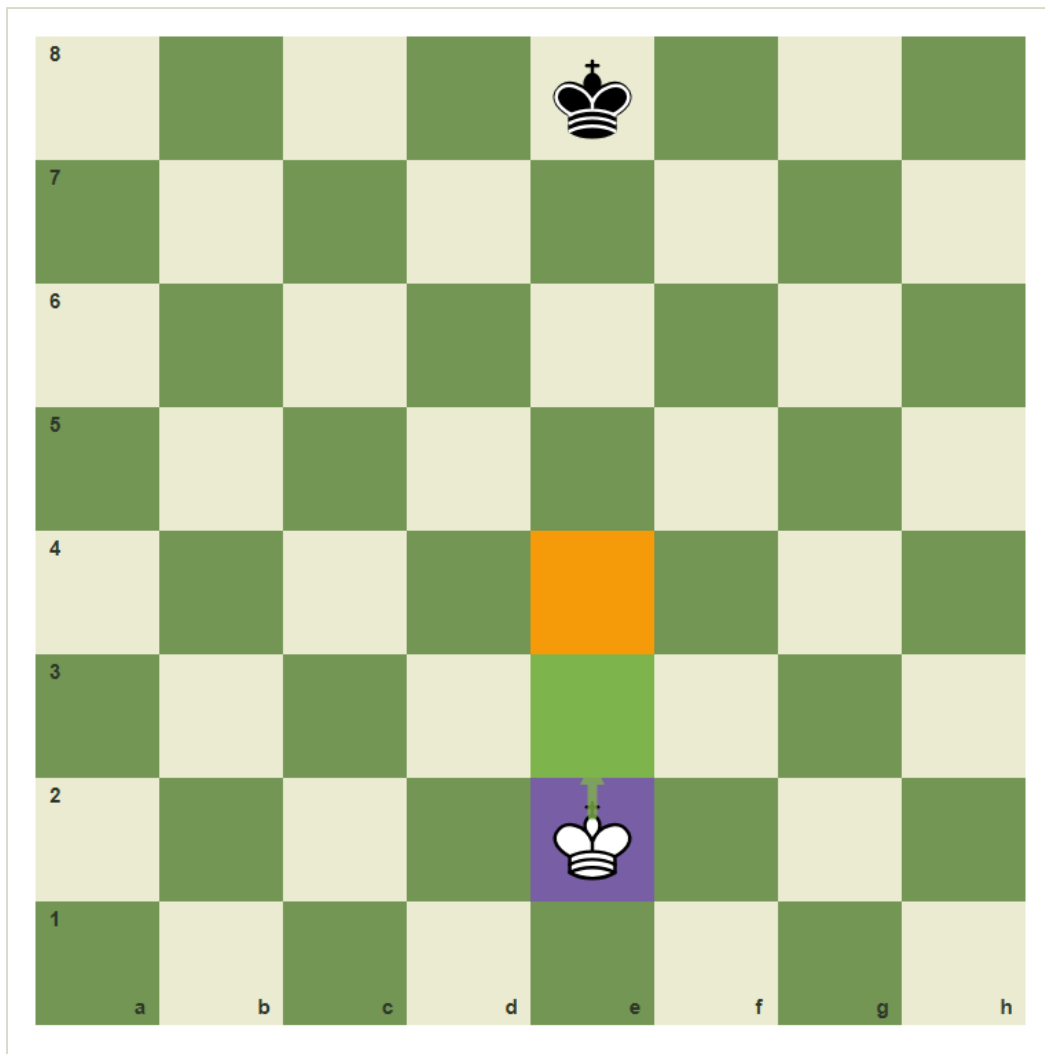
Training Diagram: review position



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

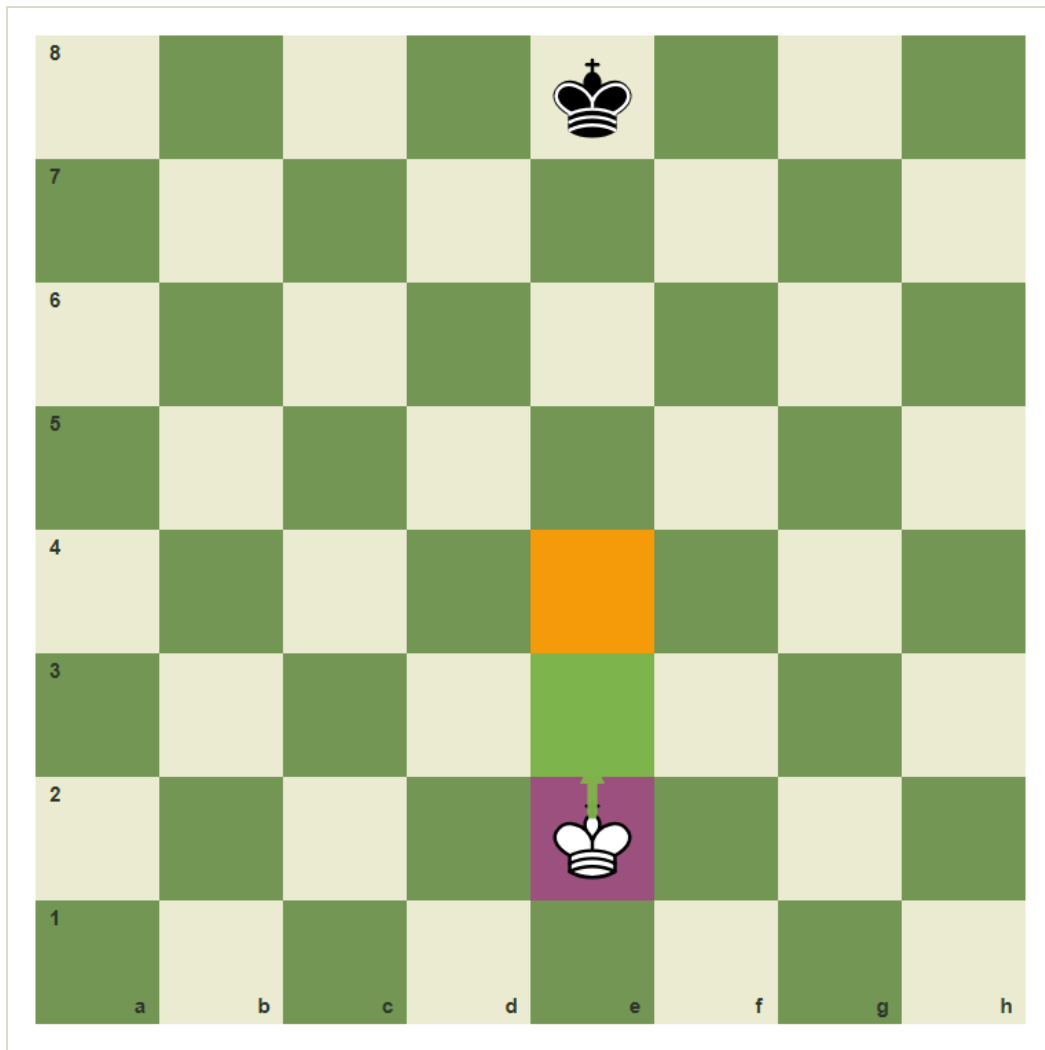
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e3**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Threats Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **threats**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Threats Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **threats**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Threats Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **threats**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opponent Best Reply

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Opponent Best Reply converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

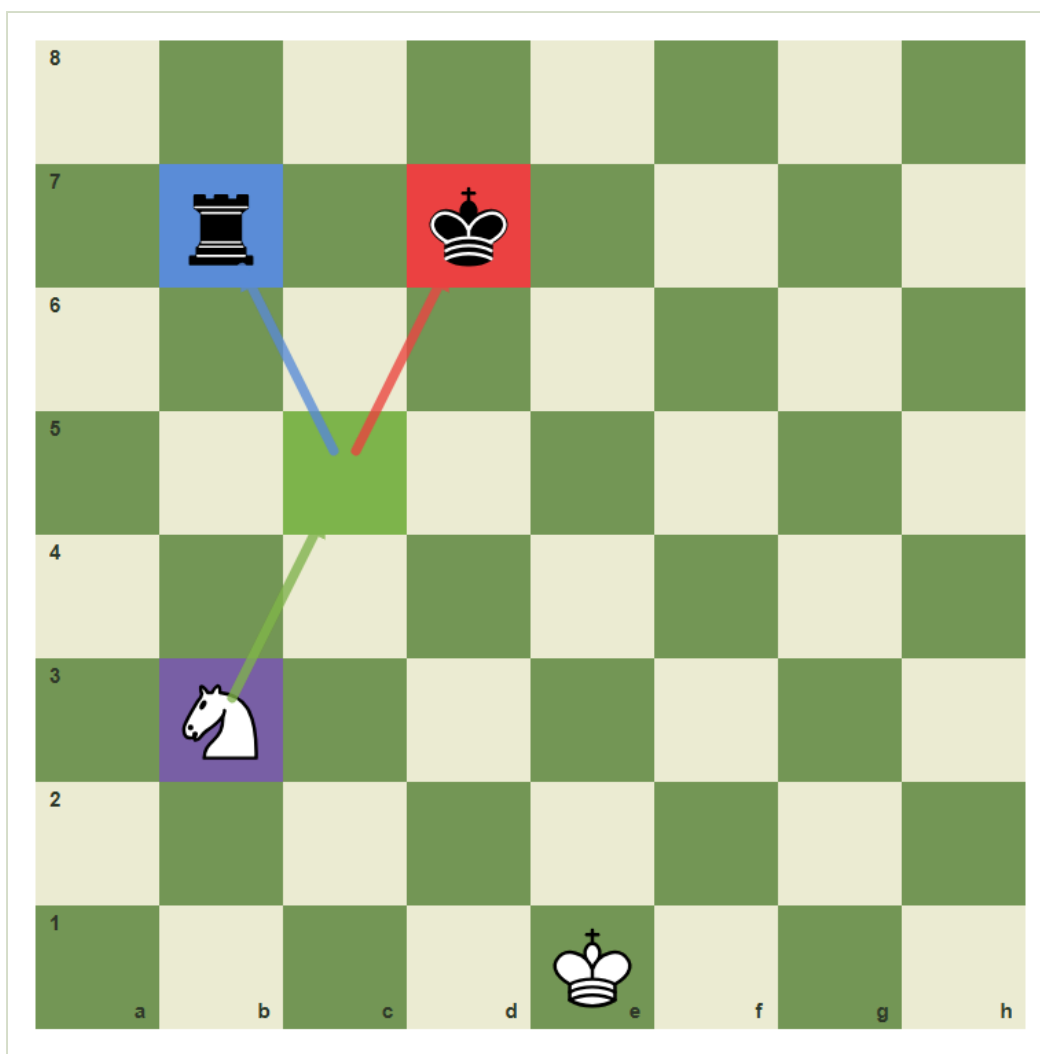
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for opponent best reply.
- Choose a move or plan that fits opponent best reply.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with opponent best reply.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

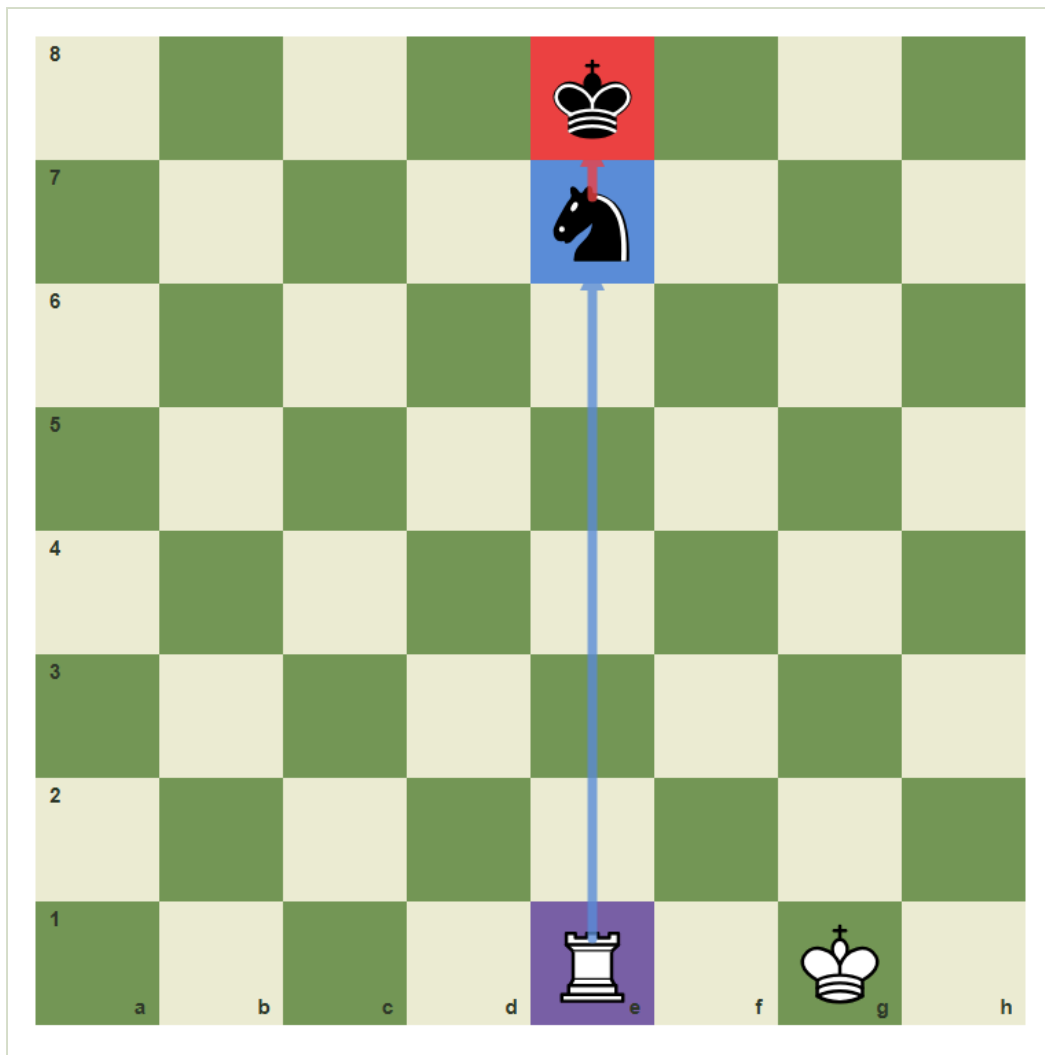
Opponent Best Reply is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

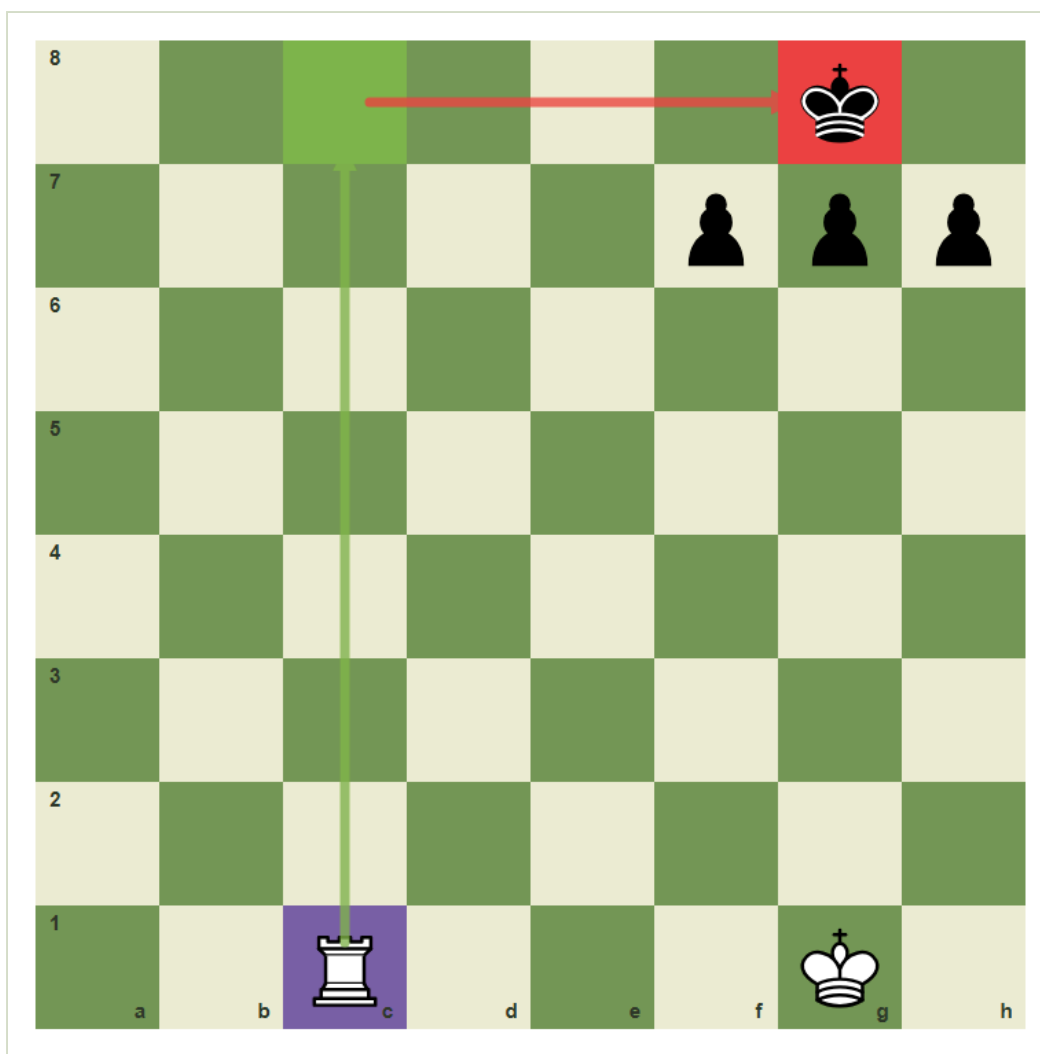


The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

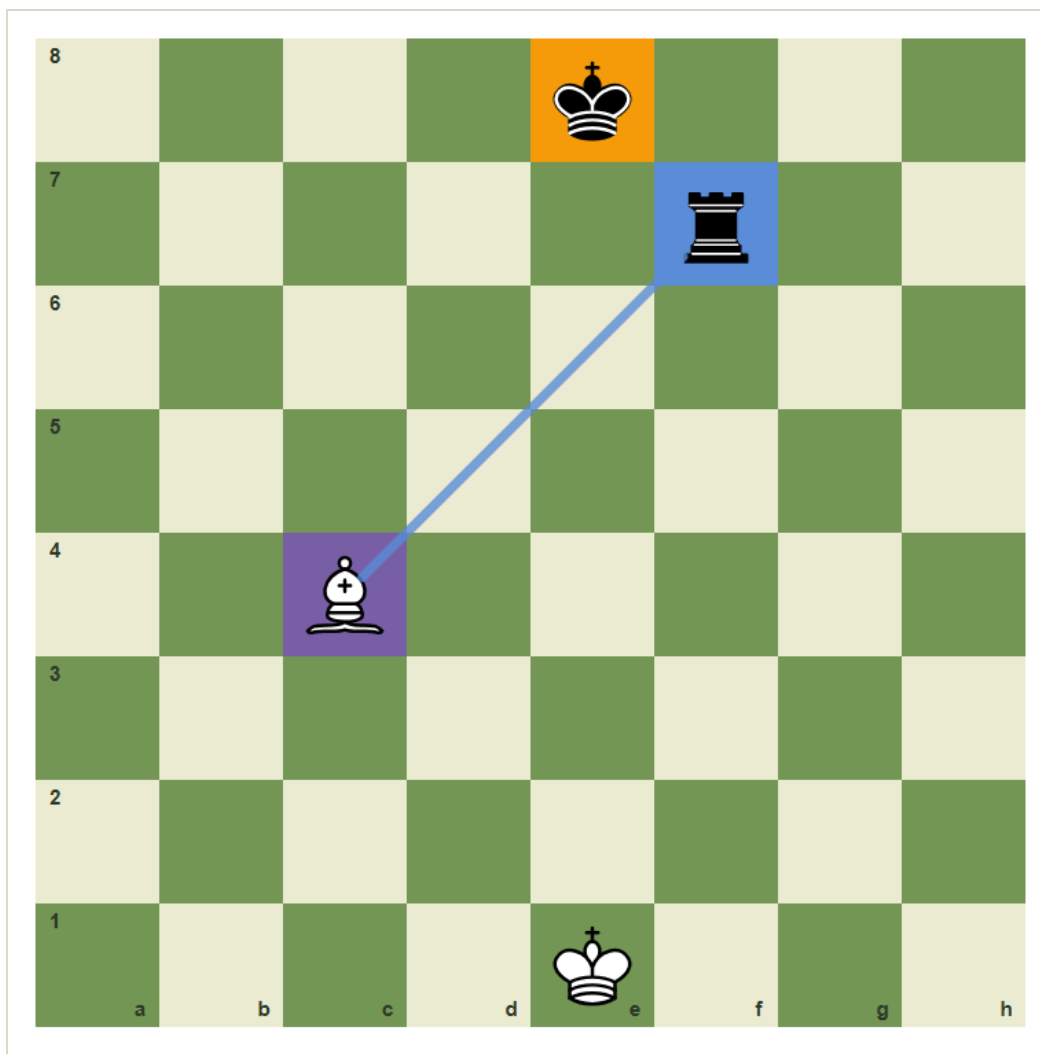
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



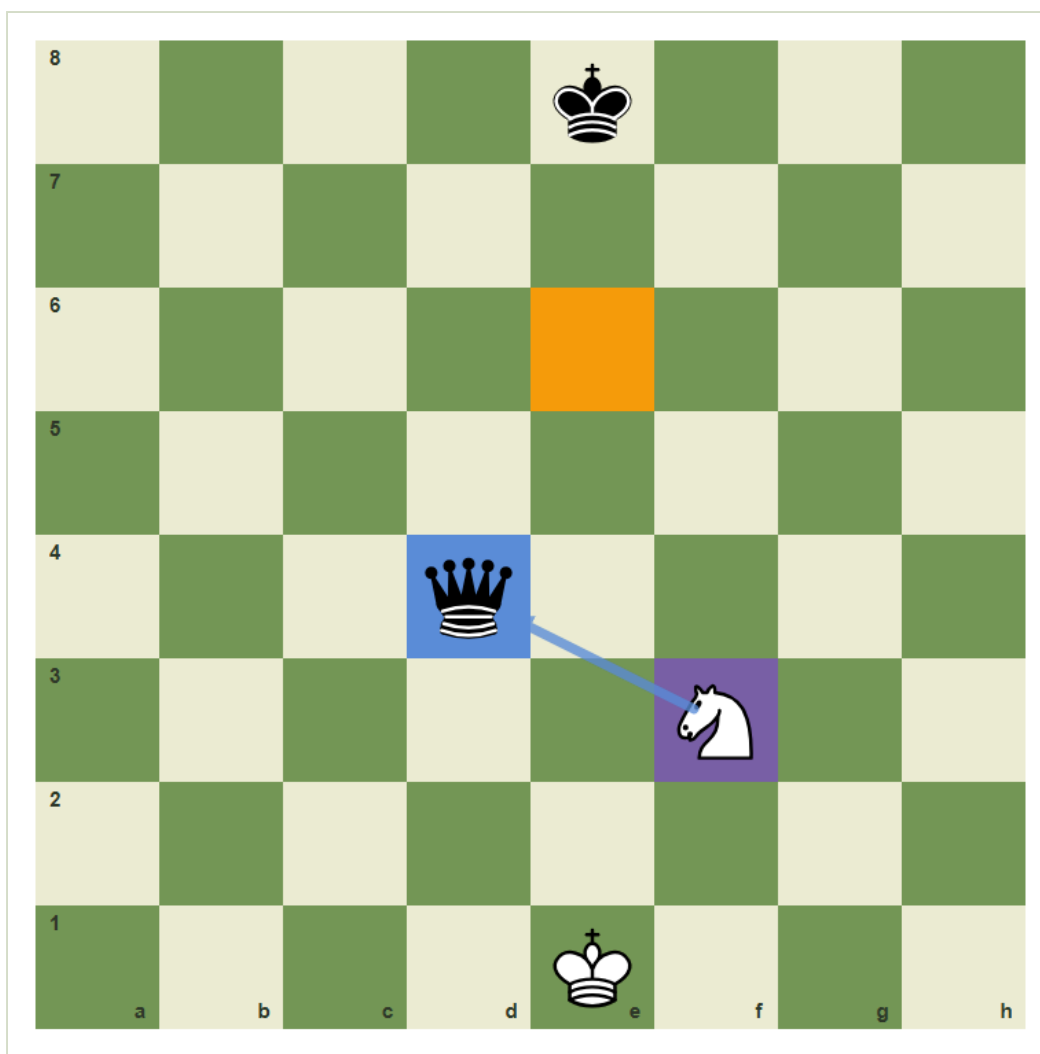
A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

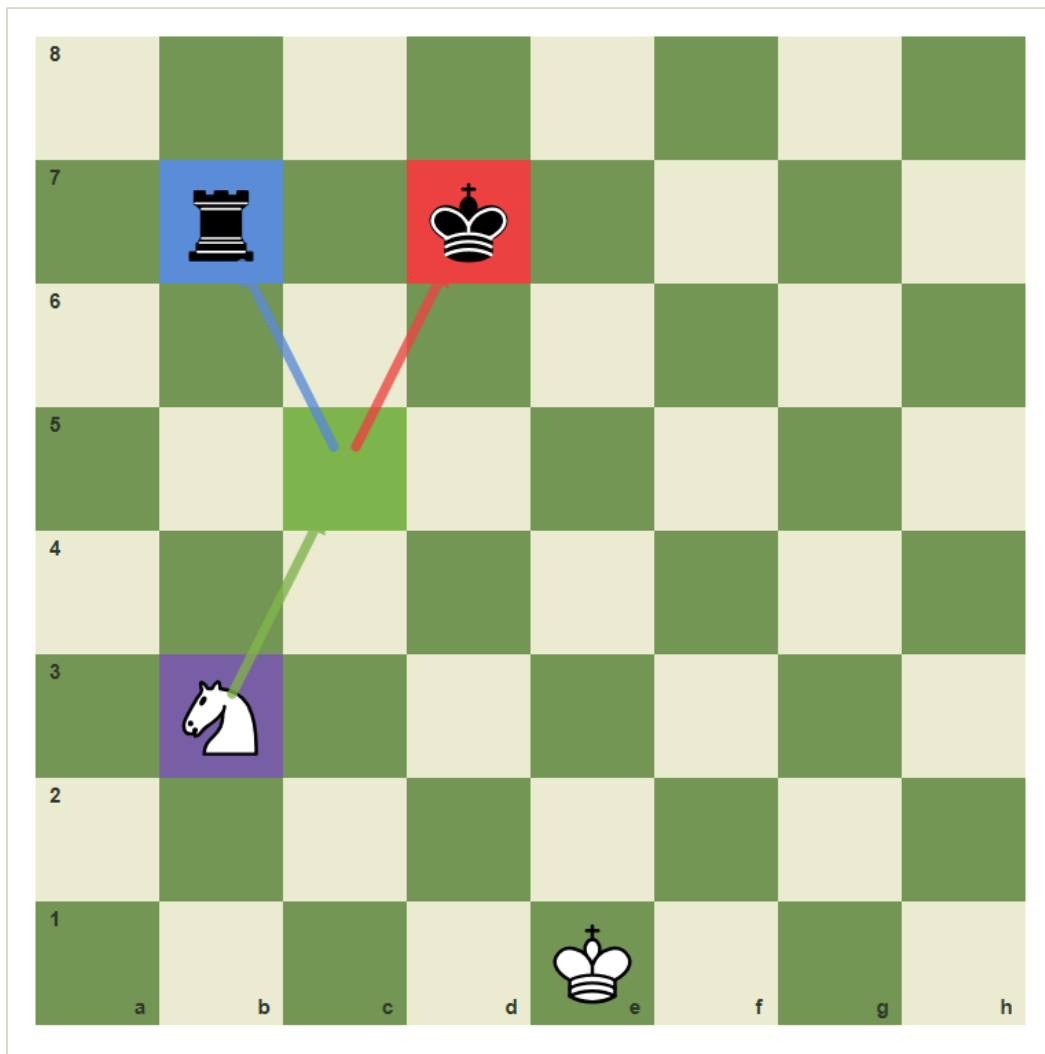
Training Diagram: review position



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

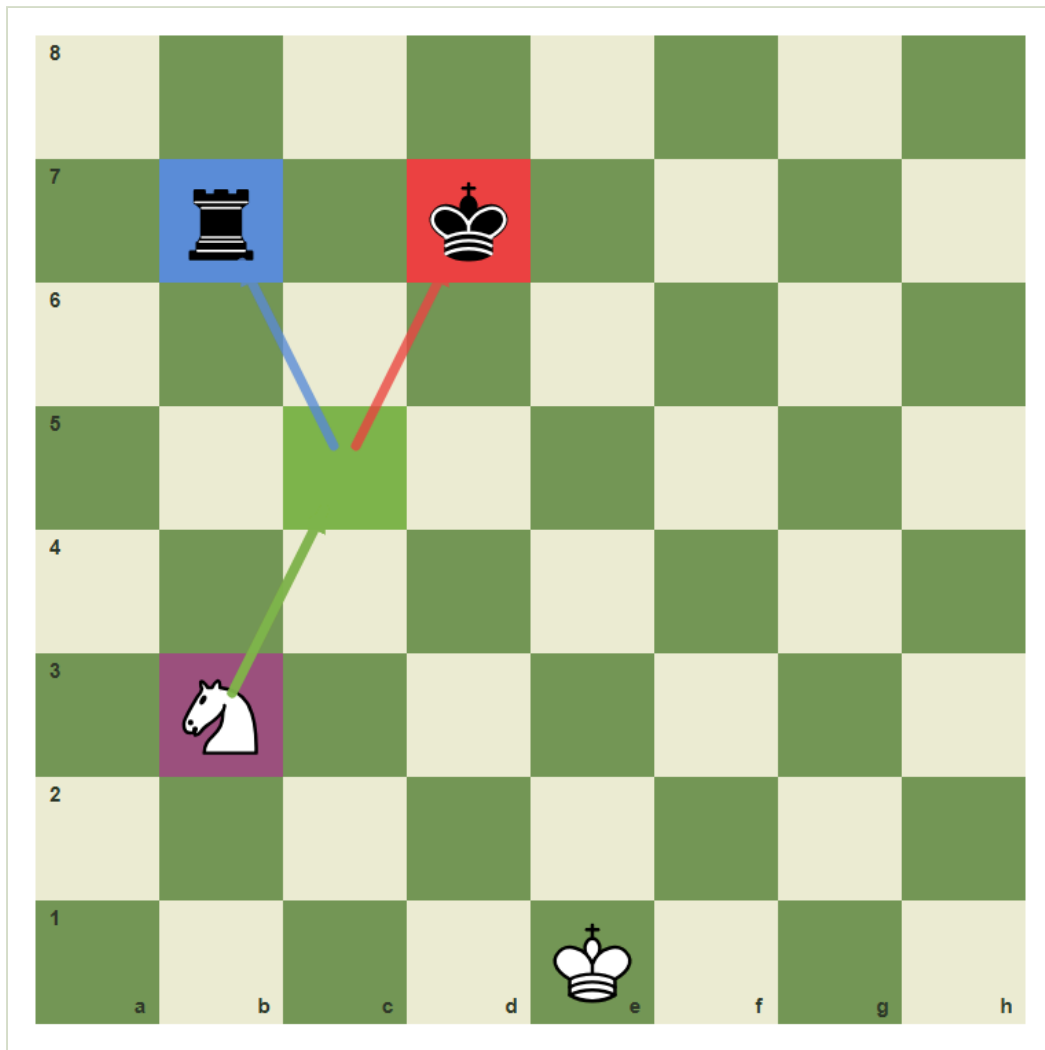
Play the highlighted move from **b3** to **c5**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Opponent Best Reply Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **opponent best reply**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opponent Best Reply Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **opponent best reply**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Opponent Best Reply Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **opponent best reply**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

One Move Deeper

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

One Move Deeper converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

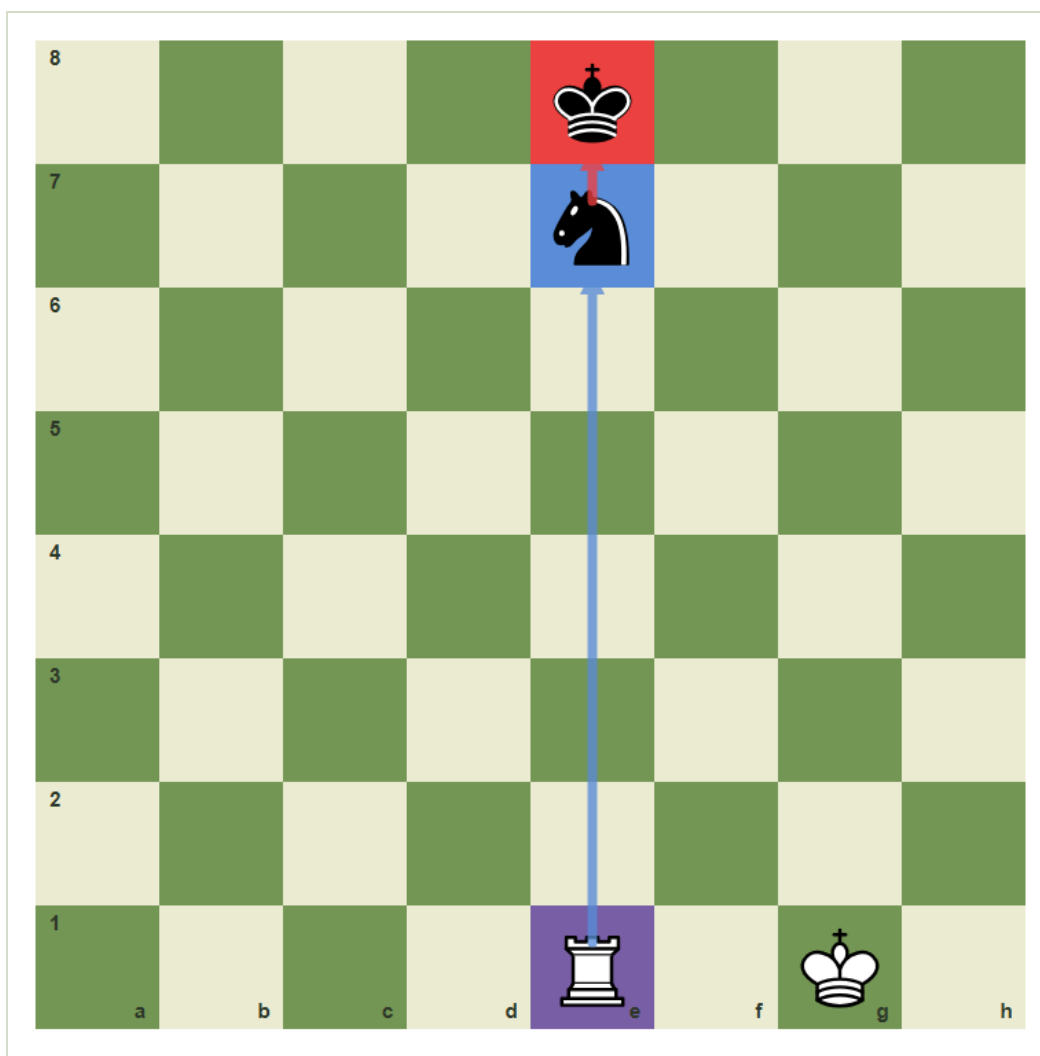
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for one move deeper.
- Choose a move or plan that fits one move deeper.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with one move deeper.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

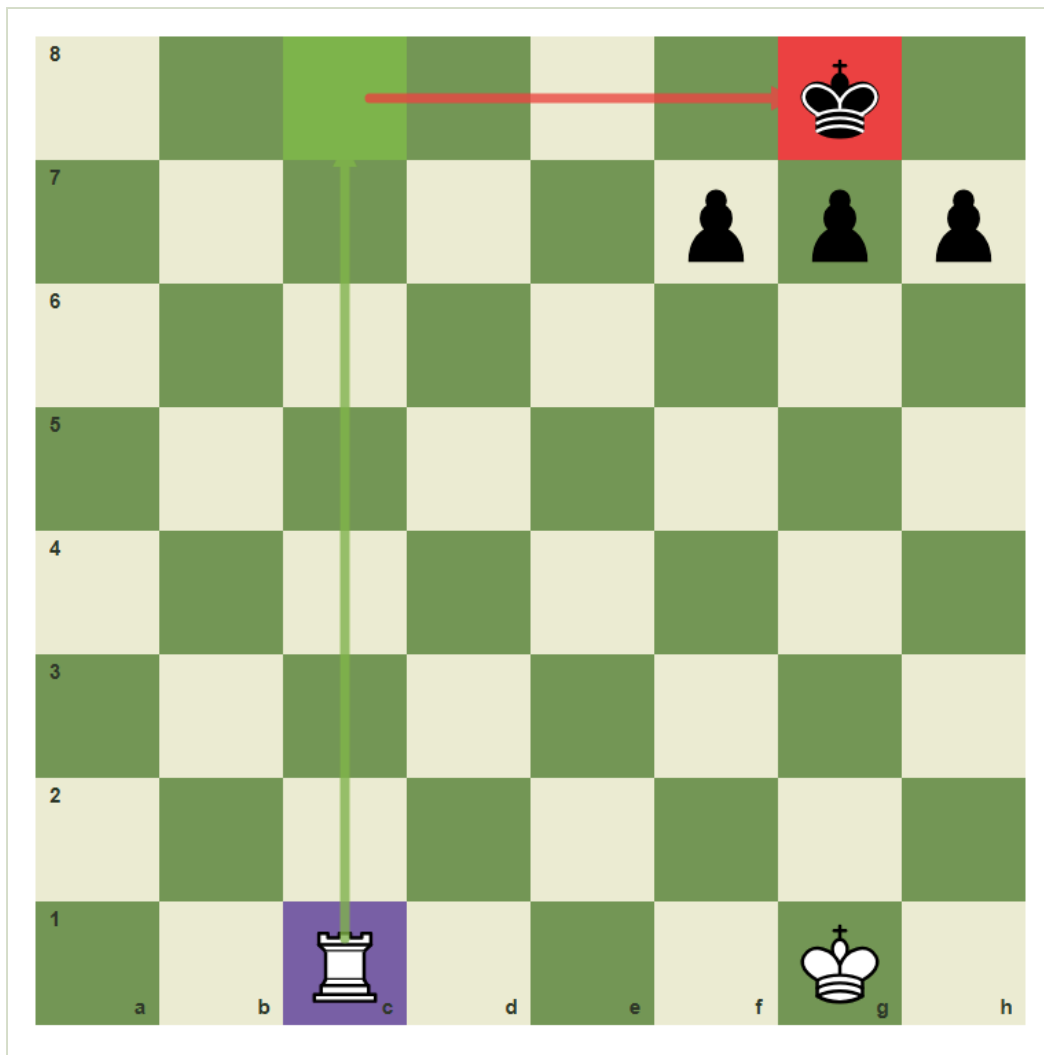
One Move Deeper is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

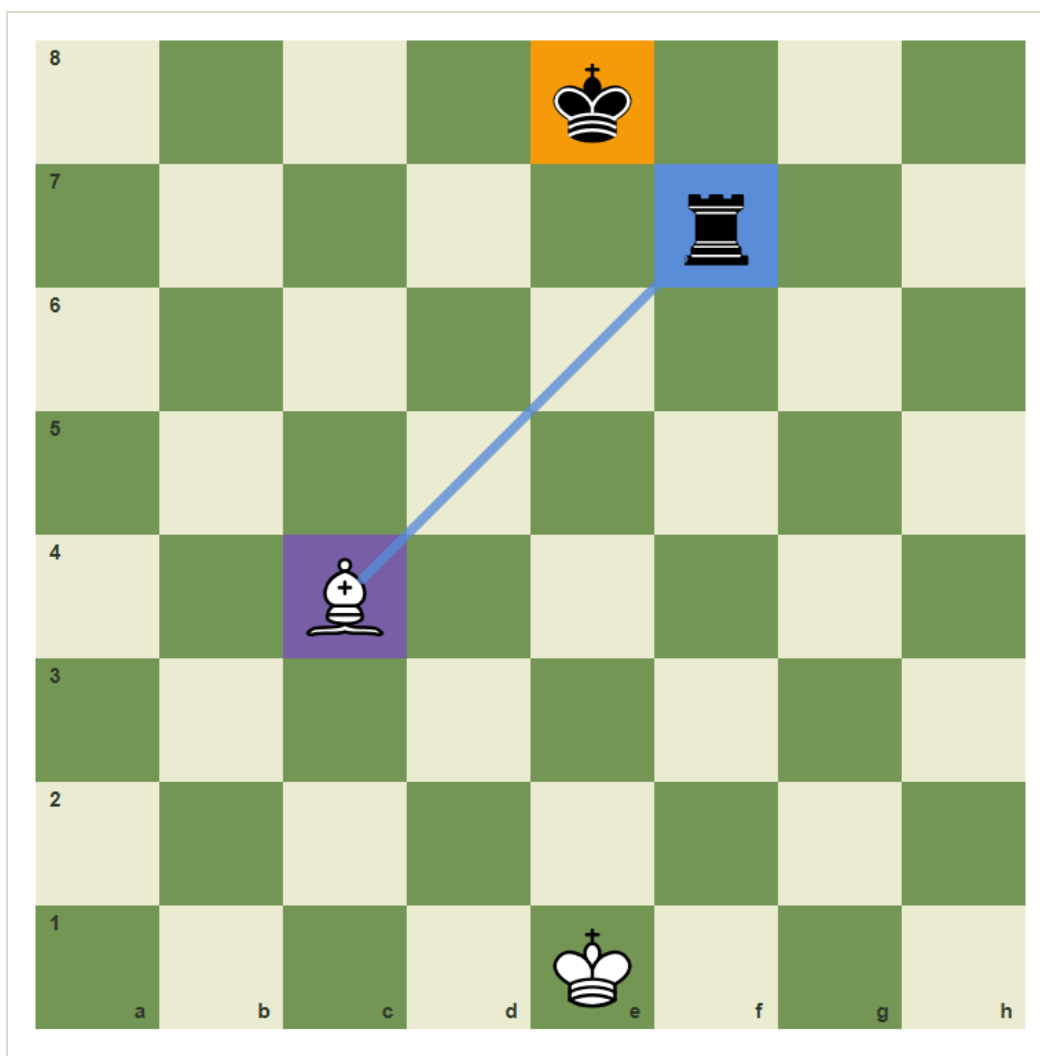


A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

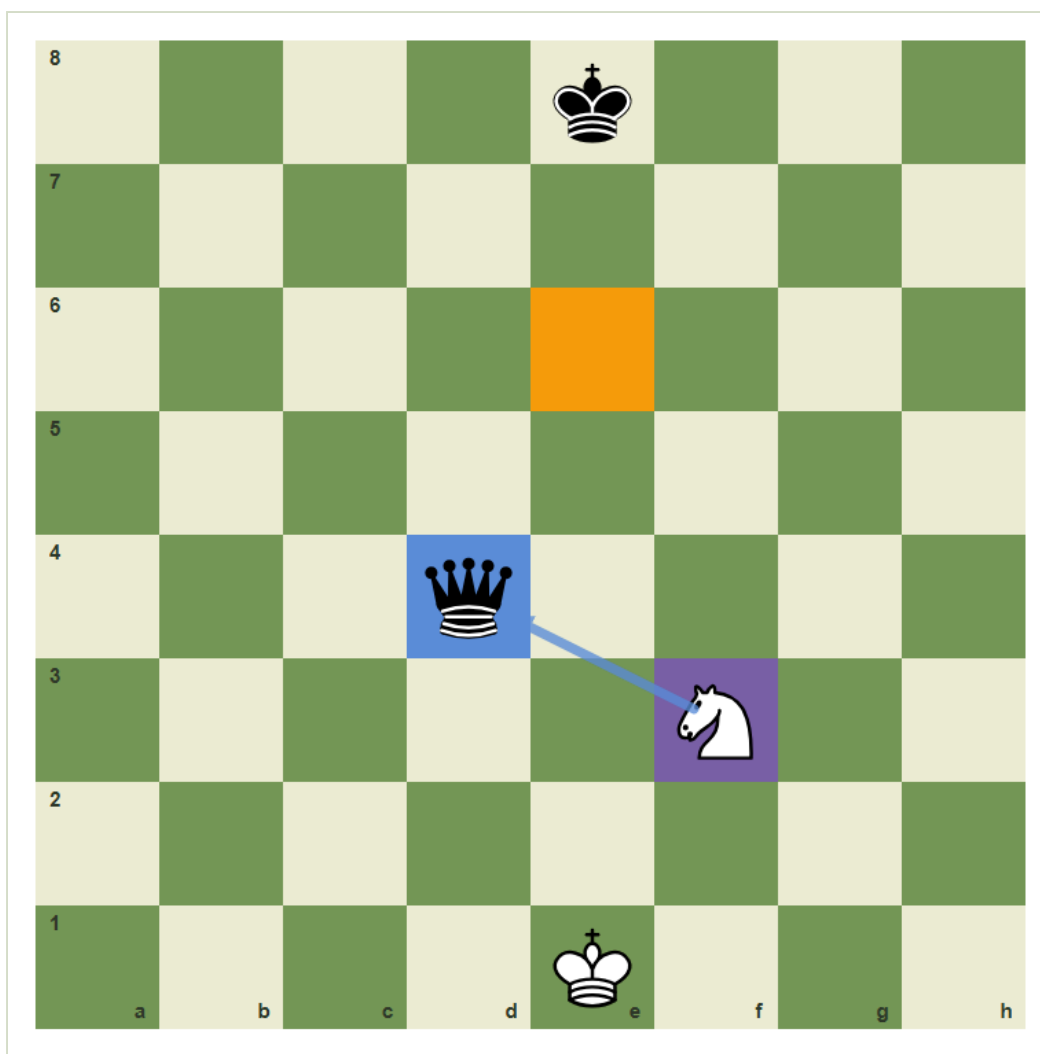
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



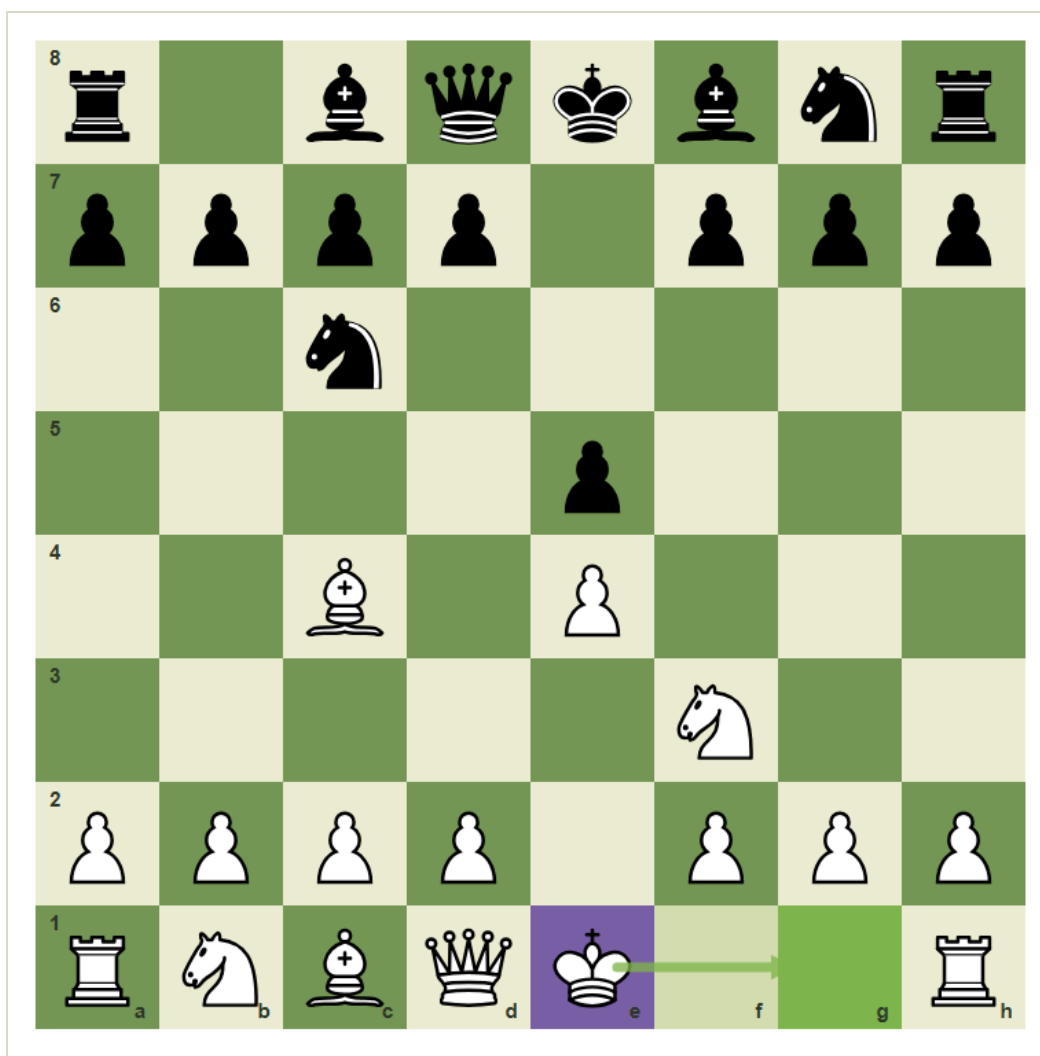
The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

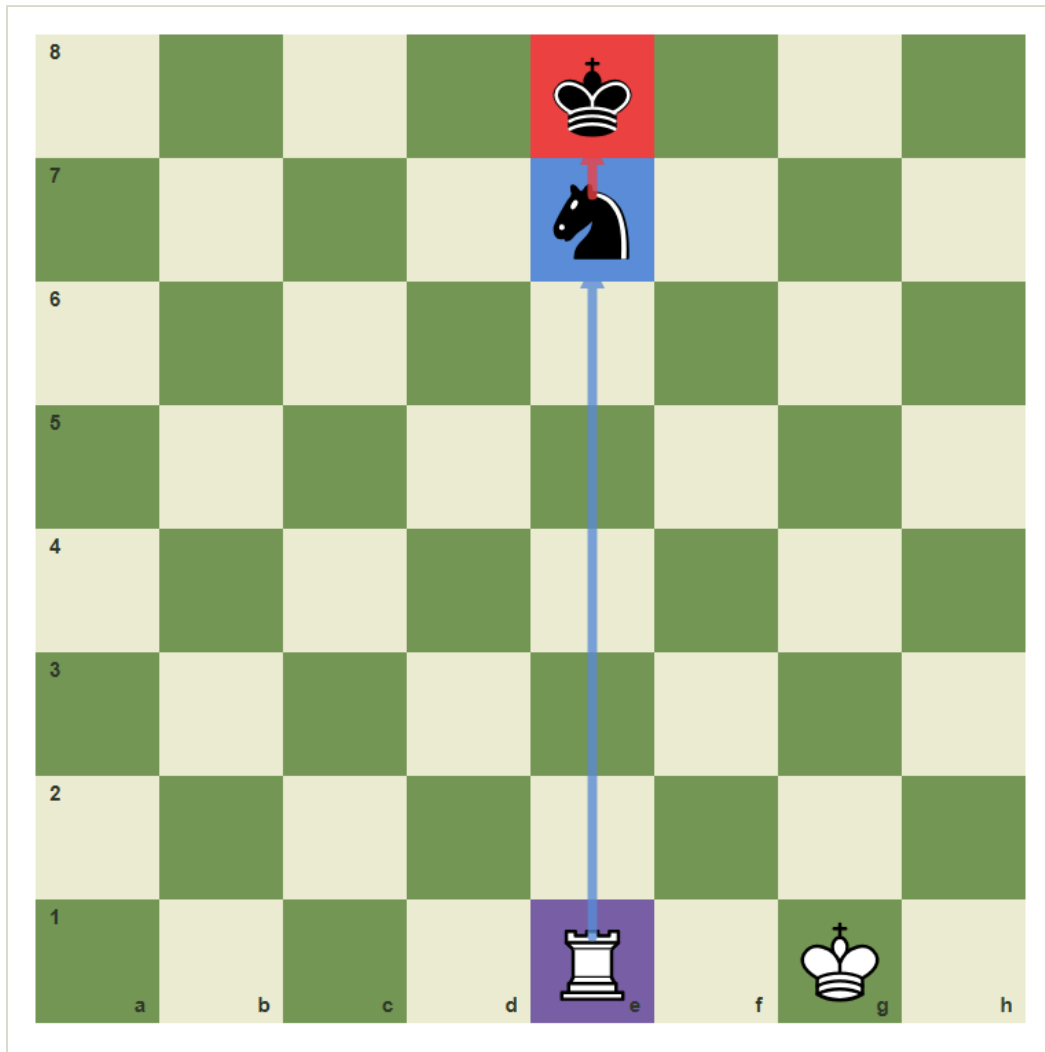
Training Diagram: review position



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

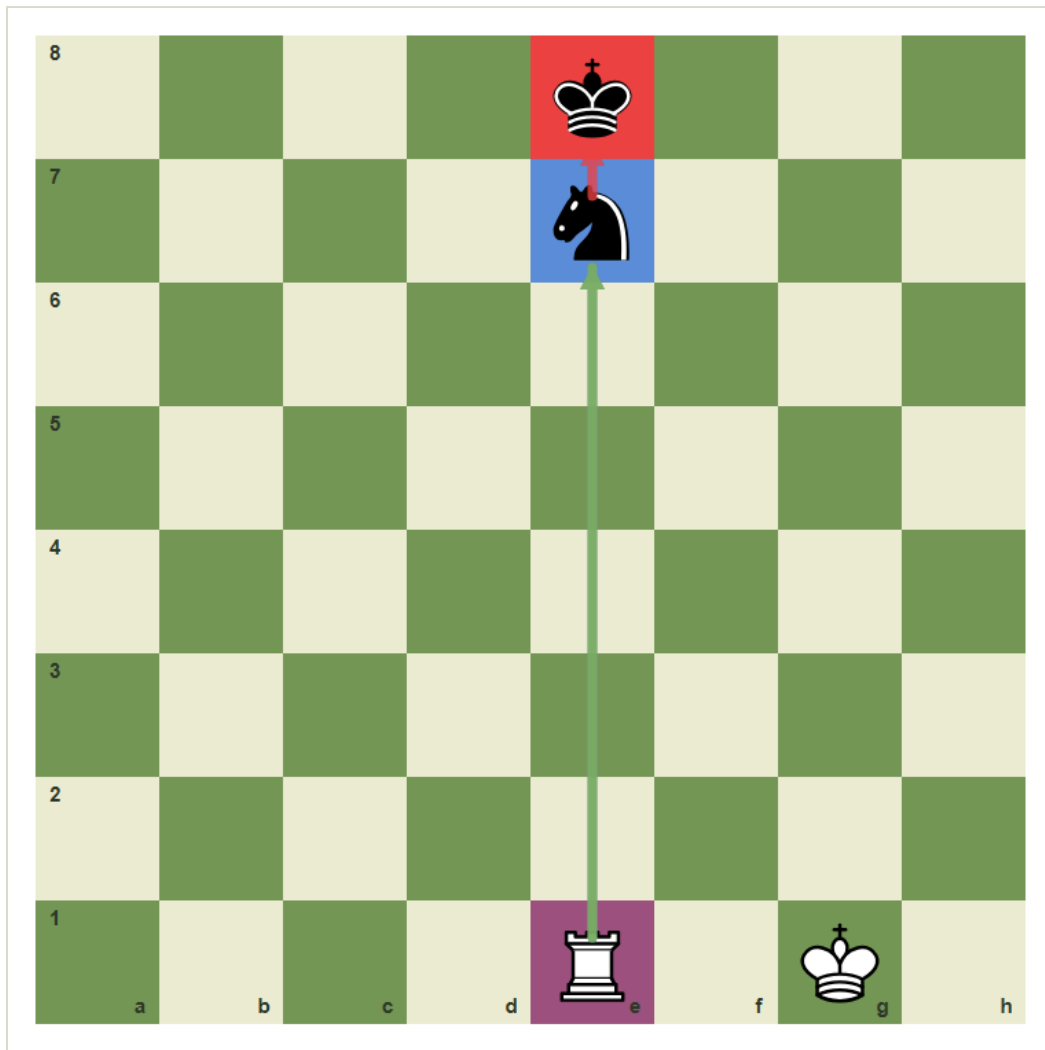
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **e7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

One Move Deeper Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **one move deeper**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

One Move Deeper Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **one move deeper**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

One Move Deeper Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **one move deeper**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When To Stop Calculating

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

When To Stop Calculating converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

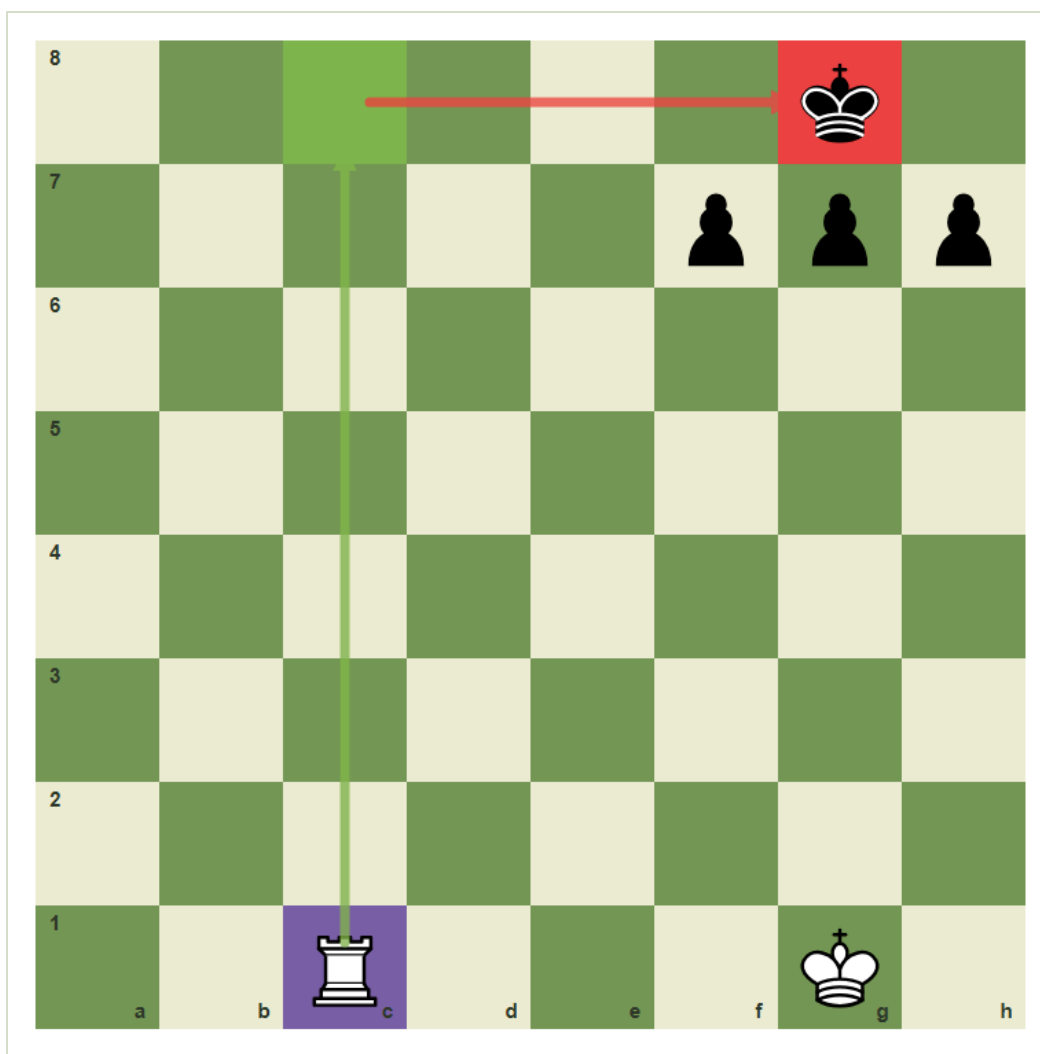
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for when to stop calculating.
- Choose a move or plan that fits when to stop calculating.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with when to stop calculating.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

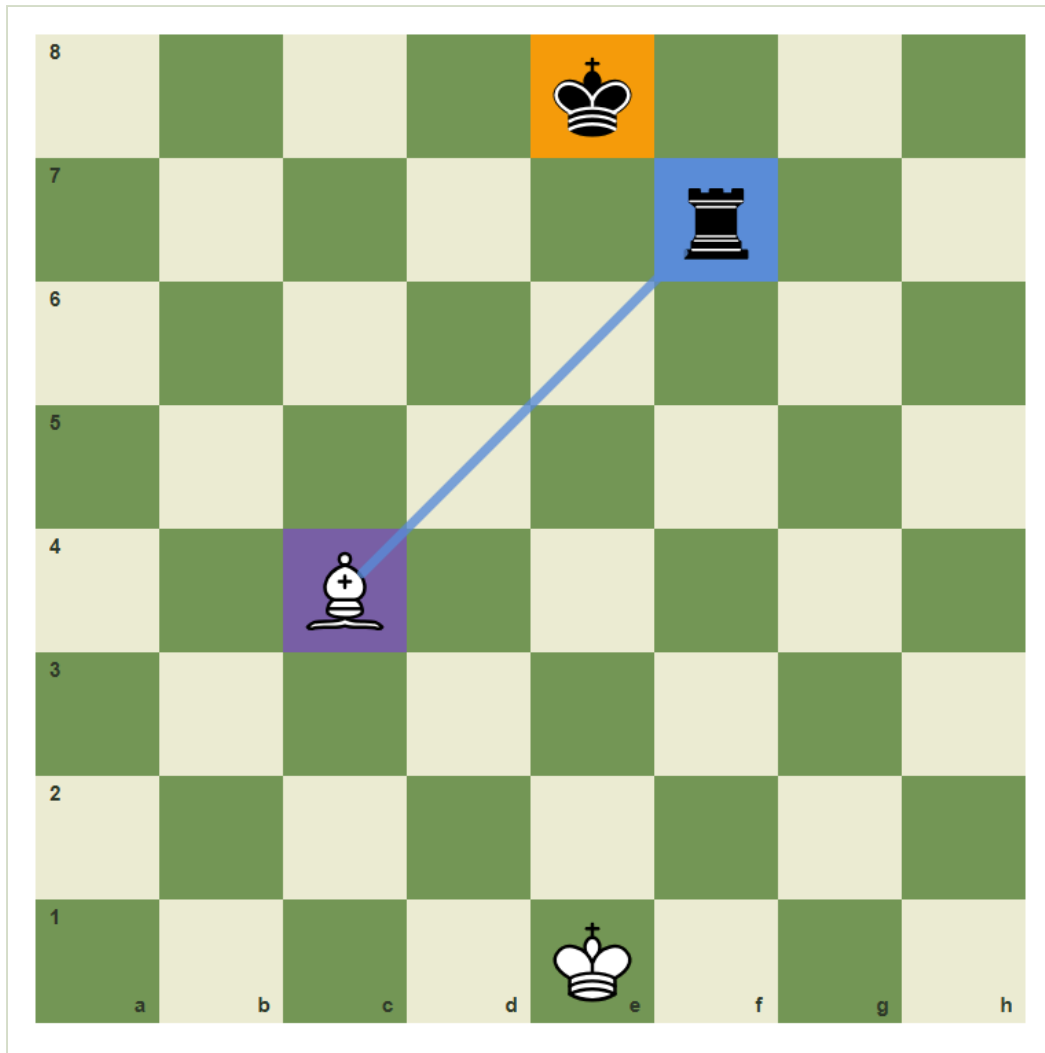
When To Stop Calculating is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

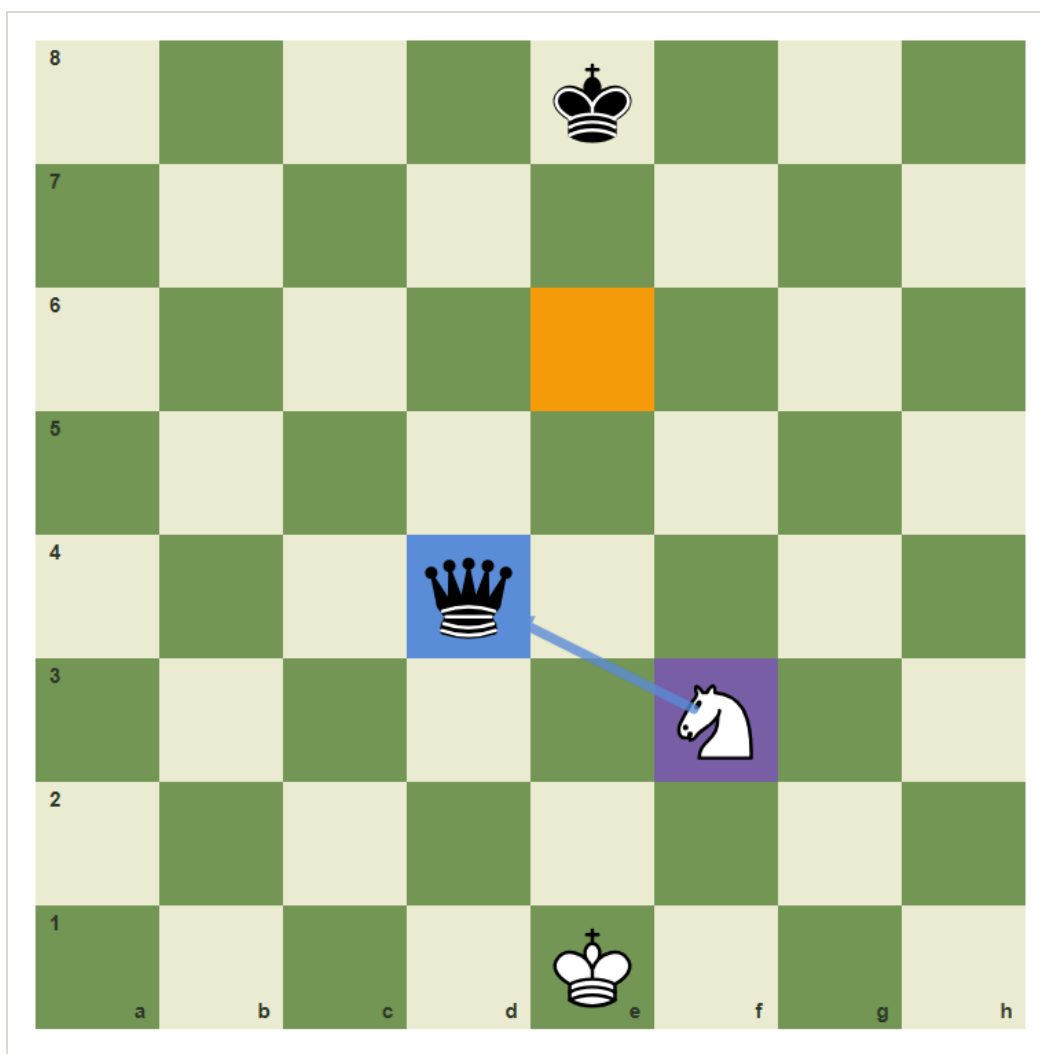


The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

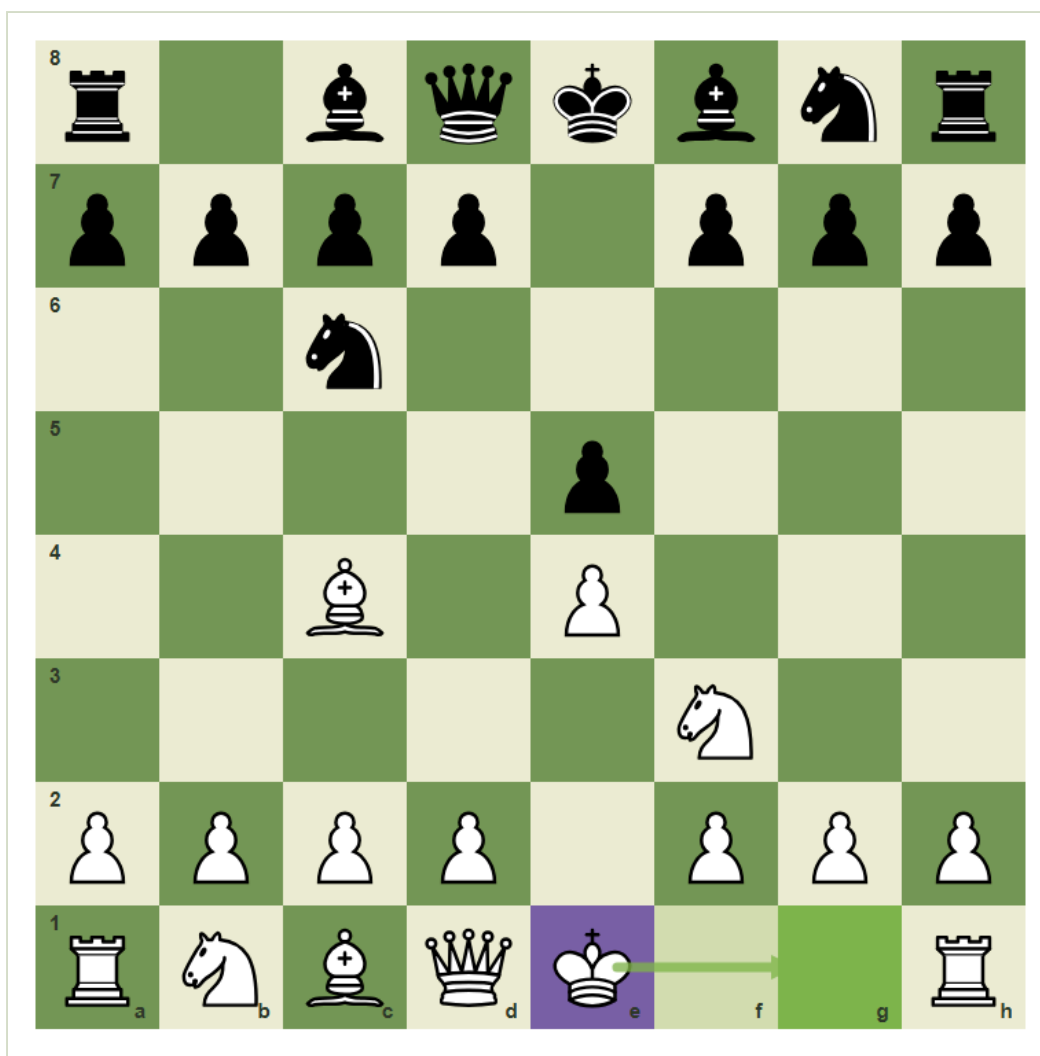
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



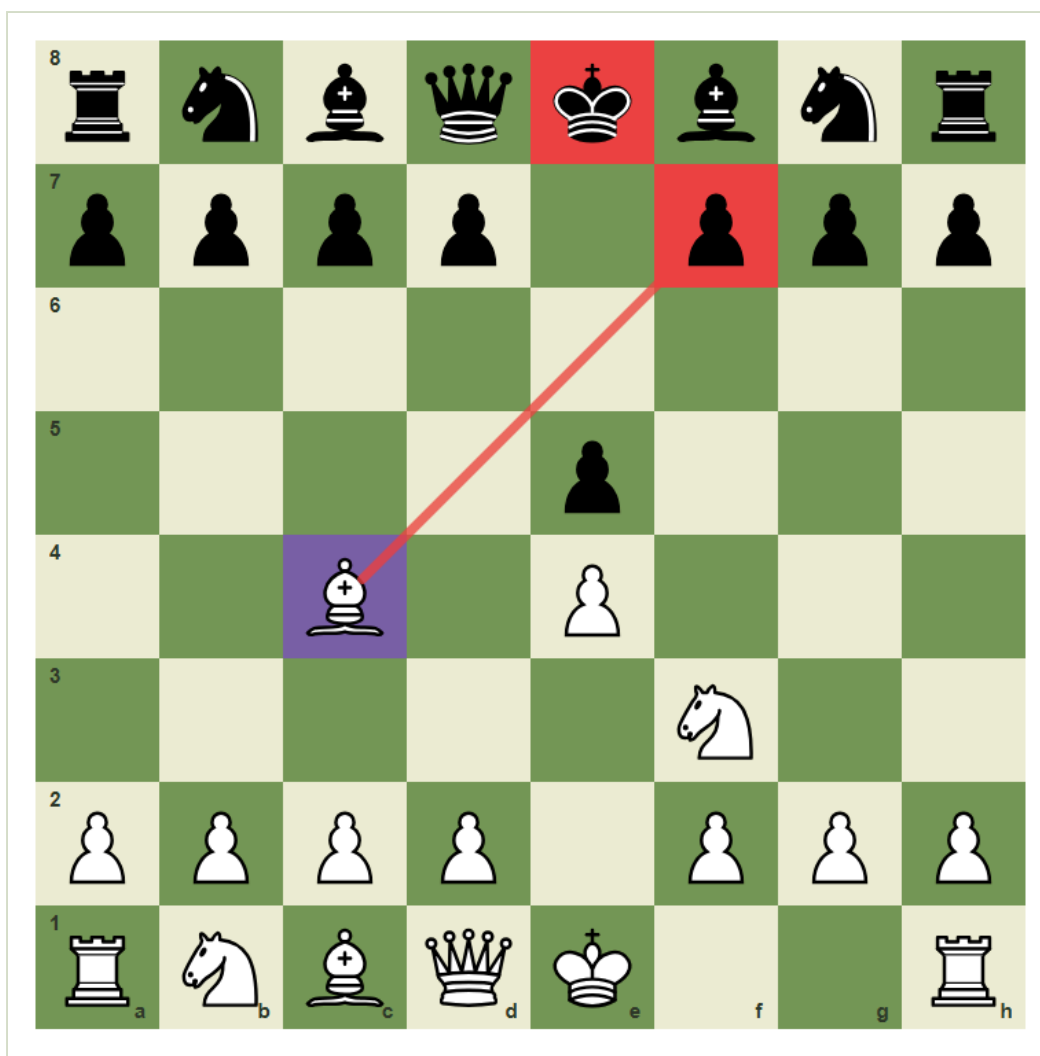
A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

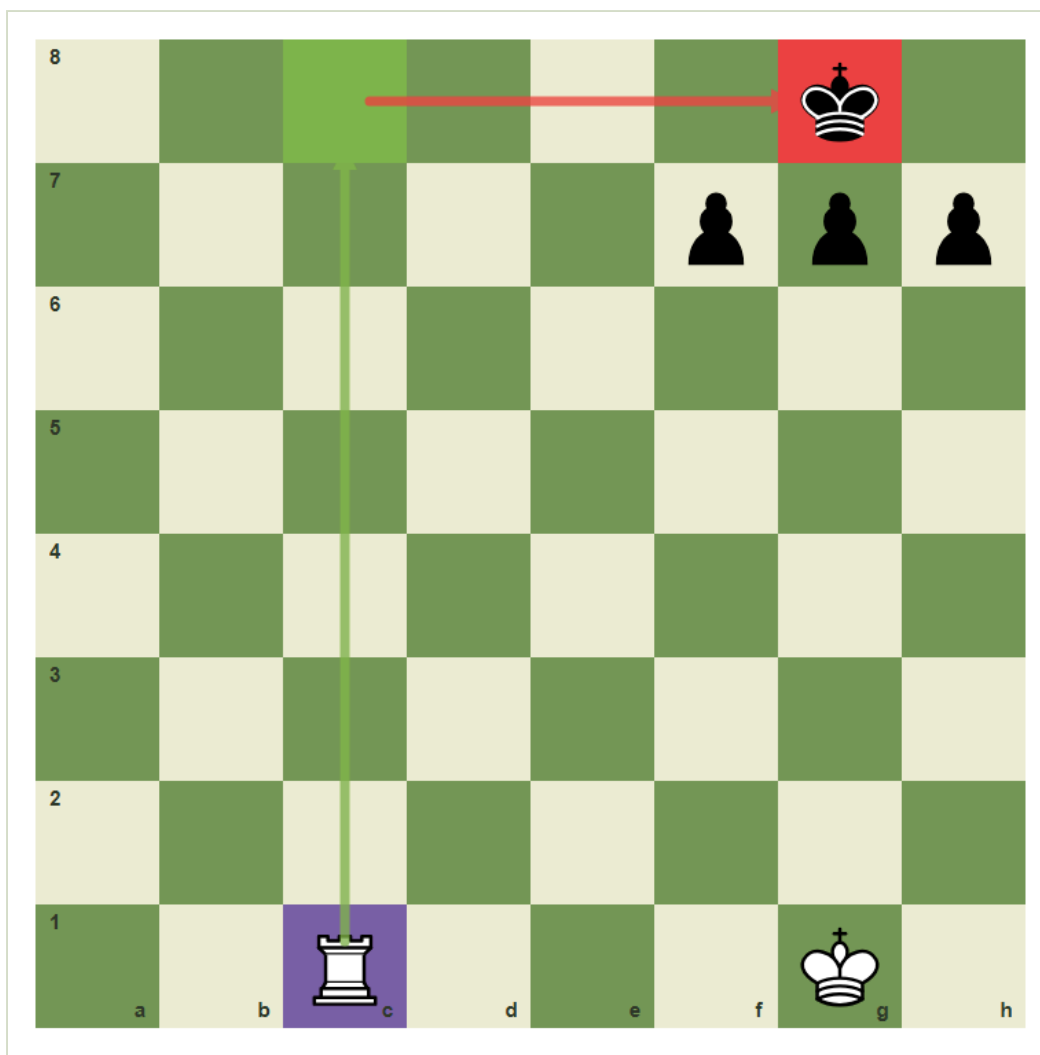
Training Diagram: review position



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

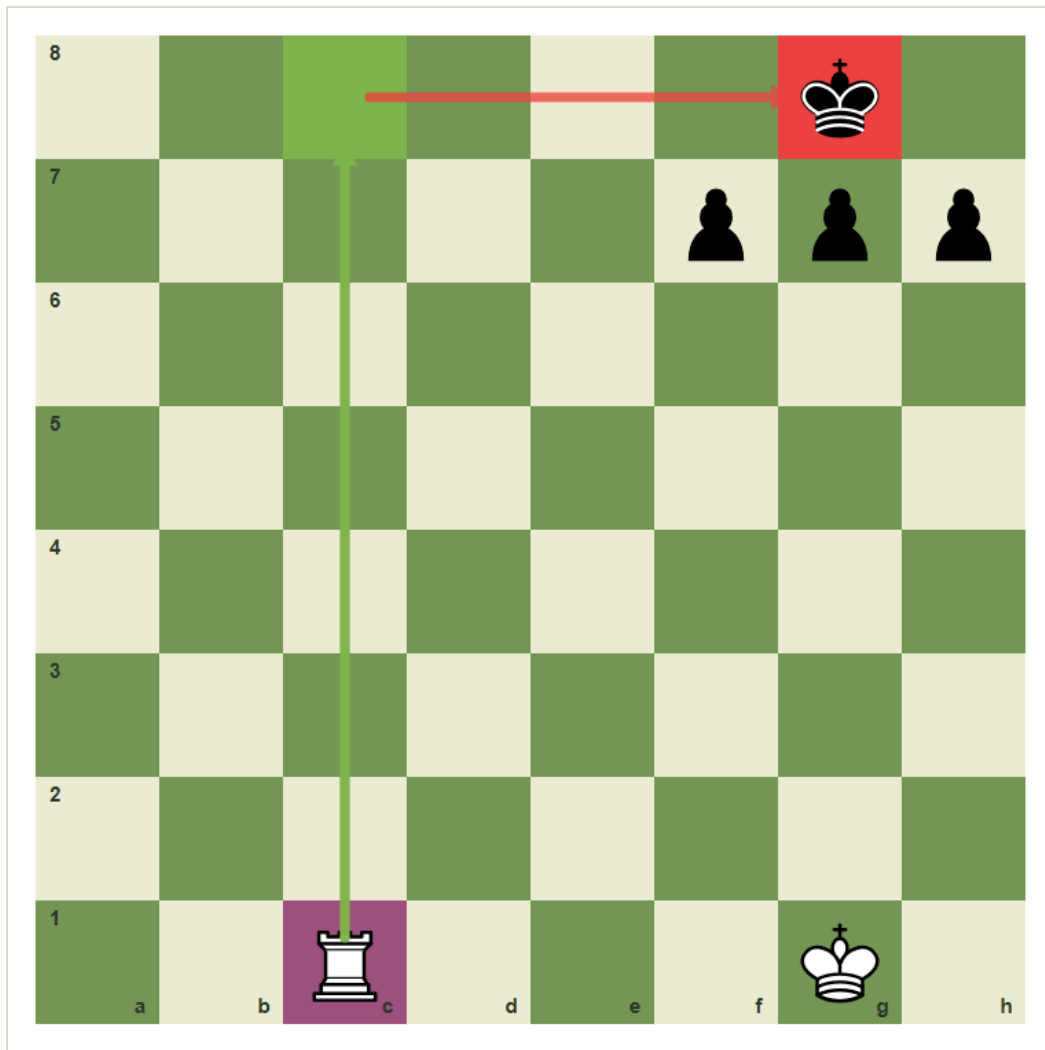
Play the highlighted move from **c1** to **c8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

When To Stop Calculating Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **when to stop calculating**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When To Stop Calculating Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **when to stop calculating**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

When To Stop Calculating Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **when to stop calculating**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Avoiding Hope Chess

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Avoiding Hope Chess converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

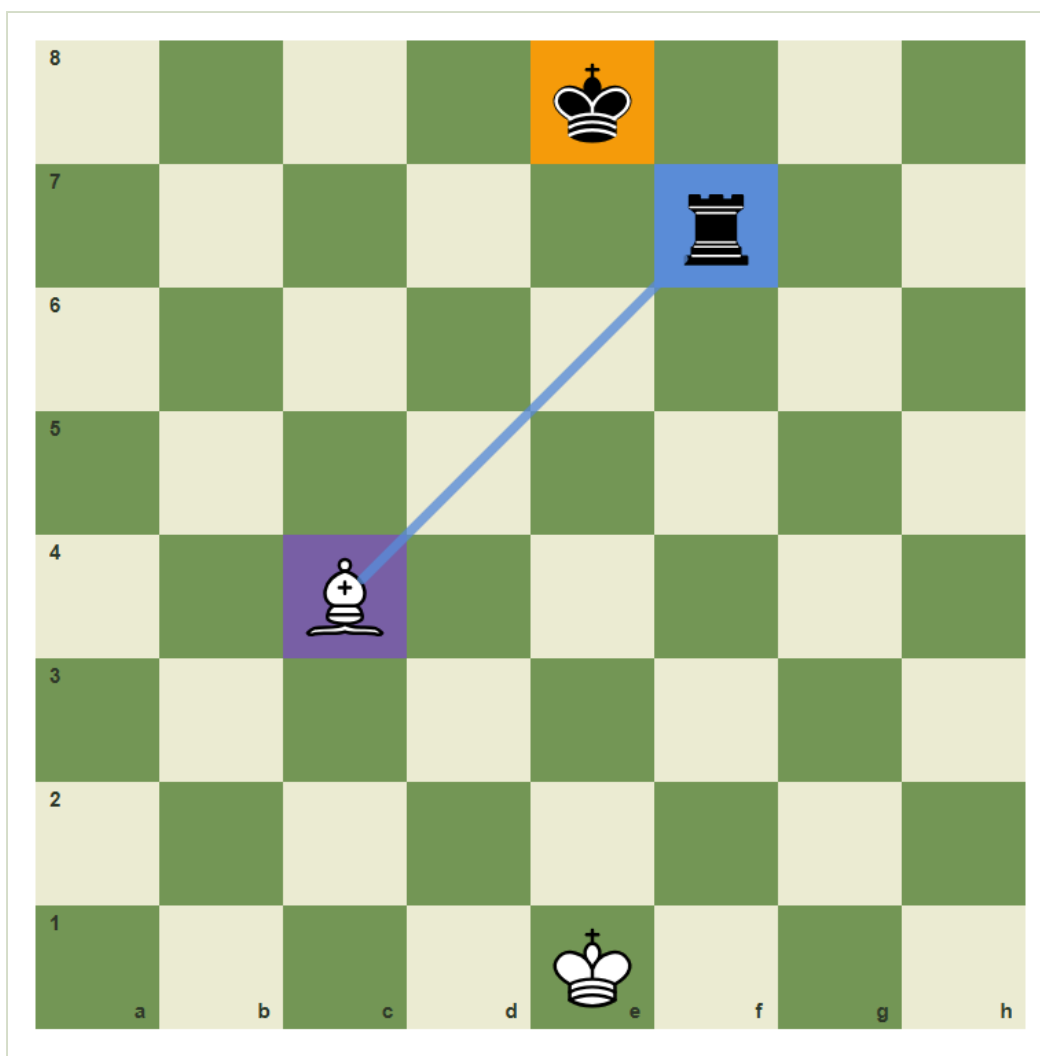
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for avoiding hope chess.
- Choose a move or plan that fits avoiding hope chess.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with avoiding hope chess.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

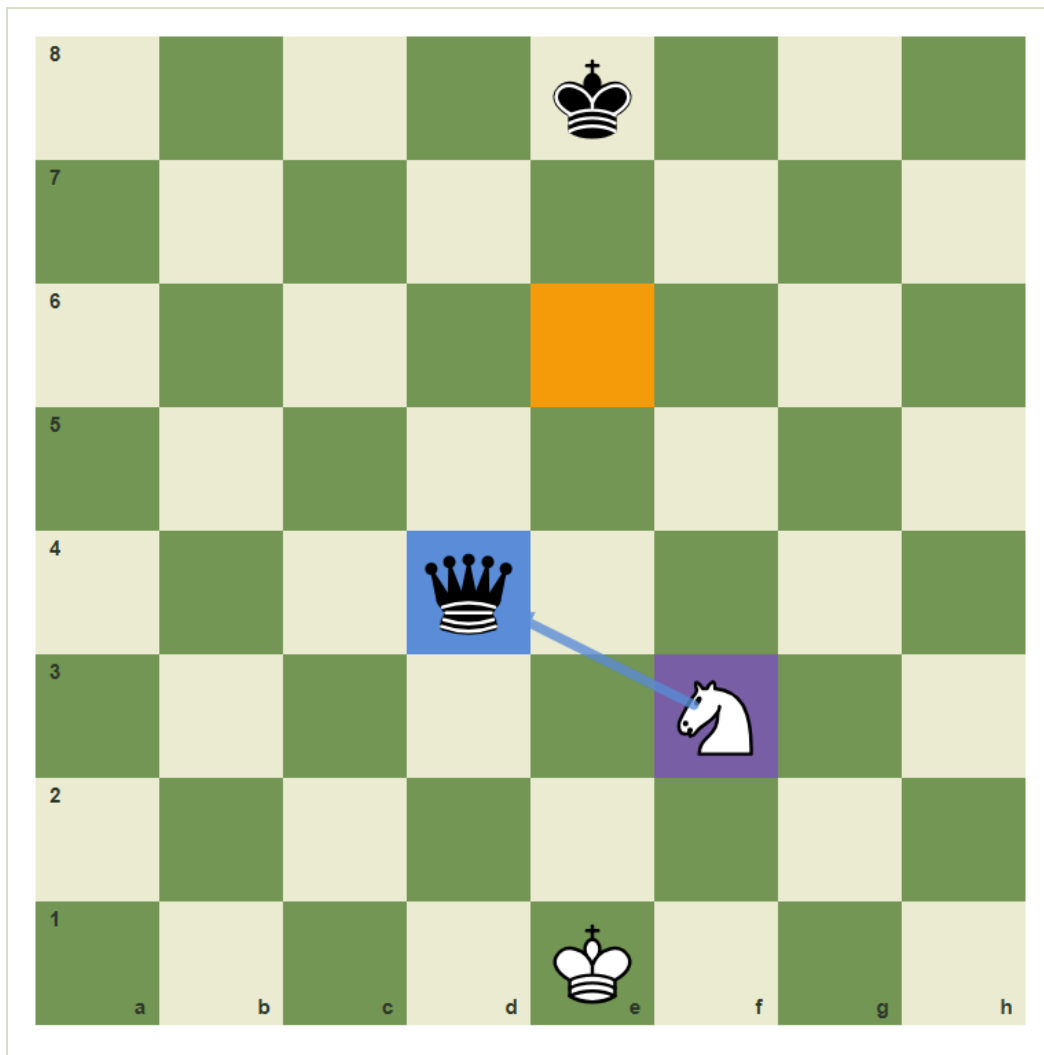
Avoiding Hope Chess is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

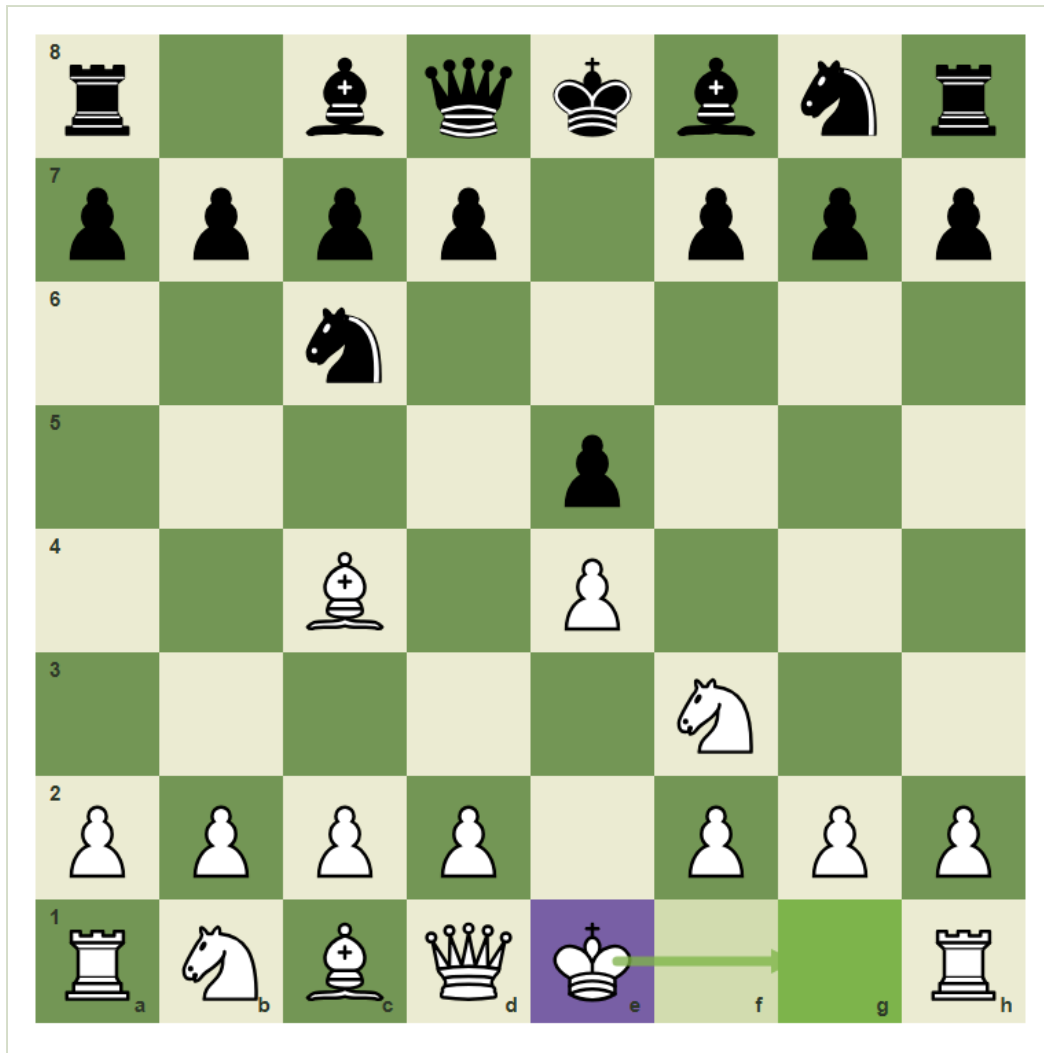


A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

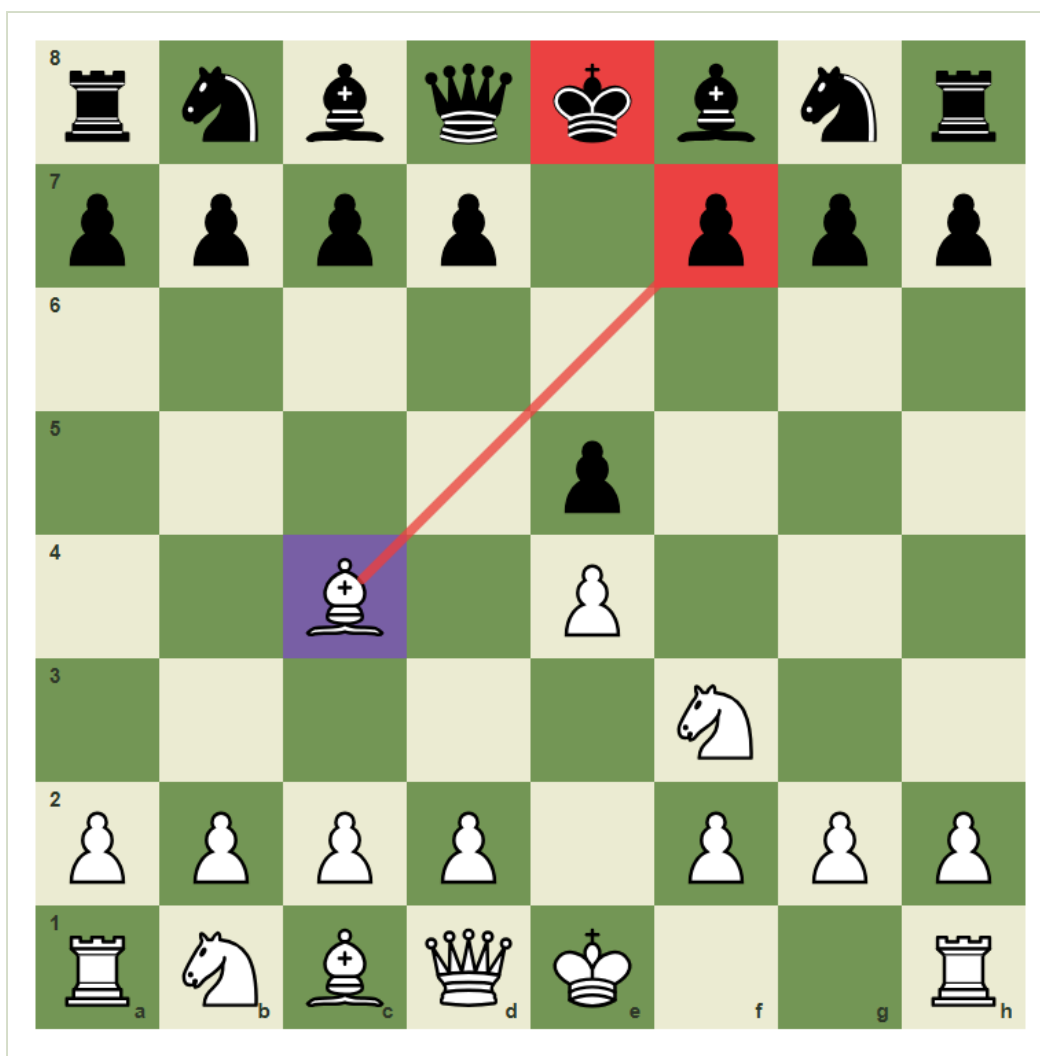
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



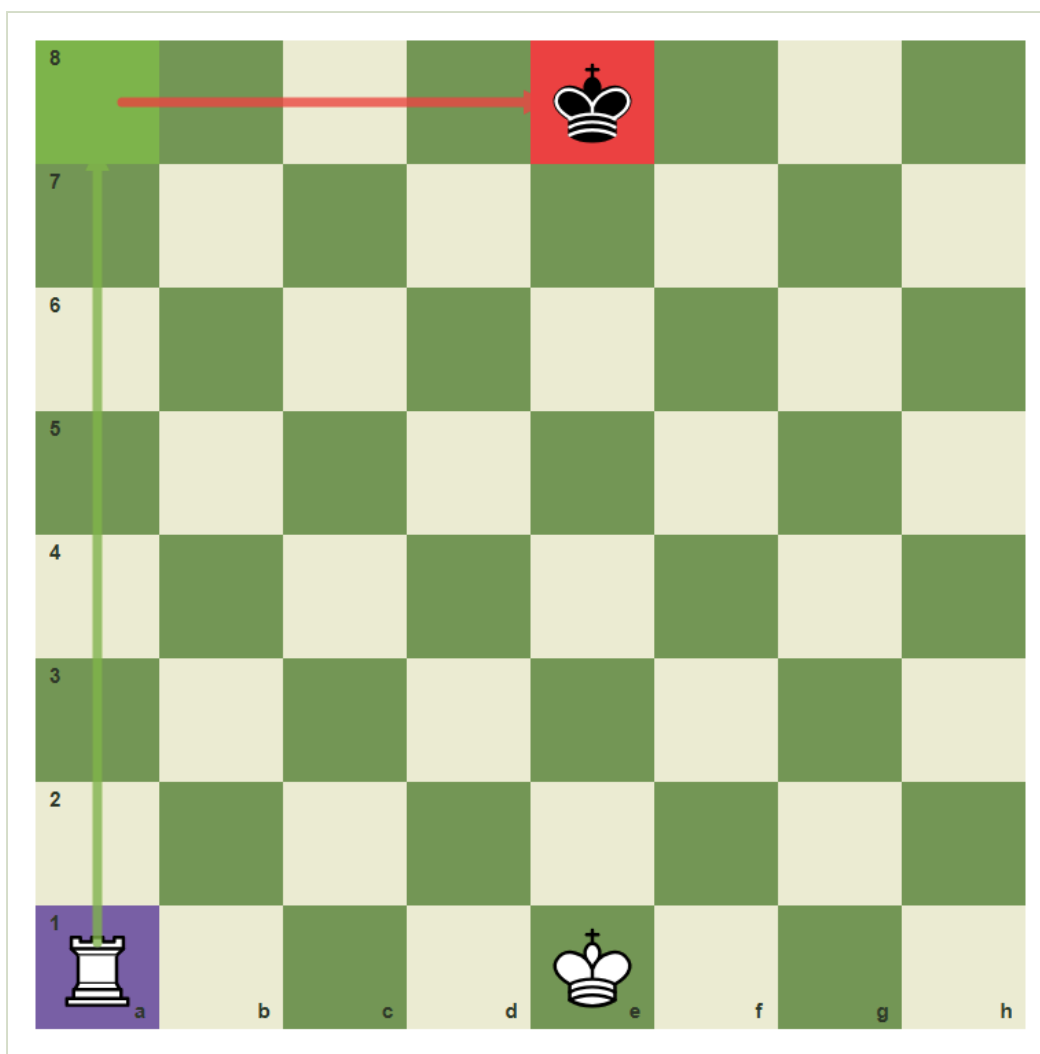
King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

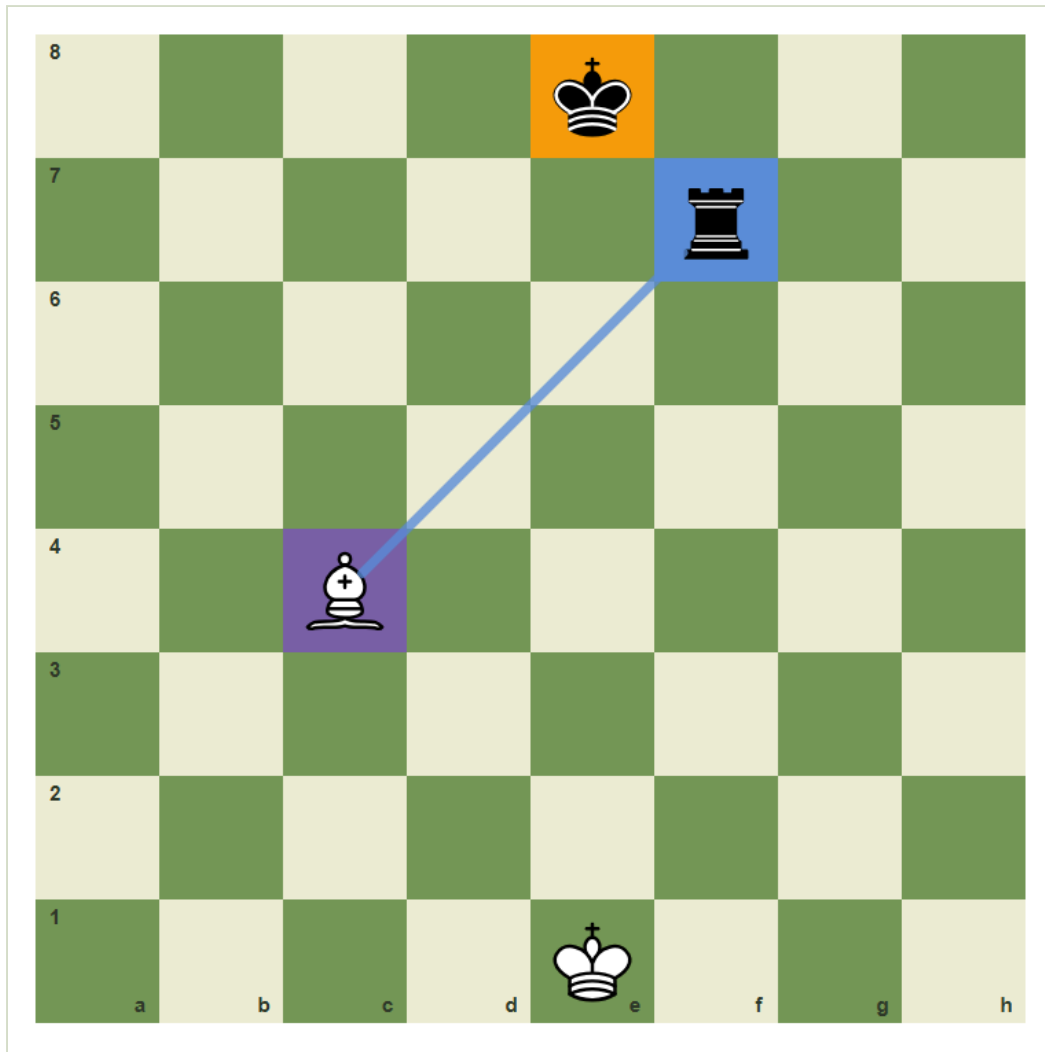
Training Diagram: review position



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

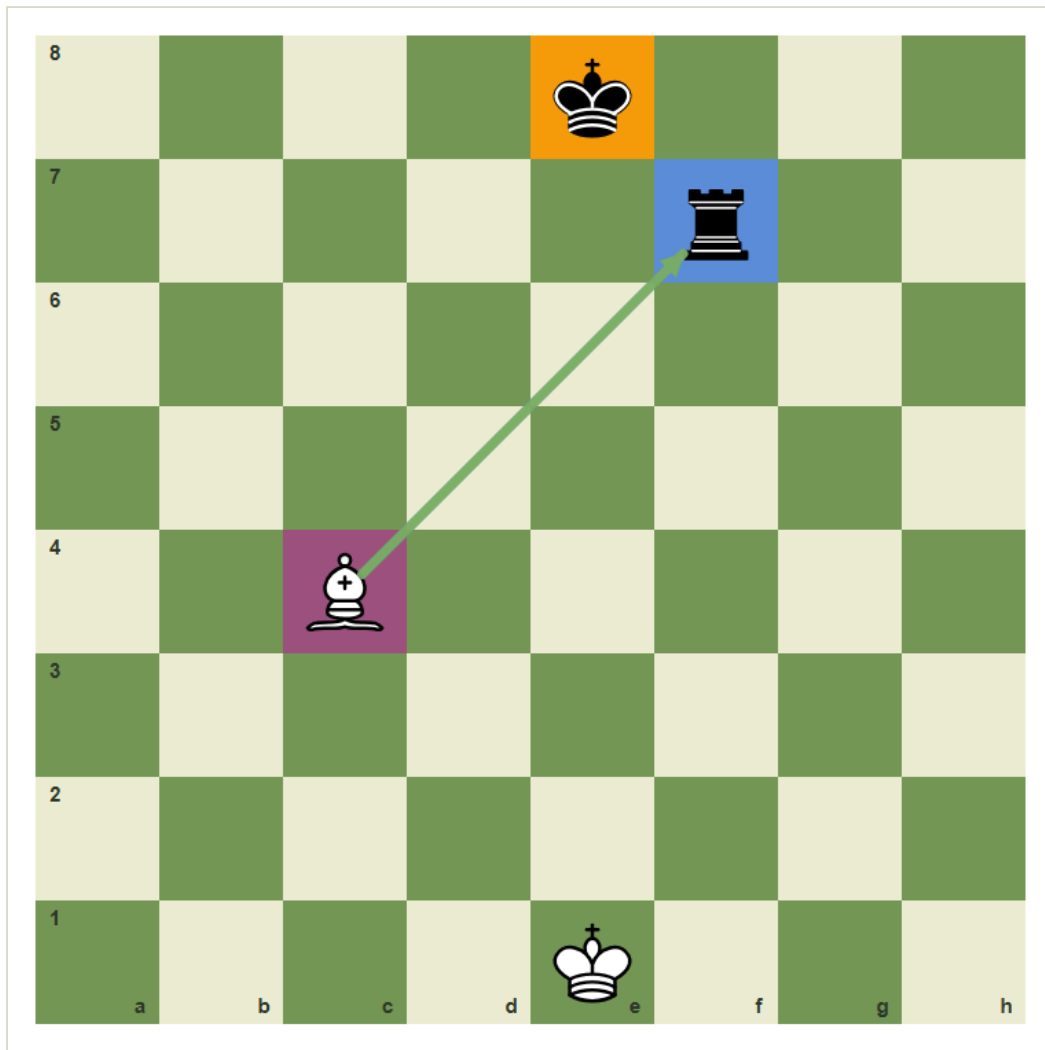
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Avoiding Hope Chess Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **avoiding hope chess**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Avoiding Hope Chess Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **avoiding hope chess**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Avoiding Hope Chess Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **avoiding hope chess**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Calculation Checkpoint

Calculation I - Candidate Moves | 1100-1400 | silver

Calculation Checkpoint converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

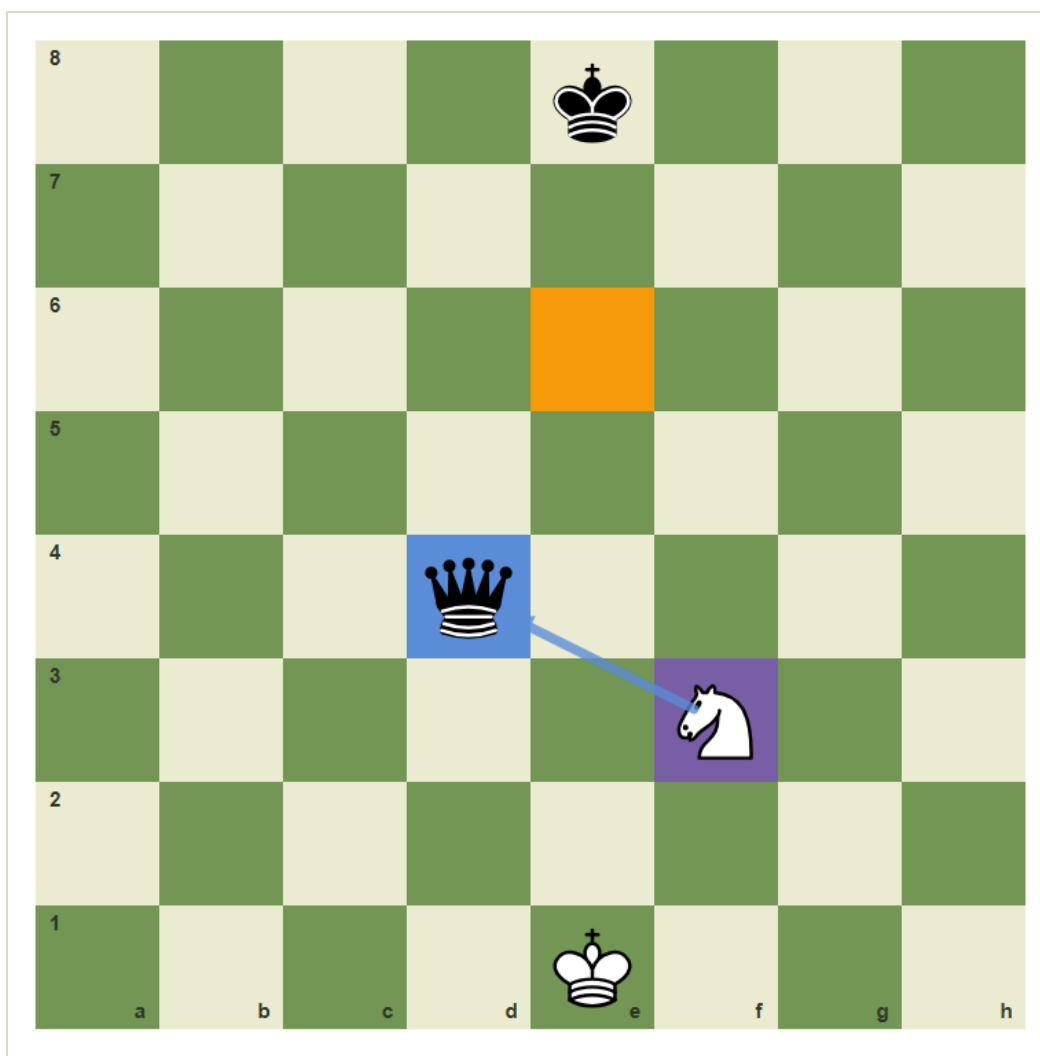
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for calculation checkpoint.
- Choose a move or plan that fits calculation checkpoint.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with calculation checkpoint.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

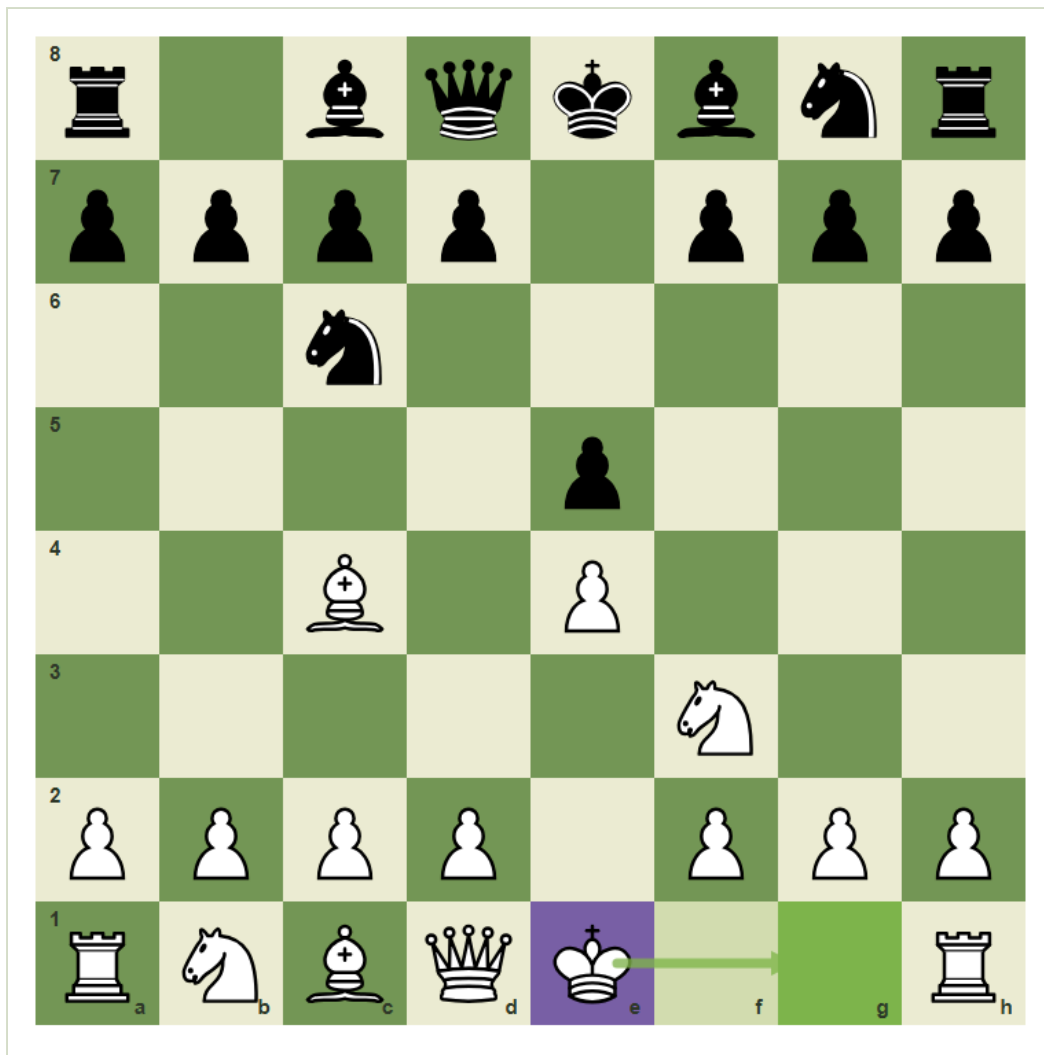
Calculation Checkpoint is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

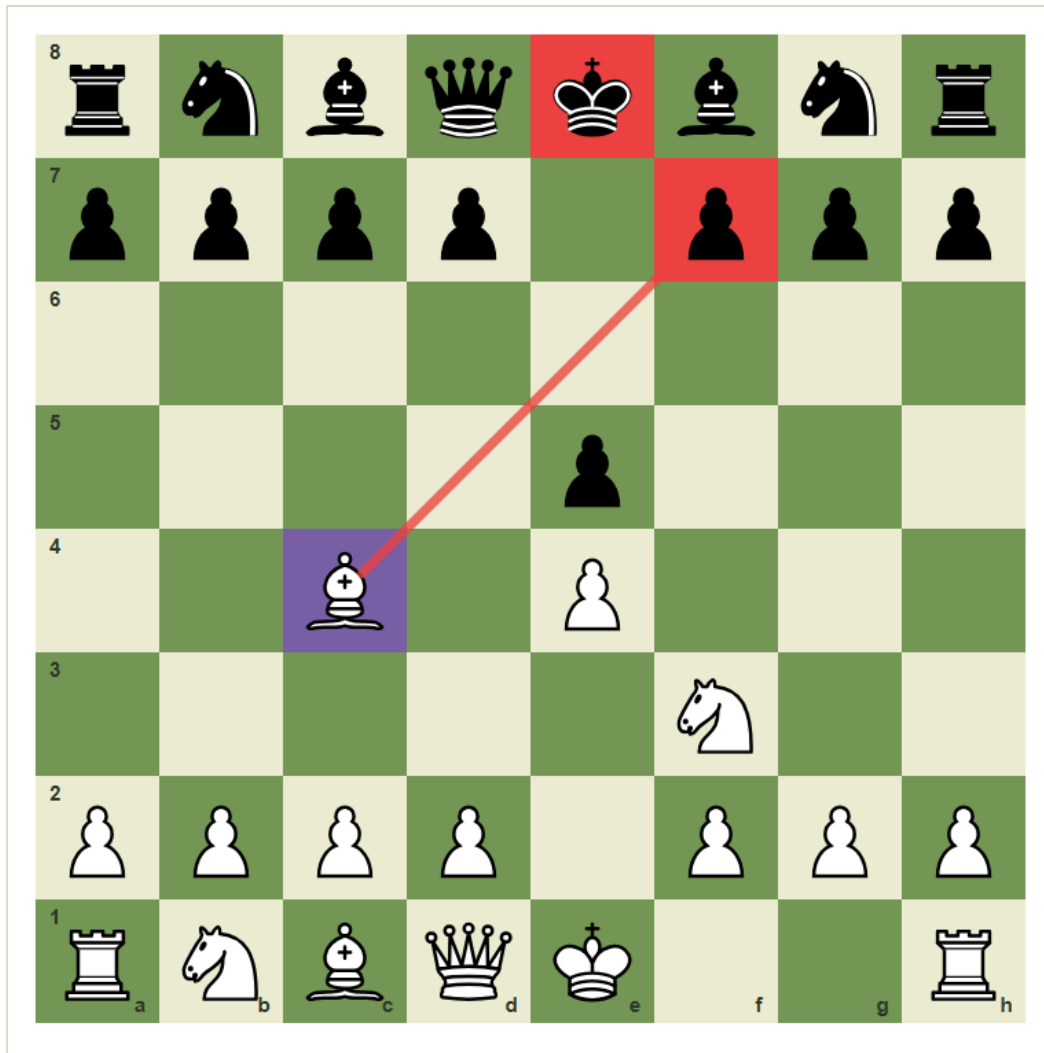


King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

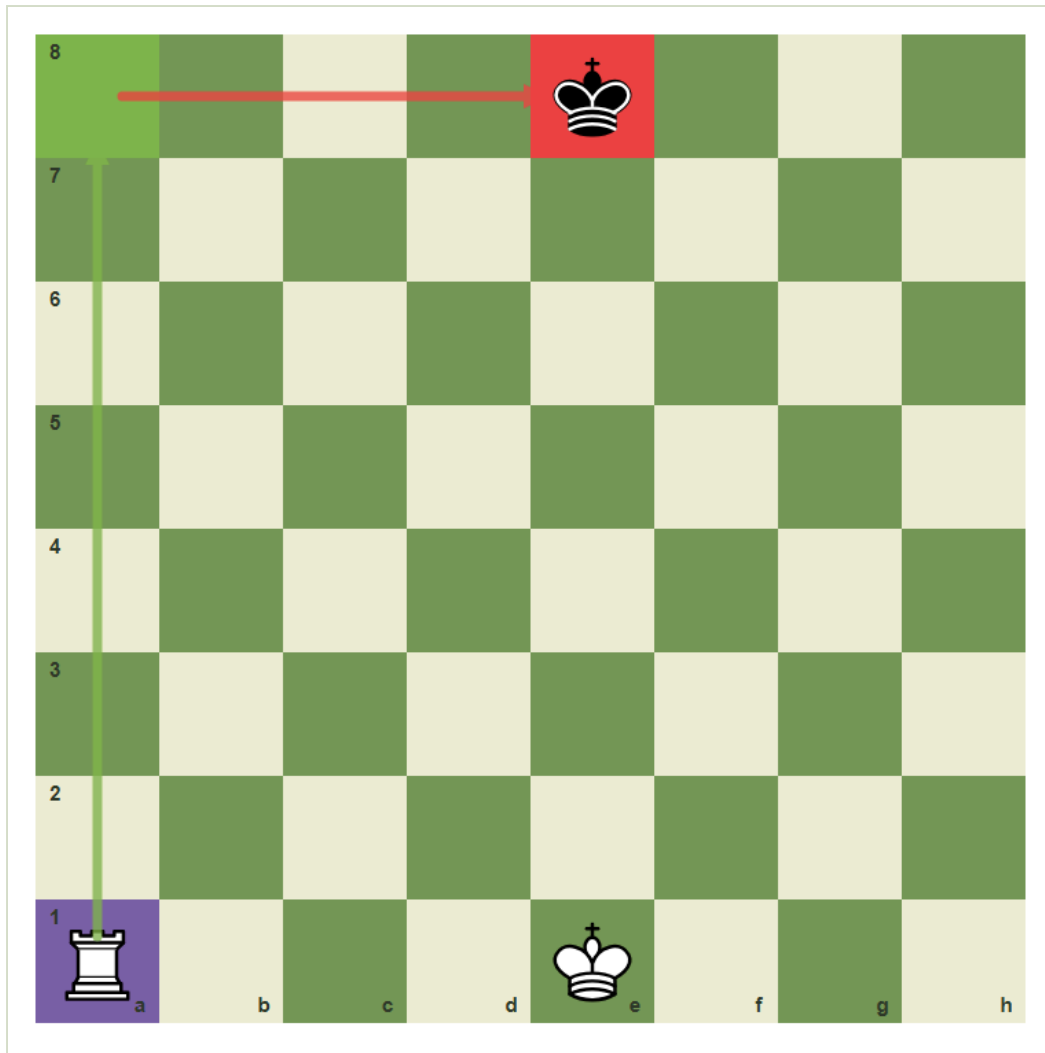
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



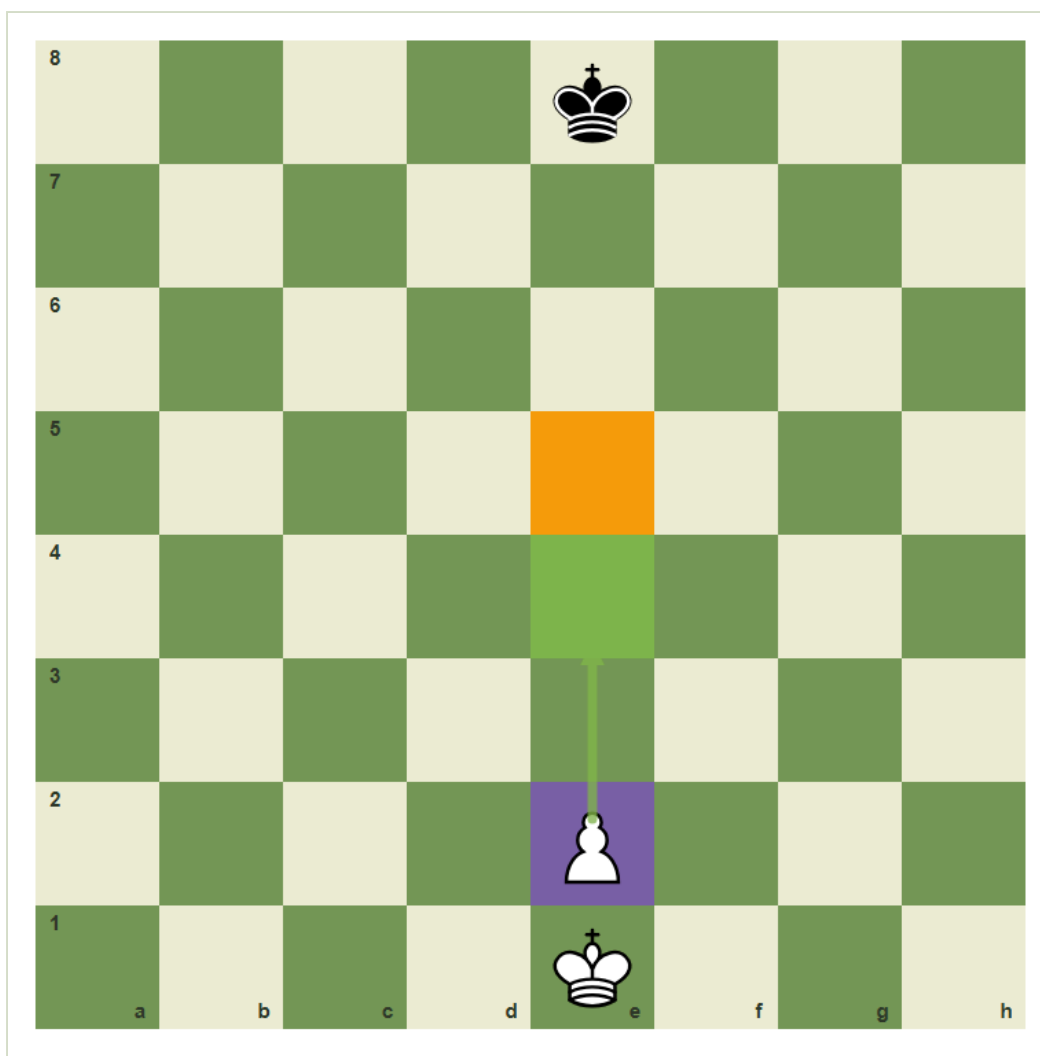
Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

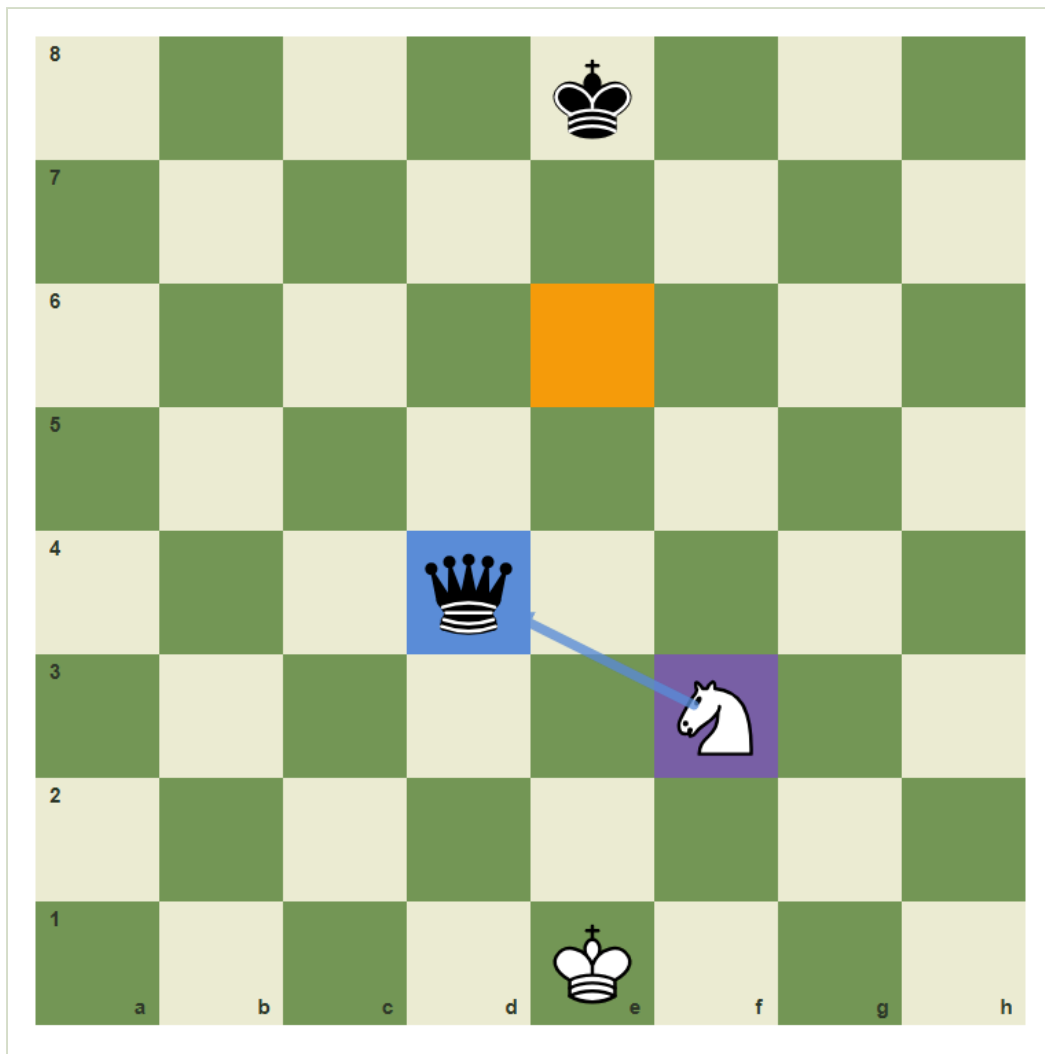
Training Diagram: review position



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

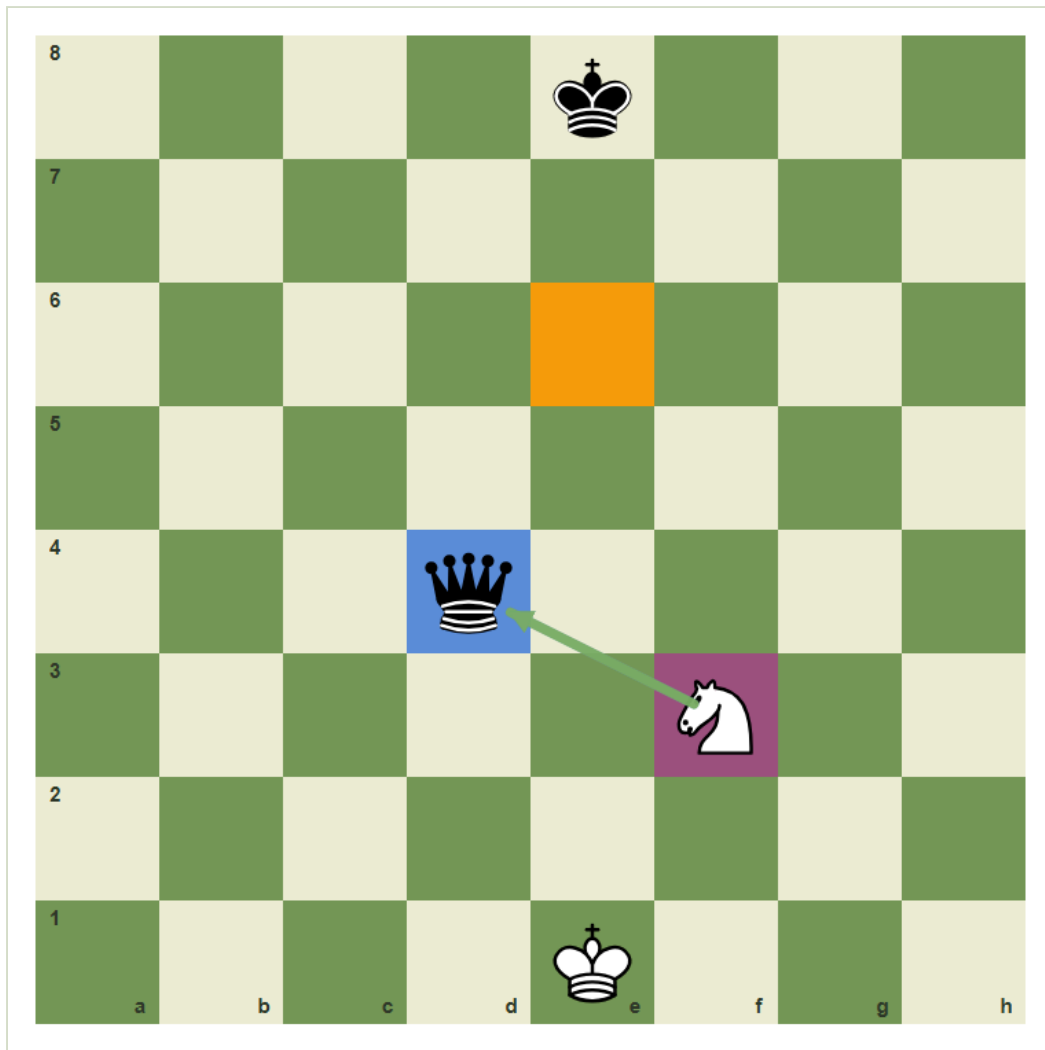
Play the highlighted move from **f3** to **d4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Calculation Checkpoint Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **calculation checkpoint**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Calculation Checkpoint Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **calculation checkpoint**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Calculation Checkpoint Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **calculation checkpoint**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.